

Whirlpool of India Ltd. (WHIRLPOOL)

Conference call transcripts, oldest-first. 5 call(s). Generated 2026-08-02.

Call: Feb 2024

February 08, 2024

The Manager

Listing Department

BSE Limited

Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers

Dalal Street, Mumbai,

Maharashtra - 400001

Script Code : 500238The Manager

Listing Department

National Stock Exchange of India Limited

Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block G,

Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East,

Mumbai, Maharashtra – 400051

Symbol: WHIRLPOL

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Transcript of the Earnings Conference Call

This is further to our intimation letter dated 26th January, 2024, we enclose herewith a copy of the transcript of the Earnings Conference Call of the Company for the quarter and nine months ended 31st December, 2023 held on 02nd February, 2024.

The same will also be uploaded on the Company's website at www.whirlpoolindia.com.

Yours faithfully,

For Whirlpool of India Limited

Roopali Singh

VP - Legal and Company Secretary

Plot No. 40, Sector 44,

Gurugram, Haryana

Encl: as above

Conference

Title:

Earnings

Conference

Call

with

Whirlpool

Date:

Friday,

2nd

February

2024

Roopali

Singh:

Thank

you.

Good

afternoon,

everyone.

I'm

Roopali

Singh,

the

company

secretary

of

the

company.

I

welcome

you

all

to

the

earnings

call

of

Whirlpool
of
India
Limited.
We
have
with
us
today,
Mr.
Narasimhan
Eswar,
the
managing
director
of
the
company,
Mr.
Aditya
Jain,
the
Chief
Financial
Officer.
Today
during
the
call,
we
will
begin
with
the
presentation
on
the
business
and
financial
results
followed
by
the
Q&A
session.
Please
note
that
the
cautionary
statement
right
now
on
the
link,
please
take
note
of
the
content.
With
that,
I

would
now
hand
it
over
to
Mr.
Eswar.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Thank
you.
Thank
you,
Roopali.
I'm
Narasimhan
Eswar,
managing
director
for
Whirlpool
of
India,
and
I'm
here
with
my
colleague,
Mr.
Aditya
Jain,
the
CFO.
I
will
walk
you
all
through
the
business
overview
and
the
strategic
competitors
and
then
request
Aditya
to
come
in
on
the
financial
performance
then
I'll
come
back
to
close.
And

after
that,
we're
open
for
questions.
So
before
I
begin,
thank
you
all
for
making
the
call.
We
really
appreciate
it.
Let
me
just
get
onto
the
business
overview
now.
The
■rst
thing
I'd
like
to
start
o■
with
is
by
talking
about
India
and
it's
being
a
huge
strategic
focus
for
Whirlpool.
Why
is
that?
A
couple
of
reasons.
One
is
the
opportunity
that
India

itself
a word
as
a
marketplace.
The
value
creation
opportunity
in
India
is
basically
coming
through
three
things.
Firstly,
the
fact
that
the
market
GDP
growth
is
expected
to
be
between
six
and
7%
going
forward
across
span
of
time.
This
will
lead
for
sure
to
a
very
strong
growth
influence
in
demographic,
which
we
all
know
about.
And
so
that
middle
class
growing
and
becoming
more

premium,
more
up
market
is
something
that
we
all
expect.
But
more
important
than
that
is
the
opportunity
we
have
for
the
penetration
growth
in
appliances.
So
if
you
see,
for
example,
refrigerators
are
typically
in
about
one
in
three
homes
in
India,
there
or
thereabouts,
washing
machines
are
in
less
than
one
in
■ve
homes,
and
the
rest
of
the
appliances
are
in
less
than

one
in
10
homes
typically.
So
there
is
a
significant
growth
opportunity
for
consumer
durables
in
India.
If
you
look
at
Whirlpool,
India
itself,
Whirlpool
India
has
got
a
track
record
of
value
creation
for
its
investors
as
well
as
for
the
market.
We
played
a
pioneering
role
in
the
Indian
durables
i
ndustry,
and
Whirlpool
has
been
associated
with
several
industries
■rst.
I'm
not
going

to
go
into
the
details
of
it
now,
one
of
my
future
slides
will
cover
it.
The
other
important
thing
is
Whirlpool
is
a
very
well-known
brand
in
this
country.
It's
a
very
well-known
brand
and
it's
also
very
well
known
for
its
quality.
And
the
good
thing
about
our
business
is
that
we
are
quite
strong
across
the
entire
country.
So
it's
not
one
region

or
a
couple
of
regions
we're
strong
in.
We
are
very
strong
throughout
the
northeast,
west,
south
of
India.
Also
across
economics
strata.
As
we
started
o■,
we
started
o■
with
the
DC
business,
the
direct
cool
refrigerator,
the
single
door
refrigerator
business,
and
we
were
strong
there
and
we
continue
to
be
strong
there,
as
well
as
in
semi-automatic
washing
machines.
But
we've
since
then

across
the
years
and
decades,
progressed
into
other
areas
as
well.
The
premium
areas
like
frost
free
refrigerators,
top
loaded
washing
machines,
and
now
we've
recently
made
an
entry
into
front
load
washing
machines
as
well,
making
in
India
from
2022
second
half.
Then
the
product
portfolio
that
we
have.
So
we
got
a
diverse
product
portfolio
across
multiple
categories
including
refrigerators,
washers,
cooking,
and
so

on
and
so
forth.
The
more
important
thing
is
we
look
at
continued
innovation
in
premium
product
segments
coming
through
across
all
these
different
categories,
and
this
is
backed
by
a
strong
manufacturing
footprint.
Now,
what
do
I
mean
by
that?
We've
got
a
factory
in
Faridabad
that
basically
makes
refrigerators
and
makes
semi-automatic
washing
machines.
We've
got
a
factory
in
Pune
that
makes
frost
free

refrigerators
and
direct-cool
refrigerators.
And
we've
got
a
factory
in
the
south
of
India
in
Puducherry,
which
makes
washing
machines.
Layer
this
on
top
of
the
fact
that
we
have
a
powerful
Pan-India
sales
distribution
and
service
network.
Now,
why
do
I
call
it
powerful?
One
is
the
reach
and
depth
of
it.
The
number
of
billing
points
that
we
have
in
terms
of
sales,
the

number
of
service
partners
we
have
across
the
country,
and
the
number
of
towns
we
have.
More
than
that,
also
the
tremendous
relationships
we
have,
which
have
been
built
over
decades
and
kept
over
decades
with
the
customers.
So
we've
got
a
very
strong
network
that
is
not
just
based
on
the
amount
of
sales
points
that
we
do,
but
also
the
relationship
that
we
have

with
customers.
In
our
best
years

,
we've
also
had
good
investments,
strong
investments
in
building
retail
demand
generation.

So
these
are
the
things
that
have
actually
added
and
created
value
over
the
years
for
Whirlpool.

Let
me
now
shift
gears
and
talk
to
you
about
the
business
performance
over
the
last
15
years.

First,
I'll
talk
to
you
about
the
years
up
to
the
current

■scal
year,
and
then
in
the
next
slide
I'll
cover
the
current
■scal
year.
So
if
you
look
between
2008,
2009
and
2019,
2020,
we
were
growing
at
a
revenue
CAGR
of
12%
and
the
PBT
CAGR
of
20%,
which
is
quite
an
attractive
growth
trajectory
over
the
years.
In
the
years
of
2021
and
2021,
2022,
we
were
hit
by
what
I
call
the
three

Cs.
The
■rst
C
was
COVID.
That
really
had
a
signi■cant
impact
on
many
aspects
of
the
business
as
you
can
imagine.
The
second
one
was
increased
competition.
So
as
we
all
know,
there
were
a
lot
of
new
players
who
came
in,
existing
players
who
started
pumping
in
a
lot
of
investments.
So
competition
also
impacted
us.
And
the
third
thing
that
a■ected
us,
the

commodity
costs
which
went
up
post
COVID.
This
is
something
that
happened
across
the
industry.
It
also
happened
to
us
with
the
result
that
over
those
two
years
we
were
■at.
We
did
not
grow
any
revenue
at
all.
In
2022,
2023,
sorry,
just
to
mention,
these
three
things
also
contributed
to
the
pro■t
margin.
So
we
used
to
be
at
a
PBT
margin
of
about

11%
for
three
years,
between
2017,
2018
and
2019,
2020.
And
that
PBT
margin
went
down
to
about
5%
in
2021,
2022.
In
the
year
2022,
2023
on
top
of
these
things,
something
else
happened,
and
that
was
that
there
was
a
pricing
uncompetitiveness
that
started
happening
in
the
market
as
far
as
our
brands
were
concerned
across
all
our
categories.
This
was
because
of
some

pricing
actions
that
we
had
taken.
And
therefore,
what
happened
as
a
result
was
that
while
at
the
beginning
of
the
year
our
revenue
went
up,
throughout
the
year,
the
balance
of
the
calendar
year,
the
revenues
as
well
as
the
market
shares
took
a
beating
as
we
went
through
2022,
2023
with
the
result
that
we
ended
up
growing
revenues
about
3%,
but
profitability
dropped

to
about
4 %
by
2022,
2203,
and
we
were
losing
market
share
quite
strongly
by
then.
Now
let's
talk
about
2023,
2024,
the
year
that
we're
still
in.
So
I
just,
there's
a
bit
of
a
complex
chart,
so
I
request
you
to
just
stay
with
me
for
a
second.
So
if
you
look
at
the
left
of
the
chart,
this
talks
about
the
half
one

2023,
2024.
This
is
basically
April
to
Septe
mber.
In
the
■rst
six
months
of
this
■scal
year,
April
to
September,
our
revenues
were
declining
by
4.3%
and
our
PBT
was
declining
by
about
28.8%.
That's
at
the
bottom
right,
basically.
Now,
what
actually
happened?
What
happened
was
that
two
fundamental
things
came
in
and
a■ected
these
numbers.
The
■rst
was
that
between
the
period
of

Jan
to
April,
we
adjusted
the
pricing
in
the
market.
We
adjusted
the
pricing
from
our
side
to
basically
make
sure
that
we
were
back
to
our
pricing
indices
that
make
sure
we
are
competitive
in
the
marketplace.
So
when
you
take
that
pricing
decision,
what
happens
is
it
hits
your
revenue
and
it
also
hits
your
profits.
So
that
was
the
first
thing.
The
second

thing
is
on
refrigerators,
which
is
a
significant
proportion
of
our
business.
There
was
a
significant
regulatory
change
from
an
energy
standpoint
and
capacity
standpoint
that
happened,
and
we
had
to
re-engineer
quite
a
bit
to
basically
drive
that.
And
that
regulatory
cost
upcharge
as
well
came
into
this
fiscal
year.
So
these
were
the
reasons
why
the
revenue
declined
by
4.3%
in
the
first
half

of
the
year,
and
the
profits
declined
by
28.8%
in
the
first
half
of
the
year.
In
the
October
to
December
quarter,
we've
actually
had
a
pretty
decent
growth.
So
our
revenues
grown
by
about
19.2%
on
a
standalone
basis.
I
just
want
to
clarify
this
is
standalone,
not
including
Elica.
This
is
the
Whirlpool
based
brand
business.
Revenues
have
grown
by
19.2%
and
our
profits

have
grown
by
34.6%
albeit
the
profits
growth
being
on
a
small
base.
Now,
what
has
actually
happened
is
the
following;
I'll
walk
you
through
the
details
now.
So
firstly,
the
pricing
as
I
told
you,
January
to
April,
we
changed
the
pricing
and
that
pricing
impact
started
helping
us
after
April,
May,
basically.
So
that
helped
because
we
got
the
pricing
back
to
indices
that

were
healthy
for
us
to
compete
in
the
marketplace.
The
second
thing
is
that
we
had
changed
all
of
the
refrigerators.
We
had
upgraded
a
lot
of
our
refrigerators
basically,
and
the
DC
refrigerators,
the
direct-cool
refrigerators,
got
into
the
market
around
April
or
so.
The
frost
free
refrigerators
actually
got
in
the
market
between
April
and
June.
So
by
the
third
quarter,
all
these
new

products
were
very
well
established
in
the
market
and
very
much
available.
The
innovation
was
very
much
available.
And
as
you'll
see
later,
we
upgraded
a
lot
of
features
in
claims
in
these
with
new
technology,
new
clai

ms
and
so
on
and
so
forth.
We
also
had
a
lot
of
focus
on
executional
excellence
that
we
started
from
around
April
or
May.
Just
to
give

you
one
small
example
of
that,
was
basically
looking
at
retail
executives.
So
we
employed
a
significantly
larger
number
of
retail
executives
than
before.
And
we
were
consistently
monitoring
the
return
on
investment
of
these
retail
executives.
And
based
on
that,
we
were
able
to
generate
some
clear
revenue
growth
as
well.
There
is
only
one
example.
There's
been
a
lot
of
focus
on
execution
excellence,

whether
it's
driving
higher
margin
products,
whether
it's
driving
display
compliance
as
well
as
driving
sales
fundamentals,
billing
points,
and
so
on
and
so
forth
that
we
focused
on
throughout,
starting
from
about
April,
May.
On
top
of
this,
there
were
two
other
things
that
helped
us
basically
deliver
on
profit
and
on
volumes.
One
thing
that
helped
us
on
volumes
was
basically
the
festival
seasonality.

So
this
year,
Diwali
was
on
November
12th
and
last
year's
Diwali
was
on
October
27th,
if
I
remember.
24th,
okay.
So
basically
there
was
a
three
week
difference
and
therefore,
the
volume
help
you
get
during
seasonality
is
split
up
into
September,
October
for
last
year
and
October,
November
for
this
year.
So
remember
all
these
factors.
We've
had
some
reasonably
good
growths
basically
on

revenue
this
year.
And
not
to
mention
very
significant
effort
that
we
basically
put
on
cost
productivity
which
I'll
talk
about
later,
it's
a
program
that
we
do
called
P4G,
Productivity
for
Growth.
And
that
program
is
coming
through
very
strongly.
It
is
faring
quite
well.
And
therefore,
the
nine
months
to
fiscal
year
2023,
2024,
we're
looking
at
a
revenue
growth
of
about
1.6%.
It's

almost
a
tale
of
two
halves
in
a
way,
which
is
what
we've
called
out.
Now,
as
far
as
the
full
year
is
concerned,
we
expect
full
year
revenue
growth
to
benefit
from
the
positive
momentum
that
we
see
in
H2.
And
we
expect
the
full
year
revenue
growth
to
track
moderately
better
than
the
cumulative
growth
delivered
in
the
first
nine
months.
And
in
terms

of
profit
improvement
in
the
short
to
medium
term,
we
expect
that
to
be
driven
by
revenue
growth,
especially
in
the
premium
segments
which
we're
focusing
on.
And
also
our
continued
P4G
program,
which
really
delivers
cost
takeout
actions
across
all
lines
of
the
P&L.
Moving
on
to
the
cooking
part
of
our
business
with
the
Elica
India
business,
we
increase
our
own
ership
in
Elica

India
from
49%
to
87%
in
2021.
The
Elica
brand
has
got
very
strong
capabilities
and
local
manufacturing
local
innovation.
So
I
think
Elica
is
really
another
name
for
innovation
in
this
market
and
cooking.
Strong
distribution
presents,
and
a
strong
brand
awareness.
We
are
also
working
to
establish
Whirlpool
as
a
mass
premium
cooking
brand
in
the
same
segment
so
that
we
have
two
brands

playing
in
the
cooking
space.
If
you
look
at
our
business
results
on
the
revenue,
we've
had
double
digit
CAGR
if
you
look
at
the
last
two
years
and
nine
months
with
strong
margins.
We
were
growing
at
a
revenue
of
21,
22%
in
the
last
two
years.
The
nine
months
to
2023,
2024,
our
revenue
growth
is
coming
to
about
7%,
excuse
me,
while
we

hold
a
very
strong
profit
before
taxes
on
percentage
of
revenue.
Now,
this
revenue
growth
of
7 %
has
been
impacted
by
a
couple
of
things
because
obviously
21
is
going
to
seven,
obviously
there's
a
question
around
what's
going
on.
Well,
firstly,
the
market
has
been
a
little
softer,
I
think
this
year
totally
for
durables
and
definitely
for
cooking
as
well.
And
the
second
thing

that
has
also
happened,
there's
been
a
significant
amount
of
competition
that
has
come
in
influencing
the
marketplace.
Our
strategy
on
Elica
has
been
to
make
sure
that
we
have
a
very
strong
profit
structure
because
that
is
what
will
drive
our
business
in
the
long
term.
And
we
continue
to
do
that
and
we
will
use
other
strategies
like
premiumization,
which
I'll
talk
about
a

second,
to
basically
drive
our
revenue
growth
going
forward.
So
we
expect
to
have
decent
revenue
growth
and
hold
our
profit
structure
on
Elica
as
we
go
forward.
I'll
move
on
to
the
strategic
competitors
that
I
want
to
talk
about,
but
before
I
do
that,
very
quickly,
a
message
from
our
executive
vice
president,
the
chief
financial
officer
of
the
company
who's
also
the
president

of
Asia,
Whirlpool
Mr.
Jim
Peters.
I
read
this
out
to
you,
says,
Whirlpool's
commitment
to
India.
We
truly
believe
in
the
long-term
trajectory
of
India.
It
is
one
of
the
strongest
growth
opportunities
for
the
company.
Whirlpool
of
India's
long-term
outlook
for
growth
in
margins
are
both
in
the
high
single
digits
making
India
very
attractive
to
operate
in.
So
India
is
a
very
important

market
for
Whirlpool
and
I'm
hoping
the
subsequent
slides
are
going
to
show
that
to
you.
What
are
our
strategic
imperatives?
Basically
there
are
■ve,
■rst
inspire
with
our
brands,
t

hen
win
with
product
leadership.
Third
is
to
build
a
competitive
and
resilient
supply
chain.
The
fourth
is
excellence
in
execution.
And
lastly,
grow
our
consumer
direct
business.
I
take
them
one
by
one.
Inspiring

with
our
brands.
If
you
go
back
and
see
our
history
of
when
we
had
our
most
successful
years,
the
analysis
showed
us
that
whenever
we
did
some
heartbreaking
work
in
introducing
something
new
to
the
world,
something
interesting,
those
were
years
in
which
we
had
phenomenal
success.
Just
for
example,
Whirlpool
is
one
that
introduced
pedestals
into
the
Indian
DC
market,
and
today
pedestals
from

a
significant
proportion
of
the
industry,
not
just
Whirlpool.
Whirlpool
was
the
first
to
introduce
auto
defrost
into
the
DC
machines,
providing
a
product
that
would
straddle
between
DC
and
frost
free
in
terms
of
the
benefit
that
was
given.
Whirlpool
was
also
one
of
the
earlier
pioneers
in
colors
and
niches
what
we
call
CFM
in
industry.
Not
only
that,
if
you
go
frost
free,

we
were
the
■rst
to
bring
in
the
three
doors
with
a
prod
outreach.
We
were
the
■rst
to
introduce
dark
interiors
with
the
Platina
edge
that
we
offer
on
some
of
our
models.
We
also
are
the
■rst
to
introduce
heaters
into
the
top
load
washing
machine
area.
So
all
of
these
initiatives
that
were
done
in
the
past
are
based
on
very,
very
solid

consumer
insight
done
by
consumer
generation.
And
all
of
these
not
only
established
our
position
as
one
of
the
leaders,
but
also
inspired
trust
in
our
brands.
And
just
to
move
on
to
what
we
are
doing
in
2024,
I
will
talk
to
you
in
the
product
leadership
segment
about
product
initiatives
that
we're
doing,
which
are
going
to
really
inspire
as
well.
But
very
speci■cally,

there
is
something
very
interesting
that
I
want
to
share
with
you
about
what
we're
doing
from
Jan
2024
onwards.
From
2024
Jan,
we
are
going
to
be
offering
a
four
year
comprehensive
warranty
on
all
the
semi-automatic
washers
that
we
manufacture.
The
genesis
to
this
was
basically
that
we
wanted
to
find
a
way
to
grow
a
share
in
semi-automatic,
but
at
the
same
time

grow
the
semi-automatic
market
as
well.
As
we
looked
into
the
details,
we
asked
ourselves,
what
is
our
point
of
difference?
What
is
that
we
can
hold
onto?
And
the
answer
was
simple.
We
make
a
semi-automatic
washers,
we
have
strong,
strong
faith
and
belief
based
on
data
and
based
on
performance
and
the
quality
of
our
machines.
And
that
is
what
has
prompted
us
to

other.
Typically,
the

market
is
in
about
two
years
on
semi-automatic
washers
from
Jan
2024.

And
by
the
way,
we
had
tried
this
out
in
around
October
2023
on
some
of
our
more
premium
ranges,
and
that
worked
very
well.

So
we
rolled
this
out
in
2024
January
onwards
to
our
entire
range
of
semi-automatic
washers.

So
this
is
now
going
to
be
a
two
plus

two
four
years
comprehensive
warranty,
which
we
believe
is
something
that
will
definitely
inspire
trust
and
hopefully
drive
market
shares
as
well
as
category
penetration.
But
just
move
on
to
product
leadership,
which
is
the
second
strategic
imperative.
Our
product
innovation
is
focused
on
winning
in
premium
segments.
To
be
honest,
between
the
period
of
say
2019
and
2022
we
did
have
a
bit
of
a

challenge
as
I
explained
last
time
in
the
AGM
speech
that
I
made
that
we
could
not
premiumize
our
portfolio
as
well
as
we
would've
wanted
to
do
for
a
variety
of
reasons.
But
starting
2022,
we've
initiated
significant
plans
for
premiumization
of
the
portfolio.
And
just
a
few
examples
that
I'd
like
to
put
in
front
of
you.
On
single
door
refrigerator,
what
I
want

to
also
highlight
is
that
we
have
not
chosen
one
or
two
categories
to
say,
we'll,
premiumize,
we
are
premiumizing
across
every
category
that
we
play.
So
if
you
take
DC
or
direct-cool
single
door
refrigerators,
we
have
introduced
the
■ve
star
rating,
which
is
a
premium
line,
we've
reintroduced
in
quarter
two,
2023
after
two
years
of
not
being
in
the
market,
okay?
But
we're

also
very,
very,
very
proud
to
basically
get
from
the
Honorable
President
of
India,
Shrimati,
Droupadi
Murmu,
the
Appliance
of
the
Year
for
the
refrigerator
category
at
the
National
Energy
Conservation
Awards
in
December,
2023.
And
this
was
a
moment
of
great
pride
for
us.
It
showed
the
quality
of
the
products.
This
was
for
our
215
liter
DC
product,
the
215F
model.
And
I
think

this
also
goes
to
show
the
quality
of
the
products
that
we
basically
make.
So
that
was
in
direct-cool
refrigerators.
If
I
then
move
on
to
fully
automatic
washers,
we've
got
inbuilt
washers
on
most
of
our
fully
automatic
premium
range.
But
starting
January,
2024,
even
in
the
premium
entry
range,
we've
upgraded
the
business
to
soft
close.
The
idea
being,
to
provide
more
benefits
to

the
consumer
who
is
buying
premium
products.
If
I
then
move
on
to
the
front
load
fully
automatic
washers,
we
have
started
making
these
in
India
from
2022.
It's
been
in
the
market
mostly
from
2023.
And
what's
great
about
these
products
is
they
are
not
only
excellent
in
washing
performance,
as
you
would
expect
from
a
totally
automatic
washer
from
a
great
company,
but
they

also
have
this
path
breaking
ozone
refresh
technology.
Now,
what
this
does
is
for
all
your
expensive
clothes,
which
you
maybe
go
for
a
wedding
or
you
go
for
a
party,
wear
it
for
a
couple
of
hours,
say
it's
silk
or
it's
a
suit
or
something,
you
can't
really
wash
it,
you
got
to
send
it
for
dry
cleaning.
But
with
ozone
refresh
technology,
you

can
actually
use
the
ozone
refresh
button
and
we
have
an
ozonizer
in
our
machine,
and
the
advantage
of
this
is
that
it
refreshes
your
clothes
and
removes
all
the
odor
from
it
without
water
or
detergent.
So
this
is
an
added
feature
that
we
give
on
our
fully
automatic
washers
on
top
of
the
benefits
that
we
already
serve.
If
you
then
move
to
frost

free,
I'm
very
happy
to
announce
that
from
mid-2023
onwards,
we've
been
able
to
put
in
the
265
to
360
liter
business,
which
makes
up
the
bulk
of
the
market
in
frost
free.
We
have
introduced
the
fastest
convertibility,
so
it
converts
from
freezer
to
refrigerator
in
just
23
minutes.
We
also
have
a
10
in
one
convertible
mode.
So
both
of
these
facilities
are
available

in
all
our
models
from
265
to
360
liters,
and
it
also
gives
you
a
two
times
longer
vitamin
preservation
for
all
the
food
that
you
store.
So
these
are
cutting
edge
claims
that
we've
been
able
to
put
in
the
market
from
mid-2023
onwards,
and
we
hope
to
reap
the
benefits
of
this
in
the
months,
quarters,
and
years
to
come.
Lastly,
if
I
look

at
semi-automatic
washers,
I
already
spoke
to
you
about
the
additional
two
years
warranty,
which
makes
it
two
plus
two,
four
years
comprehensive
warranty.
I'm
glad
to
announce
that
there
is
a
new
product
coming
soon
in
the
premium
end
of
the
semi-automatic
category.
This
should
be
in
the
market
very
soon,
and
I
cannot
tell
you
more
about
it,
but
I'm
sure
you'll
■nd
it's

a
very
interesting
one
when
you
see
it
in
the
market.
So
the
point
really
in
the
slide
that
I
wanted
to
drive
is
we've
not
picked
one
or
two
categories
in
which
to
premiumize.
We're
premiumizing
across
every
category,
even
in
categories
that
typically
the
market
could
think
of
as
entry-level
categories
like
a
DC
or
a
semi-automatic.
So
because
everything
is
premiumizing.
If
I

then
go
to
Elica,
for
example,
and
this
is
an
example
for
me
of
Elica,
just
a
couple
of
examples
here,
recent
product
introductions.
This
is
the
iS

mart
inverter
kitchen
hood
with
brushless
PC
motors
that
we've
just
introduced.
The
beauty
of
this
is
that
the
consumer
insight
comes
from
the
fact
that
consumers
switch
on
the
gas
or
the
cooktop
and
they
forget
to

switch
on
the
chimney.
So
they
spend
about
15,
20
minutes
cooking
and
then
realize
that
the
chimney
is
not
on,
which
is
obviously
not
helpful.
These
Auto
Sense
chimneys
are
programmed
to
sense
as
soon
as
the
cooktop
comes
on,
so
that
they
start
operating,
directly
saving
the
trouble
for
the
consumer.
So
again,
based
on
a
very
strong
consumer
insight.
And
we've
also
introduced

new
Hexa
IND
Lotus
Series
hobs,
basically.
As
you
can
see,
these
are
heavy
duty
brass,
multi
■ame
burners
with
a
triple
ring
burner.
They've
got
a
beautiful
cast
iron
and
pan
support
with
a
heat
guard,
so
to
avoid
any
chance
of
injury
from
your
side.
And
there
is
a
lifetime
warranty
of
tenure
on
the
burners.
If
I
go
to
the
next
strategic
imperative,

which
is
basically
the
resident
supply
chain,
there
are
two
parts
that
I
would
like
to
talk
about.
The
■rst
is
quality,
the
second
is
cost.
If
I
look
at
quality,
we
follow
the
world
class
manufacturing
practices.
I
had
already
updated
last
time
that
our
Pune
plant
got
the
bronze
in
world
class
manufacturing
in
2021
and
our
Faridabad
plant
got
the
bronze
in
2022.

I'm
extremely
happy
to
announce
that
our
Puducherry
plant
as
well
as
our
third
plant
has
also
got
bronze
in
October,
2023,
and
we
will
continue
this
March
on
the
world
class
manufacturing,
driving
our
quality
more
and
more
ahead
as
we
go
along.
The
other
program
that
we
are
very
proud
of
is
the
P4G
program.
This
is
a
productivity
for
growth,
it's
a
cost

leadership
program,
and
we've
got
a
very,
very
strong
program
that's
already
in
place
that
is
delivering
cost
takeout
across
all
lines
of
the
P&L.
And
this
is
the
program
that
helps
us
improve
gross
margins.
This
is
the
program
that
helps
us
keep
fixed
costs
in
control.
This
is
the
program
that
keeps
variable
costs
in
control,
and
it's
a
full-fixed
program
that's
not
only

driven
by
procurement,
but
across
all
lines
of
the
company.
All
functions
of
the
company
work
to
deliver
this
P4G
program,
which
is
closely
monitored.
And
then
move
on
to
my
favorite
topic,
which
is
excellence
and
execution.
Our
aim
is
to
win
every
day
and
every
store
with
every
consumer.
That
is
the
only
way
in
which
one
can
really
have
hope
to
have
a

leadership
brand.
And
the
reason
why
this

is
important
in
this
business
is
because
consumers
come
into
the
store
and
if
they
walk
out
of
the
refrigerator
and
it's
not
your
brand,
then
you're
out
of
the
market
for
the
next
seven
to
10
years,
maybe
more.
So
it's
very
important
to
win
every
day
and
every
store
with
every
consumer.
How
are
we
going
around

doing
this
in
terms
of
execution?

Firstly,
we
made
sure
across
the
months,
and
we
will
continue
to
do
that
going
forward
to
the
best
of
our
ability
that
we
have
stronger
visibility
of
our
premium
lines.

So
this
is
something
that
we
track
and
we
deliver
on.

We
have
stronger
visibility
of
our
premium
lines,
which
is
what
we
want
to
push
even
further,
as

well
as
our
new
ranges
that
we
brought
in
recently.
Second,
we've
made
sure
that
our
pricing
strategy
is
getting
in
the
right
direction.
Obviously
this
is
a
dynamic
area
and
it
changes
every
month,
and
we
monitor
that
and
act
on
that.
But
we
also
have
looked
at
some
of
our
premium
lines
and
are
looking
and
will
continue
to
look,
are
there
opportunities
to

get
that
part
of
the
strategy
to
drive
more
profitability
for
the
company
and
more
premiumization
for
the
company.
And
that
is
something
that
we're
actively
doing.
The
third
area
is
strongest
sales
execution.
In
the
strongest
sales
execution,
I
mentioned
to
you
about
retail
executives
and
the
work
that
we've
been
doing
on
that
for
the
last
few
months.
So
we
have
put
in
a

reasonably
decent
number
of
incremental
retail
executives.
We
found
the
results
from
that
were
coming
quite
strong
from
a
return
on
investment
point
of
view
and
we
are
driving
that
even
further
as
we
speak.
This
is
something
that
we
are
really
focused
on.
Our
whole
intent
and
our
whole
strategy
is
to
focus
on
return
on
investment
in
whatever
investment
we
make.
Any
money
that

we
put
into
the
market,
we
track
the
ROI
on
and
we
make
sure
that
it's
delivering
on
that
ROI.
If
something
is
very,
very
clear
and
the
ROI
is
coming
through
very
clearly,
then
we
roll
it
out
in
a
very,
very
strong
way.
If
the
ROI
is
not
very
clear
to
us,
then
we
figure
out
what
ROI
is
before
we
put
significant
amount

of
money
behind
everything.
So
that's
a
very
simple
and
straightforward
strategy.
Retail
executive
is
only
one
part
of
it.
There's
many
other
parts
of
sales
execution,
like
the
number
of
billing
points
that
we're
doing,
which
we
track
regularly.
The
displays
that
we
have,
how
we
performing
on
that,
the
amount
of
premium
displays
that
we
have.
As
also
ot

her
than
all
of
these

things,
we've
also
made
a
significant
change
in
our
incentive
plans
for
our
sales
force.
So
this
is
something
that
we
are
changing
from
January,
2024.
It's
already
rolled
out
to
our
sales
force,
but
basically
in
a
nutshell,
our
sales
force
typically
used
to
be
compensated
based
on
national
results.
And
the
second
thing
is
they
were
compensated
based
on
volume
growth
across
categories
now,

from
January,
2024,
and
this
is
why
it's
such
a
significant
change.
The
sales
force
field,
sales
force
incentives
will
be
based
on
what
the
branch
has
achieved,
which
therefore
gives
the
sales
force
much
more
control
over
their
destiny
and
their
results.
And
the
second
thing
is
the
sales
force
is
going
to
be
incentivized
on
front
volume
performance.
And
to
get
that
value
performance,

they
have
to
get
the
volume
also.
So
that's
a
pretty
significant
change
that
we're
doing
from
January,
2024.
We
are
also
leveraging
our
great
customer
relationships
in
terms
of
working
out
top
to
tops,
market
visits,
et
cetera,
across
all
levels
of
the
organization,
not
just
the
sales
guys.
And
lastly,
winning
in
every
store.
It's
not
enough
just
to
win
in
the
online
stores.

It's
also
important
to
win
in
the
online
stores.
So
this
is
something
that
we
started
doing
from
around
July
of
this
year.
We
looked
at
the
e-commerce
business
and
we
saw
that
there
were
significant
opportunities
to
drive
the
e-commerce
business
through
investing
in
e-commerce
marketing
given
its
return
on
advertising
sales
that
we
were
getting.
And
that
is
something
that
we
started
doing
and

we
will
continue
to
do
because
we
continue
to
see
strong
ROI
coming
out
of
that.
If
I
then
shift
gears
to
the
right
half
of
the
screen
and
talk
about
the
NPS
improvements.
Our
NPS
is
significantly
—
NPS
is
basically
net
promoter
score,
and
it
is
based
on
consumer
response
to
our
service
or
installation.
Our
net
promoter
score
has
seen
significant
improvement
across

the
years,
and
it's
now
at
an
all-time
high.
We
will
continue
driving
it
forward.
This
is
based
on
the
fact
that
we've
got
a
very
strong
organization.
We've
got
differentiated
call
centers
with
dedicated
desks
for
premium,
customers
for
top
20
cities
and
escalation
desks.
We
have
enabled
a
lot
of
technology
that
helps
us
avoid
cost
significant
in
certain
areas.
And
we've
also
got

in-house
service
centers
that
we
set
up,
which
not
only
drive
an
excellent
service
experience,
but
al
so
make
■nancial
sense
for
us.
And
of
course,
we
continue
to
drive
D2C.
We
have
got
a
modern
and
scalable
platform
that
we've
built
with
cutting
edge
technologies,
and
we've
got
a
good
operations
platform
in
place.
I'm
now
going
to
hand
over
to
my
colleague,
Aditya
to

talk
about
the
financial
performance.
Aditya
Jain:
Thank
you,
Mr.
Eswar.
Good
afternoon
everyone,
and
let
me
now
take
you
through
our
financial
performance
for
Q3
on
a
standalone
basis.
In
this
quarter,
our
revenue
grew
in
double
digits
at
19.2%.
The
revenue
was
driven
by
a
lot
of
initiatives,
which
Mr.
Eswar
spoke
about
in
his
presentation,
which
was
about
starting
—
at
the
beginning

of
the
year
we
started
with
the
price
reduction
and
the
price
correction
actions,
though
it
had
a
negative
impact
on
the
revenue,
but
we
saw
a
positive
momentum
in
volume
because
of
that.
Subsequently,
there
were
new
product
improvements
in
productions
both
in
DC,
frost
free
and
other
parts
of
the
portfolio
also,
the
impact
of
which
is
visible
in
this
quarter's
revenue
growth.
And

then
there's
a
lot
of
investment
on
the
sales
execution
side
as
well,
be
it
Aris,
be
it
the
display
compliances,
be
it
the
focus
on
the
premium
mix,
premium
lines
and
the
high
DCM
SKUs,
et
cetera,
et
cetera,
and
the
customer
relationships.
As
a
result
of
this,
we've
seen
some
benefit
of
all
these
actions
translating
into
revenue
growth.
In
addition
to
that,
the

current
quarter
has
also
benefited
from
the
timing
of
the
Diwali
Festival
as
Diwali
this
year
was
in
November
versus
October
last
year.
And
hence
we've
seen
a
phasing
of
volumes
moving
from
September
up
to
October
this
year.
And
the
benefit
of
this
flowing
through
in
the
revenue
growth
in
the
current
quarter.
What
has
happened
is
as
a
result
of
all
these
cumulative
actions

that
has
happened
throughout
2023,
we've
seen
a
sequential
improvement
in
our
revenue
growth
trends
and
momentum
across
key
categories
of
a
business,
i.e.,
both
refrigerators
and
washers
grew
in
high
double
digits
in
this
quarter.
Moving
on
to
pro■ts,
our
EBITDA
came
in
at
39
crore
at
2.8%.
That's
105%
growth
versus
a
year
ago.
And
our
PBT
came
in
at
22
crore
at
1.6%.

That's
a
35%
growth
versus
a
year
ago.
The
improvement
in
profit
was
driven
by
the
strong
volume
growth,
the
actions,
very,
very
focused
actions
on
driving
the
high
margin
premium
SKUs
product
mix
and
the
cost
productivity
supported
by
the
strong
P4G
that's
productivity
for
growth

the
program
which
helped
us
save
cost
across
most
line
items
of
the
P&L,
and
the
impact
of
decrease

in
commodity
prices
as
well.
All
these
things
have
helped
both
then
on ■ set
the
impact
of
price
production,
which
we
took
at
the
beginning
of
the
year,
and
the
regulatory
cost
of
charges
on
the
refrigerator
business,
which
we
had
to
absorb
in
the
P&L
during
the
year.
Coming
to
cash,
cash
is
a
good
story.
We
generated
470
crores
cash
from
operating
activities
for
the

nine months ended December, 2023. And this cash was generated predominantly by improvement in working capital on accounts receivable and inventory management. With this cash generation, our balance sheet becomes even healthier with a very strong cash position, and this allows us the flexibility to invest in the right product innovation and projects to drive growth and value creation for the shareholders. With this, I'll pass

it
back
to
Mr.
Eswar
for
the
closing
piece.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Thank
you,
Aditya.
So
just
last
couple
of
slides,
but
quickly
on
this
is,
I
just
wanted
to
walk
you
through
the
market
share
trends,
basically.
So
this
is
basically
refrigerators
and
washers
market
share.
Just
stay
with
me
as
I
walk
you
through
the
slide.
There
are
three
time
periods
here
that
we've
called

out,
October
2022
to
March
2023,
April
2023
to
September
2023,
and
October
2023
to
December
2023.
The
market
itself
was
growing
in
October
2022
to
March
2023
by
mid-single
digit
growth.
Whirlpool
of
India
had
quite
significant
challenges
and
impacted
by
the
price
index
challenges
in
October
to
December
of
2022.
We
lost
a
significant
amount
of
share.
We
took
a
price
correction
in
Jan

to
March,
2023,
as
I
said,
and
we
also
launched
our
new
direct
code
ranges
into
the
market
between
Jan
and
March,
2023.
It
was
still
continuing
to
lose
share
versus
year
ago
from
a
volume
market
share
point
of
view.
In
April
2023
to
September
2023,
the
market
was
■attish
to
slightly
declining
in
terms
of
volume
and
we
were
able
to
do
a
couple

of
things.
One
is
in
addition
to
the
direct
cool
ranges,
our
frost
free
range
upgrades
also
got
into
place.
This
is
the
product
I
was
showing
you
earlier.
So
that
got
to
the
market
between,
call
it
April
and
June,
July,
2023.
We
also
started
focusing
very
signi■cantly
on
the
execution,
stepping
up
the
execution
across
these
months
and
setting
the
stall
for
that.
Our

volume
market
share
started
declining
a
lot
less
compared
t

o
year
ago
during
this
time
period.

In
October
2023
to
December
2023,
the
market
continues

to
grow
by
a
very
low
single
digit
growth.

But
we've
been
able
to
start
getting
positive
on

the
volume
market
share
of
the
year
on
year
as
the

additional
retail
educators
that
we
put
in,
they
started
functioning
fully

at
the
pace
at
which
—
because
they
need
a
little
time
to
wrap
up
and
so
at
the
pace
at
which
they're
supposed
to
wrap
up.
So
we're
happy
with
that
as
well
as
the
impact
that's
coming
from
all
the
new
products
that
we've
got
into
the
markets
as
well
as
the
mixed
drive
that
we
want
to
take
them
strategically.
So
that's
basically

the
market
share
trend
that
we
have
so
far.
And
I'm
just
going
to
close
with
my
last
slide
before
we
open
up
for
questions,
is
how
are
we
going
to
deliver
sustainable
and
profitable
growth
over
the
long
term?
I
take
you
back
to
the
same
■ve
strategic
imperatives
inspired
with
our
brands.
If
I
look
at
this,
it's
very
clear
that
in
the
best

years,
we
had
superior
consumer
insights
and
these
superior
consumer
insights
is
what
we're
going
to
focus
on
starting
from
now.
We're
going
to
go
out
and
figure
out
how
to
get
the
best
consumer
insights
that
drive
two
things,
one,
best
in
class
innovation,
like
some
of
the
stuff
that
you
saw.
But
the
second
area
is
best
in
class
communication,
which
is
how
do

we
tell
this
news
to
the
consumer,
whether
it
be
through
impact
stickers,
whether
it
be
through
our
retail
executives,
whether
it
be
through
other
forms
of
communication.
Second,
product
leadership.
We
will
continue
to
overdrive
premiumization.
We
will
also
look
to
■ fill
gaps
in
our
core
categories,
but
the
intent
is
really
to
deliver
winning
products
across
the
board.
The
third
area
will
be
resilient

supply
chain.
We
will
continue
to
drive
the
quality
of
our
products
up
through
WCM.
We
will
continue
to
drive
P4G
in
a
very
strong
way.
P4G
is
our
defense
against
any
chaos
that
can
happen
in
the
market.
And
we
will
keep
ourselves
focused
on
what
we
can
control
to
improve
margins
as
we
go
along.
The
fourth
area
is
executional
excellence.
We're
going
to

focus
both
on
driving
reach,
which
means
covering
more
stores
across
the
country
and
extraction,
which
means
getting
more
from
each
store
within
the
country,
getting
more
from
each
display
through
a
lot
of
focus
on
sales
and
marketing
execution,
including
a
best
in
class
retail
executive
program
that
focuses
on
the
quantity
of
retail
executi
ves
that
we
have,
the
quality
of
retail
executives
that

we
have,
and
more
importantly,
their
retention
because
that's
a
major
variable.
And
lastly,
we
will
grow
the
consumer
direct
business
ahead
of
the
industry.
We
believe
that
these
things
should
be
able
to
get
us
over
the
long
term,
a
high
single
digit
revenue
CAGR
with
a
high
single
digit
PBT
margin
percentage
over
the
long
term,
over
multi
years.
Yeah.
So
that's
all
I

wanted
to
share.
Happy
to
pass
over
to
Roopali
again.
Roopali
Singh:
Thank
you,
Mr.
Eswar
and
Mr.
Jain.
With
that,
I
hand
over
the
proceedings
back
to
the
Operator
for
commencing
the
Q&A
session,
please.
Operator:
Thank
you,
Ms.
Roopali.
I
request
analysts
to
press
star
one
to
ask
their
questions.
In
the
interest
of
time,
please
limit
your
question
to
one
and
one
follow

up
question.
In
case
during
the
call
you
face
any
technical
difficulties,
then
please
reach
out
to
the
help
desk,
email
IDs
are
communicated
to
you
via
email.
Our
first
question
is
from
Aniruddha
Joshi.
I
request
Aniruddha,
ask
your
question.
Aniruddha
Joshi:
Yeah.
Thanks
for
the
opportunity.
Sir,
really
thankful
for
the
presentation,
but
just
wanted
to
understand
the
guidance
part
of
it
is
high

single
digit
revenue
CAGR
in
an
economy,
which
itself
is
bringing
double
digits
in
nominal
GDP.
So
while
we're
in
a
way
looking
for
high
single
digit
revenue
CAGR
and
then
secondly,
in
an
industry
where
various
players
like
[inaudible]
Bosch
or
[inaudible],
many
players
are
doing
business
at
innovative
losses
or
investments.
So
how
do
you
see
the
margins
going
forward?
We
used
to
generate

more
than
10,
11%
margins,
now
it
has
come
down
significantly
in
mid-single
digits.
So
do
you
see
it
going
back
to
the
historical
level?
And
last
question
from
my
side,
in
the
parent's
annual
report
in
CY
2022,
India
growth
was
a
key
agenda.
Now,
we
see
the
parent
wants
to
sell
a
24%
stake.
So
what
is
the
broad
level
thinking
that
has
changed

at
the
global
level?
Yeah.
That's
it
from
my
side.
Thanks.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Got
it.
Thank
you,
Mr.
Joshi,
really
appreciate.
Sir,
do
we
have
the
three
questions
written
down?
Aditya
Jain:
GDP
normal
at
double
digit,
so
are
we
planning
to
run
single
digits
on
position
operating
at
negative
margins.
So
we
were
at
10,
11%
margin.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Okay.
Yeah.
Got
it.
Sorry,
I

was
just
trying
to
note
down
the
question.

So
in
terms
of

—

Mr.
Joshi,
the
way
we
look
at
this
is
we
are
looking
from
whe

re
we
are
and
looking
forward,
and
we
are
trying
to
get
an
assessment
of
how
quickly
and
how
far
we'll
go.

We
recognize
that
it's
a
very
competitive
market.

We
recognize
that
competition
is
going
to
be
there.

It's
not
going
away.
We
recognize
where
we
are
basically.
And
going
forward,
this
is
the
guidance
that
we
give
in
terms
of
the
growth.
You
see,
like
I
said,
we
have
to
operate
from
where
we
see
right
now
what
things
are.
While
the
GDP
might
be
growing
significantly,
the
durables
industry
is
not
growing
significantly
as
of
now.
So
we
factor
all
these
things

when
we
are
given
the
guidance.
Obviously,
if
other
things
change,
then
our
guidance
will
also
change
in
the
future.
But
at
this
point
in
time,
based
on
what
we
see
of
what's
happening
with
the
market
on
durables,
with
the
competitive
situation,
et
cetera,
this
is
the
best
guidance
that
we
would
give.
So
that's
the
answer
to
the
■rst
question.
The
second
question
is

on
margins.
So
the
answer
to
your
question
is
I
think
double
digit
margins
for
me,
as
I
look
at
it,
it's
going
to
be
quite
challenging
for
anyone
to
go
to
the
double
digit
margin.
As
we
look
across
the
industry
from
whatever
we
can
see,
nobody's
operating
anywhere
near
that.
There
have
been
a
lot
of
players
who
have
come
in,
there
are
headwinds

from
competition.
There's
also
headwinds,
as
you
can
imagine,
from
regulatory
requirements
that
will
come
going
forward.
So
do
I
see
the
best
players
operating
at
double
digit
margins?
I
would
say
it's
a
little
challenging
to
even
imagine
that.
But
I
would
say
a
high
single
digit
margin
is
something
over
the
long
term
that
one
can
aspire
towards.
Keep
in
mind
that
the
competition

is
the
one
piece
that
keeps
the
whole
thing
going.
And
the
second
thing,
of
course,
like
I
said,
is
every
regulatory
change
costs
a
significant
amount
of
money.
And
we
can
expect
regulatory
to
increase
as
we
go
along.
And
that's
the
direction
that
we've
seen
or
got
from
whatever
we've
seen
from
the
government.
So
given
those
things,
my
personal
view
is
that
double

digit
margins
are
going
to
be
very
challenging
for
anybody
to
get
to,
high
single
digit
margin
is
the
guidance
that
we
are
giving.
So
that's
the
answer
to
your
second
question.
The
third
one,
the
24 %
stake,
I
think,
just
to
be
clear,
the
Whirlpool
of
India
—
So
■rst
of
all,
nothing
has
changed
from
the
point
of
view
of
India's
importance
to
Whirlpool

Cooperation,
nothing
at
all.
What
actually
is
the
situation

is
very
simply
that
the
global
Whirlpool
Corporation
has
decided
to
sell
up
to
24 %
of
its
stake.

So
to
go
from
75 %
up
to
at
least
51 %,
that
is
basically
the
decision
from
the
Whirlpool
Global
Corporation.

What
is
the
idea?
The
idea
is
that
the
Whirlpool
Corporation
will
continue
to
hold
the
majority
interest
in

the
company.
And
India
is
supremely
very,
very
important
for
Whirlpool
Corporation
from
a
global
point
of
view,
as
you
saw
from
Jim
Peter's
message.
Why
is
the
Whirlpool
Corporation
doing
this?
It
has
very
clearly
stated
this
in
its
US
notice
that
was
released
to
the
Indian
market
as
well
followed
by
communication
from
our
side
as
well,
that
basically
the
proceeds
from
this
will

be
used
to
retire
debt
at
the
Whirlpool
Corporation
level,
and
that
is
the
sole
purpose
of
this
effort.
So
from
the
the
Whirlpool
Global
Cooperation
side,
there
is
no
change,
if
anything
at
all,
there's
even
more
of
a
focus
to
make
sure
that
India
is
very
strong
and
continues
to
be
stronger
as
we
go
forward
with
respect
to
investments
and
technology,
innovation,
et
cetera,

et
cetera.
But
this
is
being
done
by
the
Whirlpool
Corporation
to
retire
its
debt
so
that
debt
retirement
can
then
open
up
the
company
to
invest
further
and
further
as
we
go
along,
because
less
debt
driven
company
is
always
a
better
thing.
Thank
you.
Roopali
Singh:
We
move
to
the
next
question.
Operator:
Once
again,
to
ask
a
question,
please
press
star
one.
We

will
take
our
next
question
from
Renu
Baid
Cugalia,
please
go
ahead.
Renu
Baid
Cugalia:
Yeah.
Good
evening
and
thanks
for
the
opportunity.
The
■rst
question
is,
if
you
look
at
the
last
three
years
performance
of
Whirlpool
in
the
market,
there
have
been
consistent
share
loss
as
well
as
erosion
of
pro■tability.
So
probably
we
are
now
already
somewhere
at
the
bottom.
Incremental
share
loss

definitely
should
not
be
there.
And
you
did
highlight
some
gains
in
the
year
until
date.
So
can
you
quantify
what
has
been
our
current
market
share
across
some
of
the
key
categories?
And
what
is
the
targeted
share
that
we
are
looking
for
over
the
next
two
to
four
years
driving
various
strategies
of
premiumization,
more
of
sales,
marketing,
incentives?
That's
the
first
question.
Second,

on
the
strategies
to
drive
innovation
and
consumer
insights
overall,
what
is
the
budgetary
spend
that
we
are
targeting
on
R&D
and
new
product
introduction?
And
does
that
already
bake
in
your
assumption
of
high
sing
le
digit
margins
when
you're
guiding
over
the
medium
term?
And
lastly,
with
respect
to
the
portfolio
of
Elica,
larger
or
other
smaller
appliances
companies
are
now
diversified
with
M&A

in
this
space,
in
cooktops,
in
chimneys.
And
some
of
them
have
seemingly
in
the
early
stages,
a
good
foothold
in
the
premium
segment.
So
what
has
been
our
journey
here
and
how
do
we
propose
to
tackle
the
competitive
pressures
and
yet
drive
double
digit
growth
back
in
the
grouping
portfolio,
which
has
been
soft
this
year
so
far,
along
with
margin
expansion?
Thank
you.

Narasimhan
Eswar:
Thanks
a
lot.
Thank
you
so
much
for
your
question.
The
■rst
thing
is,
in
terms
of
share
growth.
So
we
have
directionally
speaking,
strong
—
we've
got
double
digit
shares
across
pretty
much
most
of
our
portfolio.
We
are
especially
strong
in
the
direct
cool
refrigerator
business
and
we
are
quite
strong
in
the
washers
as
well.
Frost
free
is
where
we
have

more
opportunity
to
improve
as
we
go
along.
And
with
the
products
that
we
have,
I'm
con■dent
that
share
growth
with
the
execution
focus
should
come
through.
In
terms
of
the
next
few
years,
if
you
can
think
about
it,
while
I
don't
want
to
give
a
speci■c
number
because
that's
very
internal
in
our
planning
and
so
on
and
so
forth.
I
think
if
you

talk
about
long
term,
like
you
said,
four
years,
you
could
call
that
long
term.
If
you
say
four
years,
then
you're
looking
at
growing
the
share
because
otherwise,
it's
quite
unlikely
to
be
able
to
grow
high
single
digits
without
growing
the
shares.
So
share
growth
is
certainly
part
of
our
whole
story.
And
we
are
very
clear
on
how
we're
planning
to
do
that,

which
is
through
all
of
the
steps
that
I
highlighted
to
you
in
the
presentation.
So
yes,
to
answer
your
question,
share
growth
is
very
much
part
of
the
story
across
the
next
four
years.
Now,
on
the
budgetary
spend
on
R&D
and
new
product
introductions,
yeah,
absolutely.
I
think
we
take
that
into
account
when
we
talk
to
you
about
anything
of
that
sort.
Very

much
so
and
X
factor
into
our
financials
and
our
calculations
as
we
speak
to
you,
also
because
in
this
category,
the
amount
of
money
you
spend
on
R&D
and
new
product
reduction
has
to
be
calculated
because
it
is
quite
a
significant
impact.
So
that
answered
your
second
question,
very
much
considered
yes.
Thirdly,
on
Elica,
I
think
yes,
there
is
a
lot
of
competitive

pressure,
but
we
want
to
improve
our
business
or
drive
our
business
financially
res

possibly
with
Elica.
And
I
think
that's
very
important
for
us.
So
we're
not
doing
any
short-termism
in
our
thinking.
Without
going
into
a
lot
of
detail,
we're
also
aware
of
several
other
impacts
that
will
come
into
this
business
as
we
go
forward
and
we
are
readying
ourselves
for
that.
I

think
there
is
something
really
special
about
a
company
that
has
got
it
set
up
here
locally
that
can
actually
do
stu■,
that
can
actually
manufacture
stu■,
that
can
put
together
stu■
and
set.
And
in
a
lot
of
industries,
a
lot
of
players
can
come
in
and
import
and
get
away
with
it
for
some
time,
but
I
think
it's
probably
di■cult
to
get
away

with
it
for
a
very
long
span
of
time.
So
I
think
we've
got
to
stick
to
our
strategy,
we've
got
to
stick
to
the
high
quality
of
products
that
we
produce.
We
will
not
compromise
on
that.
And
we
continue
to
believe
that
driving
the
right
products
and
the
right
innovation
is
what
will
basically
help
us
tackle
these
competitive
pressures,
which
will
come
and

go.
A
lot
of
people
—
Yeah.
That's
about
it.
Thanks.
Roopali
Singh:
Thank
you,
Renu.
We
move
to
the
next
question,
please.
Operator:
The
next
question
is
from
Abhijit
Akella.
I
request
Abhijit,
ask
your
question.
Abhijit
Akella:
Thank
you
very
much.
Good
evening,
and
thanks
for
the
opportunity.
So
for
me,
just
a
couple
of
data
points
if
it's
possible
to
share.
One
is

the
revenue
breakdown
across
our
product
categories,
the
key
ones,
if
it's
possible
to
share
that.
Also,
any
sense
of
volumes
that
you
could
share,
that
would
be
great.
And
in
terms
of
the
production
capacities
that
exist
right
now,
are
there
any
significant
CapEx
plans
that
you
have
to
expand
these?
And
one
■nal
thing
is
just
a
rough
sense
of
sales
mixed
by
channel.

These
will
be
great
to
have.
Thank
you
so
much.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Thank
you.
Thanks,
Abhijit.
I
think
we're
not
really
planning
to
give
out
the
details
across
categories
and
so
on
and
so
forth,
other
than
what
we've
shared
so
far,
to
be
honest
with
you.
Like
I
said,
our
shares
are
higher
in
DC,
strong
in
washers.
Frost
free
is
the
one
where
the

opportunity
is
still
there
that
we
can
grow
signi■cantly.
And
of
course,
if
you
look
at
front
load
washing
machines,
again,
that's
a
place
where
the
opportunity
is
very,
very
signi■cant
for
us
because
we've
just
launched
in
2022.
So
as
you
can
imagine,
our
shares
are
quite
low,
and
therefore
the
opportunity
to
grow
there
is
very,
very
signi■cant.
Excuse
me.
I
can
tell
you

th
at
refrigerators
are
more
than
55%
of
our
business.
Washer
is
about
30
odd
percent
of
our
business
and
other
categories
put
together,
make
up
the
rest.
And
Elica
is
outside
of
this,
of
course,
and
Elica's
numbers
you
have
already.
That's
with
respect
to
the
volumes
and
the
value.
On
the
production
capacities,
I
think
your
question
where
you're
leading
to
is,
is
there

any
massive
CapEx
that
we
plan?
Well,
to
be
honest,
we
are
reasonably
well
covered
for
now.
And
more
importantly,
we
factor
these
into
our
financial
planning
as
we
go
forward.
So
when
we're
giving
you
the
guidance,
we've
made
sure
that
capacity
planning
for
factories
is
very
much
included
in
our
financials.
So
we've
done
that
mathematics
to
say,
when
do
we
need
capacities
in

which
factory,
at
which
plan
of
time
across
the
next
seven
years?
And
we've
taken
that
into
account
already.
So
that
should
be
okay.
Roopali
Singh:
Yeah.
Thank
you,
Mr.
Abhijit.
If
we
would
move
to
the
next
question.
Operator:
We'll
take
our
next
question
from
Niraj
Jain.
Please
go
ahead,
Niraj.
Niraj
Jain:
Yeah.
Hi.
Thank
you
for
the
opportunity.
So
sir,
my
■rst
question

is,
may
I
know
an
approximate
contribution
that
is
currently
being
driven
from
the
premium
portfolio
especially
that
was
launched
in
2020?
Secondly,
I
want
to
know
like
from
a
longer
term
perspective,
what
is
the
company
strategy
behind
its
brand
building?
We
have
been
seeing
a
decline
in
ad
spends
consistently
over
the
last
three,
four
years,
while
at
the
same
time
the
peers,
especially

the
unlisted
peers,
have
been
very
quite
aggressive.
So
any
strategy
on
how
are
we
planning
to
increase
the
ad
spends,
especially
when
we
are
expecting
margins
to
continue
being
in
single
digit
on
the
account
of
competition?
And
lastly,
I
want
to
know
if
some
royalty
and
technical
know-how
fees
have
been
consistent
at
around
1.5%
over
the
years.
May
I
know
if
there
is

any
tenure
for
this
engagement
and
any
revision
that
can
be
expected
in
any
time
soon,
especially
with
the
change
and
the
parent
company
ownership
stake
going
ahead?
That's
it.
Thank
you.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Thanks
a
lot,
Niraj.
On
the
premium
portfolio,
well,
I
can't
give
you
a
percentage.
Basically,
I
can
tell
you
that
the
premium
portfolio,
■rst
of
all
are
shares
typically
in
our

entry
level
portfolio
of
anything
like
DC
or
frost
free
or
anything.
Shares
usually
the
entry
level
are
higher,
typically.
So
the
significant
opportunit

y
for
us
to
increase
the
premium
portfolio
going
forward,
it
has
been
going
in
the
right
direction
in
the
last
few
months.
And
the
second
thing
is
our
focus
is
very
much
on
that
premium
portfolio.
So
A,
we
have
a

runway
to
grow
in
that
premium
portfolio
because
Whirlpool
is
a
very
well-known
brand
to
all
these
people.
But
it
still
doesn't
have
its
kind
of,
say
fair
share
with
respect
to
the
premium
portfolio.
And
we're
seeing
it
more
in
the
right
direction
because
of
the
focus
that
we're
putting
on
premiumization
in
terms
of
the
business.
So
whether
I
take
direct-cool,
DC
refrigerators,
or

I
take
frost
free
or
I
take
even
semi-automatic
washing
machines
where
we
have
a
lot
of
strengths
or
top
load
washing
machines,
for
example,
we
definitely
have
opportunities
to
grow
in
the
premium
portfolio
significantly
compared
to
the
entry
portfolio
opportunity.
So
our
plan
is
to
leverage
this
to
really
drive
the
premium
portfolio
shares.
And
there
has
been
a
movement,
like
I
said,
in

the
right
direction
on
these
categories.
The
second
question
that
you
talked
about
is
on
brand
building,
strategy
on
management.
It's
a
great
question.
The
way
we
look
at
how
we're
spending
right
now
from
where
we
are,
and
I
want
to
be
transparent
about
it,
is
we
need
to
make
sure
we're
spending
on
the
right
things
from
where
we
are.
Our
current
focus
is

to
spend
on
things
that
can
drive
a
solid
return
on
investment,
basically.
So
if
I
put
in
money,
I
should
get
a
return
on
investment
that's
clearly
visible.
Where
it
is
clearly
visible,
we're
going
and
investing
in
a
very
big
way.
So
I
talked
to
you
about
retail
executives.
Now,
retail
executives,
very
frankly,
are
a
lot
about
brand
building
as
well,
because
you're

talking
here
about
thousands
of
people
on
the
shop
floor
who
are
talking
about
your
brand
and
its
benefits
to
your
consumers.
And
these
are
the
people
who
help
you
get
your
sales,
but
also
help
the
consumer
make
the
right
choice.
So
if
you
look
at
the
amount
of
effort
we're
spending
on
it,
not
just
in
terms
of
the
number
of
people
that
we're

hiring,
but
also
in
terms
of
the
money
we're
spending
on
the
quality
training
of
these
people
which
I
would
say
is
really,
really
good.
And
also
on
the
retention
programs,
we
are
investing
a
lot.
And
the
reason
we're
investing
a
lot
is
very
simple.
It's
because
it's
a
solid
ROI
on
everything
else,
like
I
said.
And
similar
is
a
thing
for
me
on

e-commerce
marketing,
for
example,
where
we
can

see
the
solid
ROI
we're
investing.

We
will
at
a
point
in
time
in
the
future
come
to
a
place
where
we
will,
again,
continue

to
have,
I
think
a
lot
of
levers.
We
continue
to
have

a
lot
of
levers
in
which
you
can
invest.

It's
very
difficult
to
invest
in
all
the
levers
at
the
same
time.

So
each
of
these
levers
and
brand
building,
as
we
traditionally
call
it,
advertising
is
one
of
those
levers.
Similarly,
we'll
adopt
a
similar
approach,
which
is
to
figure
out
the
ROI
through
a
methodology.
And
once
we
figure
out
the
ROI,
we
will
invest
at
the
right
time
into
that
as
well.
In
the
meantime,
we
are
driving
our
brand
very
strongly
compared
to
what

we
were
doing
some
time
ago
through
whatever
we're
doing
in
the
stores,
which
is
actually
the
single
biggest
point
of
influence
for
purchase.
A
massive
number
of
decisions
of
purchase
are
actually
made
in
the
store.
And
through
e-commerce
marketing,
which
we're
doing
right
now,
we
are
doing
our
digital
communication,
digital
marketing,
as
well
as
e-commerce
marketing.
So
that
part
of
it
is
happening.

Other
levers,
and
there
are
many
levers
to
drive
the
business,
to
drive
the
sales,
to
drive
the
revenue
and
the
profits,
as
well
as
to
drive
market
share.
Large
scale
advertising
is
one
of
those
levers.
We
will
look
at
it
at
the
right
time,
evaluate
it
with
the
right
ROI,
prove
the
ROI,
and
then
we'll
expand
it.
That
is
the
second
part.
So

certainly
it's
a
part
of
our
future
plans,
but
it'll
be
done
at
the
right
time
and
with
the
right
ROI.
The
third
thing,
I'm
going
to
defer
to,
Aditya.
Aditya
Jain:
Yeah.
And
Niraj,
in
reference
to
your
question,
whether
royalty
or
technical
know-how
fees,
which
is
paid
to
the
parent,
will
it
change
as
a
result
of
the
change
in
stake?
The
answer
to

this
question
is
we
do
not
anticipate
any
change
in
the
royalty
and
technical
know-how
percentages
as
a
result
of
the
shareholding
pattern.
So
we
anticipate
you
to
continue
at
the
same
levels.
Roopali
Singh:
Thank
you,
Niraj.
With
that,
we'll
move
to
the
next
question,
please.
Operator,
can
we
move
to
the
next
question,
please.
Operator:
The
next
question
is
from
Bhavin.
Please
go
ahead.

Bhavin:
Thank
you
so
much
for
the
presentation.
First
one
is
a
request
for
a
greater
frequency
of
investor
interaction
through
quarterly
earnings
calls
and
analyst
days.
We
understand
business
ups
and
downs,
but
any
interaction
channel
being
open
helps
us
immensely.
The
question
that
I
have,
one,
is
your
strate

gy
of
premiumization.
And
one
of
the
disadvantage
that
I
believe
is
that
your
peers,

like
LG
or
Samsung
have
larger
manufacturing
facilities
across
Asia.
So
that
puts
Whirlpool
through
three
types
of
disadvantages.
A,
is
the
cost.
B
is
the
frequency
of
refreshes,
and
three
is
in
terms
of
number
of
SKUs
because
they
have
a
greater
scale.
So
how
do
you
plan
to
mitigate
this
and
increase
your
share
in
the
premium
space?
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Thank
you,
Bavin.
On

your
two
points,
the
■rst
one
is
the
greater
frequency
of
interactions.

A
point
well
noted.
I
came
in
about
10
months
ago,
so
it
took
a
little
bit
of
time
for
me
to
understand
all
the
factors
and
the
business
and
the
people
and
everything
else.

So
I
think
this
is
the
■rst
time
we're
interacting
with
you.
We
did
have
an
AGM
in
August

where
we
spoke
to
all
the
shareholders.
So
yes,
we
will
certainly
take
that
into
consideration
as
we
go
along.
Thank
you
for
that
suggestion.
In
terms
of
the
manufacturing
facilities,
I
would
say,
to
be
honest
with
you,
it's
not
something
that
concerns
us
at
all
because
the
way
we
look
at
it
is
that
we're
a
global
cooperation.
We've
got
products
and
designs
and

engineering
structural
knowledge
that
comes
from
multiple
markets,
whether
from
North
America,
from
Latin
America,
from
parts
of
Europe
where
we
have
technology,
parts
of
Asia
where
we
have
technology,
and
of
course
in
India.
So
we've
got
access
to
global
technology,
global
knowledge,
global
scale
in
several
areas
of
engineering
and
manufacturing.
Secondly,
we've
got
three
world
class
plants
here.
As
I
told
you,
we've

got
WCM
bronze
ratings
in
all
three
plants.
And
as
you
know,
the
WCM
ratings
are
not
just
for
certain
parts,
it's
to
do
with
the
completely
comprehensive
and
full
scale
assessment
of
the
ability
of
a
plant
to
deliver
products
with
great
quality,
cost
and
safety.
So
I
would
say
that
from
our
landscape,
do
we
have
enough
to
basically
deliver
the
products
that
we

need?
Absolutely.
These
are
the
plants
that
have
delivered
the
national
award
winning
world
class
DC
refrigerator
that
I
spoke
to
you
about.
These
are
the
same
plants
that
have
basically
come
up
with
the
fastest
convertible
in
the
market
in
23
minutes.
These
are
the
same
plants
that
have
come
up
with
the
heater
technology.
So
I
do
believe
that
we
are
well
served.
We

have
enough
identified
and
invested
at
the
right
time
to
make
sure
we
have
enough
capacity,
we
have
enough
flexibility
i

n
our
market.
Actually,
my
key
focus
would
be
on
really
driving
the
demand.
That
I
think
is
what
we
really
need
to
do.
To
be
honest,
I'm
not
really
worried
about
the
supply
part
of
it
at
all.
There
will
always
be
some
gaps

in
the
categories
like
I
spoke
of
in
my
presentation,
and
we
will
certainly
look
to
■ll
them
as
we
go
along.
There
will
be
capital
decisions
that
we
need
to
make
and
so
on
and
so
forth,
and
those
will
be
taken
and
done
at
the
appropriate
time.
So
I
would
say
from
our
side,
we're
not
at
all
worried
about
this,
and
with
more

and
more,
making
India
happening.
I
think
it's
only
right
that
we
make
all
our
products
out
of
here.
So
almost
all
our
portfolio
is
basically
made
out
of
here.
Even
the
categories
that
we
may
not
ourselves
make,
which
will
be
very
small,
we
source
them
from
Indian
producers.
So
we
have
very,
very
small
import
dependency.
And
I
would
say
if
you
have
a

massive
import
dependency,
you
should
probably
think
about
it
twice.
Roopali
Singh:
Thank
you,
Mr.
Bhavin.
With
that
we'll
move
to
the
next
question,
please.
Operator:
The
next
question
is
from
Yash
Jain.
I
request
Yash
Jain
to
ask
your
question.
Roopali
Singh:
Request
Mr.
Yash
Jain
from
Ambit
to
please
unmute
and
ask
the
question.
Yash
Jain:
Hello?
Am
I
on
mute?
Roopali
Singh:
Yes,

Mr.
Jain.
Yash
Jain:
Hello?
Roopali
Singh:
Yes,
Mr.
Jain,
we
can
hear
you.
Yash
Jain:
Okay.
Yeah.
Well,
I'm
saying
while
we
do
have
the
manufacturing
facilities,
but
have
we
considered
outsourcing
about
some
of
our
categories
that
can
help
in
saving
costs?
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Sorry,
I
just
want
to
be
clear
I
understood
your
question,
you're
saying,
are
we
considering
outsourcing
on
some
of

our
categories
where
it'll
help
cost,
is
the
question?
Yash
Jain:
Yes.
Right.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Great.
Thanks,
Joshi.
Yes.
So
in
categories
where
we
■nd
that
we
can
get
reasonably
competitively
priced
products
to
our
speci■cations
because
Whirlpool
has
very
clear
and
demanding
speci■cations,
then
we
have
no
problems
in
outsourcing
it.
A
classic
example
is
air
conditioners
where
we
don't
manufacture
them
ourselves.
We
get

good
products
to
our
specifications,
which
are
quite
exacting,
and
we
get
that.
Similarly
for
microwave
ovens,
we
don't
manufacture
that
ourselves,
and
we
basically
get
that
done
through
third
party
suppliers.
So
yes,
absolutely
that's
part
of
the
strategy.
But
where
I've
got
capacity
and
I've
got
the
expertise
and
I've
got
a
good
cost
base
on
refrigerators
and
washers,
again,
the
answer
is
not,

no,
it's
never
no,
but
there
has
to
be
a
really
solid
reason
as
to
why
we'd
go
out,
because
the
cost
has
to
really
work
for
us.
The
cost
benefit
has
to
be
significant
for
us
to
consider
doing
that.
As
you
can
imagine,
every
time
you
don't
make
it
in
your
factory,
you
will
incur
a
bit
of
a
hit.
So
you
have
to

look
at
that
versus
the
benefit
that
you
get
financially
from
anybody
else.
So
I'd
say
we
are
sorted
for
now
on
this.
If
there
are
opportunities
that
come
up,
which
are
significant
and
long
term,
we
have
no
problem
looking
at
it.
But
we
just
focus
on
the
core
categories,
we
keep
it
internal.
Roopali
Singh:
Thank
you.
With
that,
we
move
to
the
next

question
from
Ms.
Natasha
Jain,
we
would
request
to
please
unmute
yourself
and
speak.
Natasha
Jain:
Hello?
Am
I
audible?
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Yes,
please.
Natasha
Jain:
Yeah.
Thank
you
for
the
opportunity
and
thank
you
for
the
detailed
presentation,
sir,
I
have
two
questions.
One
is
on
product
leadership.
So
if
I
observe
your
market
share,
and
especially
the
channel
feedback
in
the
last
two
years,

you've
lost
your
[inaudible]
in
terms
of
product
leadership.
Could
this
be
more
of
a
cost
challenge
and
therefore
a
reduction
in
the
quality
of
the
product?
I
just
want
to
understand,
going
forward,
while
you've
detailed
out
the
product
leadership
in
terms
of
your
opening
remarks,
in
terms
of
quality
speci■cally,
and
in
terms
of
cost
cutting,
I
just
want
to
understand
that
relationship.
And

secondly,
my
question
is
on
Elica.
Now,
we
understand
that
Elica
is
one
of
the
top
three
players
in
terms
of
kitchen
appliances.
Now,
when
we
did
some
channel
check,
we
found
out
that
even
Whirlpool
has
launched
its
own
brand.
The
products
were
quite
similar,
both
in
terms
of
features
and
also
property.
And
so
what
I
need
to
know
is
what
is
the
rationale

for
[inaudible]
tracking
your
own
brand
when
Elica
is
already
there,
doesn't
that
dilute
the
entire
presence
of
Elica
as
a
brand?
So
those
are
my
two
questions.
Thank
you.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Thank
you.
It's
great
questions.
Thank
you,
Natasha.
So
the
■rst
question
on
product
leadership,
I
want
to
be
super
clear
that
we
have
never
contemplated
a
reduction
in
quality,
not
even
contemplated,
forget

about
putting
it
in
the
market.
Have
we
done
cost
cutting
so
that
we
can
save
our
product?
Absolutely
not.
See
Natasha,
you're
absolutely
right.
But
if
you
go
back

and
see
our
financials
over
the
last
few
years,
there
has
been
a
volume
demand
impact.
There's
also
been,
if
you
remember,
a
commodity
cost
rise.
Part
of
the
reason
is
also
that
we
never
compromise

on
the
quality,
never.
There
may
be
people
who
have
to
compromise
on
the
quality
and
reduce
their
cost,
but
you
can
see
it
in
our
P&L,
our
profits
have
gone
down
over
time.
One
of
the
things
that
stayed
constant
for
us
is
actually,
and
I
can
tell
you
our
quality
parameters
over
the
years
are
actually
improving.
So
we
right
now
are
looking
at

probably
the
best
year
in
terms
of
quality
that
we
reduce
that
we
put
out
into
the
market.
And
if
you
look
at
the
products
that
we
put
out
into
the
market
and
the
claims
that
we've
talked
about,
fastest
convertible,
right?
Convertible
in
23
minutes,
two
times
the
vitamin
preservation,
10
in
one
convertible
modes.
All
these
are
investments
into
product
quality,
we're
not
taking

them
out.
So
if
anything
at
all,
we
have
gone
and
invested
more
and
more
in
product
quality
with
the
belief,
and
this
is
a
true
belief
in
my
33
years
of
experience,
that
product
quality
investment
will
always
pay
off.
So
I
just
want
to
be
very
clear,
there
is
no
question
of
reducing
product
quality.
We
lost
demand
in
the
market,
which
is
the

result
of
the
things
that
I
explained
to
you
about,
we
lost
some
consumer
traction
in
the
market
because
we
are
not
able
to
push
our
products
well
enough.
But
the
product
quality,
if
anything,
has
only
become
better
over
time.
In
fact,
like
I
told
you,
in
DC,
we've
just
got
the
energy
conservation
award
basically
out
of
all
the
refrigerators
in
India.
We
were

chosen
by
the
president
of
—
by
the
BEE
and
awarded
by
the
president
of
India.
So
just
want
to
reassure
everybody
on
the
call,
quality
is
our
number
one
thing.
We
will
not
compromise
on
that.
Never.
That
is
Whirlpool.
So
I
hope
that
answers
the
question
very
clearly.
And
now
our
job
is
to
make
sure
we
go
and
generate
the
demand
that
the

quality
warrants.
Because
the
demand
will
not
just
come
by
making
good
products.
You've
got
to
go
out
and
make
people
know
that
there
are
those
good
products,
which
is
what
we
do
by
investing
in
retail
executives,
which
is
what
we
do
by
investing
in
communication,
which
is
what
we
do
by
driving
communications.
The
second
point
that
you
talked
about
on
Elica
and
Whirlpool,

why
do
we
need
two
brands?
Very
simple.
I
think
cooking
is
a
category
which
is
nascent.
Cooking
is
a
category
in

which
you
will
have
multiple
brands
going
forward.
We
do
believe
in
having
both
Elica
and
Whirlpool,
because
Whirlpool
is
also
a
well
known
cooking
brand
globally.
To
have
both
Whirlpool
and
Elica
as
a
portfolio
play
is
a
far-far
better
strategy.
So
if

I
go
back
to
my,
let's
say
shampoo
days,
you
will
see
big
shampoo
companies
having
more
than
one
shampoo
brand
in
the
market
driving
different
things.
So
therefore,
what
we
basically
want
to
have
is
a
portfolio
of
brands
that
can
compete
in
this
market
because
we
believe
that
over
time,
this
market
will
become
quite
significant,
both
from
a
revenue
and
from
a
profit

point
of
view.
And
we
do
believe
that
there
is
play
for
both
markets,
and
there
are
differences
between
Whirlpool
and
Elica
in
terms
of
the
ranges.
Basically,
they're
all
hobs,
hoods
and
chimneys,
no
doubt.
They
all
have
a
power
source,
they
all
have
burners
and
so
on
and
so
forth.
But
there
are
clear
differences
in
design,
there
are
differences
in
aesthetics,
and
there

can
be
differences
in
functionality
as
well
between
Elica
and
Whirlpool.
We
do
think
it's
a
very
good
idea
to
have
multiple
brands.
Roopali
Singh:
Okay.
Thank
you
Mr.
Eswar.
We'll
move
to
the
next
question.
The
next
question
is
from
Priyank
Chheda.
We
would
request
Priyank
to
please
share
his
question.
Priyank
Chheda:
Hello?
I
hope
I'm
audible.
Roopali
Singh:
please.
Yes,
please
go
ahead.

Priyank
Chedda:
Sorry.
So
my
■rst
question
is
on
the
distribution.
What
is
available
and
where
are
we?
So
what
is
the
scope
of
further
vertical
expansion
into
the
distribution
end?
Now,
within
that,
how
much
is
the
gap
that
is
available
to
increase
the
wallet
share
within
the
existing
retailer,
which
is,
so
essentially
the
distribution
expansion
vertically
and
horizontally,
if
you
can
help
us

on
that.
That
is
question
number
one.
The
second
question
is
on
the
new
product
launch
is,
do
we
plan
to
pour
into
any
product
or
any
new
vertical
lines
especially
taking
the
product
portfolio
market
from
the
parent?
And
the
third
question
is
on
the
cost
line
items.
Now,
you
did
mention
that
there's
PG4
program
that
you
would
be
running
now,
which
would
run

across
those
cost
line
items
of
P&L.
So
if
you
can
help
us
with
the
details
onto,
which
is
the
cost
line
item
which
we
should
track
ahead
for
maximum
delta
change
that
should
be
visible
ahead.
Thank
you.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Sorry.
One
question,
Priyank
if
you
don't
mind,
you
talked
about
n
ew
vertical
lines
in
new
products.
I
didn't
understand
what
that
—
what

does
that
mean?
What
is
the
meaning
of
new
vertical
lines?
Priyank
Chedda:
No.
I'm
saying
outside
the
refrigerator
and
washing
machines
and
the
available
SKUs
that
we
have,
do
we
plan
to
enter
into
any
other
new
products
which
are
very
small,
which
are
very
niche
into
their
own
segments.
And
those
are
available
at
the
parent
basket,
which
are
not
there
in
the
Indian

portfolio.
So
that
is
my
reference.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Got
you,
got
you.
Thank
you.
That's
very
clear.
Priyank,
answer
to
your
■rst
question
on
distribution.
We
have
very
strong
distribution
in
the
country.
And
without
going
into
speci■c
numbers,
I'd
say
we're
already
at
about
total
coverage
of
what,
maybe
60%
of
the
total
distribution
that's
available
in
the
market,
which
basically
means
there's
still
about

35,
40%
of
distribution
that
we
could
cover.
We're
talking
at
tens
of
thousands
of
stores
basically
that
we
cover.
So
that's
the
■rst
point.
So
there
is
plenty
of
opportunity
for
us
to
increase
the
distribution,
but
obviously
the
distribution
also
comes
at
a
certain
cost.
So
we
are
always
evaluating
the
cost
of
rolling
on
the
distribution
versus
the
return
of
what
you
get

from
that
distribution.
So
that's
a
constant
ongoing
exercise,
basically.
As
you
can
imagine
in
India,
the
more
you've
got
to
distribute,
lower
down
the
order,
the
more
you
got
to
go
into
a
smaller
town,
et
cetera,
to
basically
distribute.
So
we've
got
a
big
Pan-India
presence
on
distribution.
We
continue
to
look
at
ways
to
optimize
that
and
drive
that
further.
And
that's
there

in
our
year
on
year
results.
One
of
the
key
KPIs
that
we
have
for
our
sales
force
is
actually
billing
points.
Distribution
billing
points.
We
track
that.
What
is
important
in
this
category
is
also
not
just
have
number
of
distribution
points
per
year,
but
also
track
it
on
a
quarterly
and
on
a
monthly
basis
because
the
more
frequently
you
can
bill
to
a

billing
point,
the
better
of ■.
So
we
have
a
complete
range
of
tracking
that
we
do
across
this.
Also,
keep
in
mind
that
a
lot
of
change
to
expansion
is
happening
across
the
country.
A
lot
of
modern
trade
expansion
is
happening
across
the
country.
So
all
of
these
also
help
in
driving
total
sales.
So
just
comparing
distribution
points
will
not
give
you
a
picture,

but
as
part
of
driving
traditional
trade
distribution
expansion
is
something
that
we
always
do
while
m

aking
sure
that
we
are
doing
the
right
thing
also
for
chain
stores,
for
modern
trade,
for
e-commerce,
and
so
on
and
so
forth.

So
that's
answer
to
your
■rst
question.
On
the
new
products,
what
you
call
the
new
vertical
lines.

I
think
■rst
of
all,
we
have

a
lot
of
opportunity
within
refrigerator,
washers
and
cooking
itself,
which
are
our
core
categories,
to
drive
a
significant
amount
of
growth
to
make
our
brand
much
stronger,
to
make
sure
that
we
supply
much
better,
to
make
sure
that
people
are
buying
our
products
more
often.
There's
a
huge
amount
of
opportunity
that
we
have
within
these
categories.
On
other
categories.
We
continue
operating
in

the
categories
that
we
operate
in,
and
we
will
continue
looking
for
opportunities
that
are
interesting,
but
they
have
to
be
financially
attractive.
So
this
is
something
that
we
always
keep
our
mind
open
on
and
we
keep
looking,
but
I
think
the
most
important
thing,
and
because
all
those
things
are
nice,
that's
like
icing
on
the
cake.
The
cake
actually
is
the
business
you've

got.
So
my
clear
belief
is,
make
sure
that
you
do
very
well
on
the
business
that
you've
got
before
you
start
jumping
on
something
else
in
the
hope
that
it'll
save
you.
No,
you
have
to
make
your
business
work
for
you
■rst,
which
basically
means
for
me,
refrigerator,
washers,
air
conditioners,
microwave,
ovens,
cooking,
dishwashers,
and
so
on
and
so
forth.
So
there's
enough

out
there.
And
by
no
means
are
we
at
a
market
share,
which
is
so
high
that
I
should
start
defocusing
on
these
categories.
So
I
would
say
we're
clearly
focused
on
what
we
need
to
do,
and
there's
plenty
of
space
for
us
to
grow,
plenty
of
opportunities
to
grow.
Within
these
however,
there
is
plenty
of
opportunity
for
us
to
grow
within
refrigerator
itself

in
different
segments.
So
we
track
the
segments,
market
share
and
market
performance.
We
literally
track
it
by
segment,
whether
it's
entry
or
mid
or
premium
or
high,
et
cetera.
And
based
on
that,
we're
working
plans
to
make
sure
that
our
market
share
grows
in
the
right
segments.
The
last
question
that
you
have
is
on
the
cost
line,
P4G.
So
I
will
just
pass

it
across
to
Aditya.
Aditya
Jain:
Yeah.
To
your
last
question
on
which
cost
item
you
should
track,
and
what
is
the
P4G
program?
So
P4G
stands
for
productivity
for
growth.
That
is
a
program
where
we
have
people
who
are
responsible
for
each
line
out
of
the
P&L.
And
we
have
targets
and
we
monitor
the
progress
against
targets
on

all
the
cost
lineups
on

a
weekly
basis
and
assess
it
on
a
monthly
basis
and
do
course
corrections
if
required.
But
if
you
ask
me
from
my
point
of
view,
let's
say
what
is
the
biggest
sign
for
me
is
the
material
cost.
Over
the
last
six,
seven
years,
the
material
cost
has
gone
up
from
about
62 %
of
NR
to
about
69 %
today.
And
that
is
where
we've
lost

the
margins,
is
a
combination
of
various
factors.
We've
seen
inflation,
we've
seen
regulatory
of
charges,
and
the
industry
has
not
been
able
to
take
up
pricing.
So
what
is
important
for
us
is
to
make
sure
that
we
have
enough
coming
out
of
the
material
cost,
which
will
help
improve
our
margins
in
medium
term
and
long
term.
So
this
is
one
of
the
biggest

cost
element,
which
we
will
be
tracking
very,
very
closely
to
see
how
do
we
get
productivity
either
on
the
design
aspect
or
on
the
sourcing
aspect
or
on
the
negotiation
aspect
through
various
initiatives,
working
with
vendors,
DTV,
tear
downs,
et
cetera,
et
cetera,
localization,
and
being
able
to
deliver
our
guidance
in
terms
of
margins
and
profitability.
Roopali
Singh:
Thank
you,
Aditya.
Since
we're

nearing
the
closing
time
for
the
meeting
today,
we'll
take
one
last
question
from
Mr.
Rahul
Gajare.
I
would
request
Mr.
Rahul
to
please
ask
this
question.
Rahul
Gajare:
Yeah.
Hi,
and
thanks
for
the
opportunity.
Now,
I
had
one
question
with
respect
to,
you
talked
about
the
state
of
our
plants
that
we've
gotten,
which
have
got
bronze,
even
the
Puducherry
plant
has
been
categorized

as
bronze
level
plant.
I
think
sometime
in
2020
or
2021,
the
annual
report
of
Whirlpool
was
talking
about
export
opportunity
in
a
big
way.
I
want
to
understand
from
where
we
are
today,
you
obviously
talked
about
what
you
want
to
do
in
the
domestic
market,
but
what
is
your
thought
on
export
opportunity?
Does
that
even
hold
now,
or
do
you
really
want
to

focus
only
on
the
domestic
market?
So
your
thoughts
on
this
entire
export
element
will
be
helpful.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Great
question,
Rahul.
Thanks
for
that.
At
this
point
in
time,
we
have
an
export
part
of
the
business
as
well.
We
do
export
to
a
few
countries
and
we
keep
monitoring
that.
Obviously,
like
I
said,
we
want
to
be
financially
very
sound
in
whatever
we

do
going
forward,
and
therefore
we
keep
looking
at
that
from
a
financial
attractiveness
point
of
view
as
we
do
that.
Also,
keep
in
mind
regulations
are
the
different
markets.
As
you
can
imagine,
every
market
does
not
have
the
same
regulations.
And
obviously
these
are
very,
very
technical
products,
so
they
have
to
basically.
So
keeping
all
these
things
in
mind,
we
have
an

exports
business,
we've
got
a
team
that
looks
at
exports,
we
continue
to
focus
on
it.
I
think
it's
also
been
a
little
challenging
in
some
of
the
markets,
basically
from
an
economy
point
of
view,
not
from
our
business
point
of
view
in
some
of
our
neighboring
markets,
it's
not
been
easy
in
those
markets,
plus,
with
regulations
coming
in.
Therefore,
I
would
say
the

exports
opportunity
at
this
point
in
time
to
the
markets
we
export
in,
but
I
do
keep
in
mind
that
unlike
a
local
producer
of
India
was
just
making
products
in
India
and
exporting,
we
cannot
export
everywhere
in
the
world.
We
cannot
export
to
the
countries
where
we
already
have
business.
So
we
can
only
export
to
countries
where
there
is
nobody
else
who's
basically

managing
the
business.
We
will
continue
to
drive
exports.
Do
I
expect
that
to
be
a
blockbuster
in
the
next
two,
three
years?
No,
I
don't
think
so.
For
two
reasons.
Number
one
is
we've
got
hell
of
a
lot
of
work
to
do
from
our
side
to
really
get
us
to
the
glory
that
we
need
to
get
to.
And
I
think
that
we're
clearly

focused
on
that.
In
the
meantime,
any
opportunities
that
we
have
on
exports
that
are
sensible,
that
work
from
a
regulatory
point
of
view,
we
will
absolutely
grab.
So
I
do
expect
to
see
the
numbers
go
up
over
time,
but
I
would
not
expect
something
really
majorly
traumatic
unless
something
else
happens
in
the
marketplace,
which
either
relaxes
the
regulatory
situation
or
changes
the
■nancial

position
or
I
mean
the
financial
consideration
basically,
that
other
countries
would
expect,
et
cetera.
If
these
things
change,
then
our
position
would
definitely
change.
Roopali
Singh:
Thank
you,
Mr.
Eswar.
With
this,
I
would
conclude
the
Q&A
session.
A
big
thank
you
to
both
Mr.
Eswar
and
Mr.
Jain.
And
on
behalf
of
the
management,
I
would
also
like
to
thank
all
the
participants
for

taking
out
time
to
be
with
us
here
today.
Thank
you.
Look
forward
to
meeting
you
in
the
future.
Narasimhan
Eswar:
Thank
you
everyone.
Aditya
Jain:
Thank
you.

Call: Aug 2024

August 06, 2024

The Manager

Listing Department

BSE Limited

Phiroze Jeejeeb hoy Towers

Dalal Street, Mumbai ,

Maharashtra - 400001

Scrip Code: 500238 The Manager

Listing Department

National Stock Exchange of India Limited

Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block G,

Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East,

Mumbai, Maharashtra – 400051

Symbol: WHIRLPOOL

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Transcript of the Earnings Conference Call

This is further to our intimation letter dated 26 th July, 2024 wherein we had informed the schedule of the Earnings Conference Call, please find enclosed herewith a copy of the transcript of the Earnings Conference Call of the Company for the quarter and three months ended 30 th June, 2024 held on 01 st August, 2024.

The same will also be uploaded on the Company's website at www.whirlpoolindia.com .

Yours faithfully,

For Whirlpool of India Limited

Roopali Singh

VP-Legal and Company Secretary

Plot No. 40, Sector 44,

Gurugram, Haryana

Whirlpool of India Limited

Q1 FY25 Earnings Conference Call

August 01, 2024

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Earnings Conference Call of Whirlpool of India Limited.

We wish to inform you that all participant lines will be in the listen only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal the operator by pressing “*” and then “0” on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Roopali Singh, Company Secretary. Thank you and over to you ma'am.

Roopali Singh: Thank you. Good evening, ladies and gentlemen, a very warm welcome to the Company's Financial Year 24-25 Quarter One First Earning Call.

Today, I have with me Mr. Narasimhan Eswar – our Managing Director, Mr. Aditya Jain – the Chief Financial Officer. A Presentation on the business as well as Financials has been updated on the company and the Stock Exchange website, you may please refer to the same during the presentation.

Before we move forward, I would like to inform you that there is a cautionary statement in the presentation, kindly take note of the contents of the same.

With that, I would now hand it over to Mr. Narasimhan Eswar for an update on the business.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, Roopali. And a very warm welcome to all of you, ladies and gentlemen. I am Narasimhan and I will take the first 20- 25 minutes to walk through the business overview and our strategic imperatives and our progress on that. And then hand it over to my colleague Aditya Jain, who is the CFO to talk about the financial performance, after which we will take questions of course.

Next slide please. We are now on Slide no. 6, which is the business overview. If you can move to Slide no. 6 basically, India we have called out the four as a strategic focus for the Whirlpool Corporation globally. A couple of things basically, the value creation opportunity for Whirlpool and for all other appliance manufacturers in India is huge. And the reason is obviously the market GDP growth that we are seeing. Also

combined with the fact that appliance penetration is quite low. So, you are talking about refrigerators, mid 30s washers, mid-teens, air conditioners less than 10%. And you have got a growing affluent

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demographic, which as we know the booming upper middle class and the middle class in India. So, therefore, the opportunity for the durables business itself is very significant. Then the question comes as to whether Whirlpool has the right to succeed well, Whirlpool has got a track record of value creation in this country and talks about four very critical things that it has. As I have said before, a Whirlpool has played a pioneering role in the Indian durables industry and has been associated with several industry firsts. I will cover these later. Whirlpool is a very well reputed brand with great integrity, on quality and performance, straddling geographies. So, for example, North, East, West, South, all regions Whirlpool is strong and economic strata. So, Whirlpool has got products and consumers in not just the premium end, but the popular end as well, the mass market as well, where it's got its strengths. And as India comes back, stronger in the mass market, as it is in the premium market today, Whirlpool

will be very much there to reap the benefits of that across strata.

Whirlpool has also got a diverse product portfolio as you know, we continue to innovate on premium product segments across categories. This is particularly important because we are not just innovating on premium segments and frost free or on top loaders or front loaders, you will see later in the presentation we are innovating very much on semi-automatic washing machines premium, as well as premium segment in the DC, the direct cool refrigerators as well. And we have got a very strong manufacturing footprint, refrigerators and washers being made in multiple factories in Faridabad and Pune and in Puducherry in India.

And last but not the least, we have got a powerful pan India sales, distribution and service network and we have also got excellent relations with our customers, combined with strong investments in building retail and creating demand. So, those are the reasons why India is a great market we wish you very well know and why Whirlpool we believe has got a tremendous reason to succeed in India and therefore India is a big strategic focus to the Whirlpool Corporation.

Moving on, let's take a look at the growth and profitability record of Whirlpool:

So, very simply, I would like to call it out as a set of two big kind of intervals and then latest year. So, from 2008-09 to 2019-20 Whirlpool had a revenue CAGR of 12% and a PBT CAGR of 20%. Those numbers, I would take any day of the week, on a quick basis, but then from 19-20 onwards, we had a tougher time where the results, the revenues were not really growing significantly. And the profits came down as well. What actually happened was, obviously COVID was a major factor, we also had significant competitive intensity coming in and you had significant regulatory changes. Now all of these, with the regulatory changes came commodity cost increases. So, all of these basically hit the revenue as well as the profits. Now what happened in '23-24, in the year that just finished, very simply in '23-24 the revenue grew by about 2% and our profits basically stayed at about close to 4%, 3.9%, as opposed to 4% of last year.

Page 2 of 27

So, that would look on the face of it like not a lot of progress. But, if I walk you to the next slide, Slide no. 8, really this '23-24 Financial Year was basically a tale of two halves. In the first half of the year, as you can see, on the left-hand side, the revenue growth year-on-year was 10% and in the first half of the year, we were down (-4%). And this is basically driven by price adjustments that we needed to make strategically in the January to April period. And regulatory costs are going up, which hit the profit. The second half of the year, we have actually grown revenue by 10%. So, we have grown double digits in the second half of the year, leading to yearly results of about 2%. So, it is actually a tale of two halves from a revenue point of view. How does it look from a gross margin point of view, gross margin in the first part of the year grew by about 60 basis

points from 27.5% to 28.1%. And then the second half of the year went from 27.8% to 30.0%, which is 220 basis points.

Now, that was driven by a lot of cost productivity actions, we call this P4G, a "Profitability for Growth", really coming into action in a significant way, a very, very deliberate

strategy and plan that we do now and we will keep doing into the future. As a result, our profit which in the first half of the year was 3.4% of sales, which was actually (-29) versus the previous year, same time period. In the second half the profits grew by 58% versus the previous year, with the PBT percent going up to 4.5%. So, the full year revenue growth and profits actually benefited from the positive momentum in the second half of 2024.

Now all that's well and good, but how are we doing in April to June. So, really, if you go to Slide no. 9, we are happy that we are sustaining the momentum through April and June. Revenue growth of standalone business is 24% versus last year. PBT growth is 128% versus last year, so we are very happy that our strategy of profitable market share growth is clearly working. What I think makes us happiest is that we have had strong share gains in triple digits basis points versus last year, in both refrigerators, and washers. So, it's not one or the other, both refrigerators and washers, we have had very strong share gains in triple digits basis points. We were also helped by not just the market share growth, but also a strong growth in the refrigerator industry. So, after a long period, April, May, June has been a period in which the refrigerator industry actually grew strong double digits, washers didn't. But that's fair because both the refrigerators and the AC market really grew massively. And we are much, much more present in refrigerators and with a much smaller share in air conditioners. So, our benefit really was from the refrigerator market growth. Washers market growth not really. So, a combination of share gain in refs and washers and strong growth in ref and AC is what actually got us those results.

Basically see, we were able to grow the market share profitably, which as I explained to you last time, is always the impact. The results have actually come based on a very, very disciplined ROI-based investment strategy. So, we are calculating what we do, what we couldn't, and what we get out of things basically, quite rigorously. And that is the basis on which we invest, and we have called out very clearly, we have identified for ourselves, what are the growth levers, what is the magnitude of the

growth lever, what is the momentum of that growth lever, how much runway does the growth lever have and therefore how long can we keep focusing on it. Where we are confident about the growth lever for all these factors mentioned, we invest fearlessly, where we are not very sure we make sure that we learn, and we assess the ROI before we roll it out.

So, that is basically the strategy that we are following. Excuse Me!

If you look at the profitability, it's not just coming from our top line growth, but it's also coming from significant gross margin and bottom-line improvement, which comes from the "Productivity of Growth" program, which is the cost take out program that leads to this gross margin improvement. We are also quite happy that not only the sales and the profits are going in the right direction, but operationally we have also been able to make sure that we focus on inventory receivables and payables as well. With the result in our cash position is at about 485 crores that we have generated. So, we are quite happy about that as well. So, these are the numbers present

for you, revenue is at 2384 crores

year-on-year change 24%. Driven by strong market share improvements in ref and washers versus last year, and a strong double-digit growth in refs, as well as in air conditioner industry. Both the refrigerators and the washers business have grown by high double digits for us, which is the other notable part. So, we are not counting only on market growth as I said many times before, we are counting on growing to share.

EBITDA and PBT improvement is being driven by the volume growth, which obviously helps our industry a lot, but also by a lot of cost productivity actions across every line of the P&L in this P4G program that

leads to better margins and improved mix. We have also focused on driving the mix a lot, whether it be through our marketing strategies or it be through incentivization of the sale force incentives. And that seems to be working well as well. So, though we have had the price impacts and the regulatory impacts, these things are helping us, you know, get to a better position. And cash flow obviously derives from a strong EBITDA, but also a significant improvement in the working capital that we have been able to drive.

Next slide, please. I go to Slide #11, this is the one that I am, as a team we are happiest about. And we really hope we can keep this up. So, this is going to be the cornerstone. If we can keep this up this will be a wonderful story for us. Just walk you through October '22, to March '23. So, there's a chronological timeline that explains what has happened to our business, October '22 to March '23, the market was growing mid-single digits, we had a significant problem, because the volume market share was declining quite substantially, triple digit bps. It was impacted a lot by several issues, competition, etcetera but the biggest one was price index challenges. So, we corrected this price index challenge around Jan to April of 2024, oh sorry, of 2023. And we also introduced the new direct cool ranges in Jan to March of 2023. Despite that the volume market share though improve it was still declining versus a year ago, if you go to April to September, which is the next time period, the market was actually flat, what we were able to do is, really step up our focus on execution of marketing, execution of supply chain, execution of sales. And we also introduced the frost-free ranges fully in our stores. And these incredible ranges where we have between the 265 liters and the 360 liters, we have got claims like converse from freeze to fridge in just 22 minutes, which is best in class claim in the market. So, completely new technology that we brought in and there was an improvement in the market share versus the previous trend. But we were still kind of slightly declining versus a year ago. October '23 to December '23 that quarter, the market itself grew by very low single digits. But we had deployed some incremental retail executives in the field. They had come of age, in a matter of speaking in terms of their experience, and so on and so forth. And we started the mix drive and right earnest, along with some tests that we were doing in certain areas. And we started seeing the market share grow versus the year ago. Jan to March '24, was a period of significant consolidation of market share growth. Continuing on the growth momentum, though the market was

flat, we had a significant impact of all our ROI based investments, our new products, but also our execution of step ups. And therefore, you can see that volume market share increasing year-on-year quite significantly. And now we are talking both refrigerators and washers. And lastly April to May 24 the market itself finally grew double digits, which was very welcome. But at the same time, the full effect of our retail executives that we have added across time, the new products that we have brought in, the clear focus on mixed drive, the change of the sales force incentive plan, and many, many other changes that we have done including major programs with the customers and so on and so forth, has led to that triple digit growth in basis points in market share for both refs and for washers.

So, if I then move on very quickly to Elica. Elica continues to do well, we have increased our ownership in Elica, as you know from 49% to 87%, in 2021, very strong capabilities and local manufacturing. And Elica, I would call as a pioneer or an innovator in this space in terms of coming up with

real quality products, great technology, good distribution, good brand awareness, but still opportunities to grow in both distribution and brand awareness, which augurs well because this market is also a very low penetration market. And we believe that Elica is going to be a great long-term player. We have also established Whirlpool as a mass premium cooking brand along with Elica. If you look at our revenues and margins, the growth has been pretty significant across the last three years, double digit CAGR with strong margins. Obviously, the margins operate between 13.5 to about 17.5%, 17.5 being the peak in '23-24 but I would expect

ongoing basis, the margins to be more between the 15% to 16% kind of range, as we seek to invest to drive this wonderful business.

Next, please. So, I move on now to the strategic imperatives that we have. So, what are the strategies that we are following as an imperative to drive our business and there are ■ve basically, and I have spoken to you about this, inspiring consumers and generations of consumers with our brands. Second is winning with product leadership. The third is building a competitive and resilient supply chain, the fourth, my favorite excellence

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in execution, and the ■fth is growing a consumer direct business. So, let's take a look at it one by one.

So, if you look at our next slide, please. Slide no. 15. Inspiring with our brands we look at our history inspiring consumers with our brands. Whirlpool as you know was the ■rst introduced pedestals in DC in this country, which is now a significant proportion of the entire DC business, not just Whirlpool's business. Whirlpool was the ■rst to bring in auto defrost technology, and still remains the largest by far player of auto defrost in the country. Whirlpool was one of the early pioneers in CFM and colors and ■nishes basically. But it's not just DC, Whirlpool was the ■rst to bring in the three-door refrigerator into India with the proton series which continues to do very well. It also brought in the Platina range, which is dark interiors, and in washers Whirlpool introduced not just the incredible Bloom Wash 360, which is our top, let's say most premium top loader but also the ■rst top loading heater in the countr

y,

which we now have across quite a bit of our top load range. So, in essence, this is what I told you about earlier, Whirlpool is a pioneer in India's durables industry, in inspiring trust for consumers with our brands.

Now, how are we actually bringing it to life now, going to the next slide. We are very, very proud and happy to work with one of the great Indian company, a company that I have always admired, Unilever. We have announced a strategic collaboration on the 12th of June that we do with Unilever. So, Whirlpool and HUL have decided to collaborate to enhance the Indian consumer's laundry experience. And the whole logic is a very, very simple logic, which is, penetration is a massive opportunity for washing machines in this country. And penetration is also a massive opportunity for liquid detergents and washing machines in this country. That is, in essence the opportunity that we see, this opportunity can take several forms. At this point in time, we made a grand start with a joint media campaign, a TV and digital, which is a co-branded campaign between Whirlpool and Surf Excel. I apologize, I am not able to play this for you because it's an audio call. But the link has been sent along with the video which you can look at leisure. It's an advert that we really love. And I am sure the Unilever guys like it as well. My father, who lives in Chennai, has reported seeing it several times. He is my people leader, you know literally he monitors and then lets me know every time he sees the ad, and I believe that he's seen it a reasonable number of times.

We also are doing, sorry, please go back please, we are also doing sampling and OnPack endorsements on both the machines as well as the products of Unilever Surf Excel, which is the brands of Excel Matic, which is a brand that we are working with. So, at this point in time, it's media, it's sampling, it's OnPack endorsement, and plenty of opportunity to do much more in this area to drive penetration in washing machines and liquid detergents.

Next slide, please. But that's not all, we are taking inspiring trust to the next level, because we just said we have got amazing products on both semi-automatic as well as front load. And we have got opportunities to

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improve our market share in both these places. We took a look at these products and said, we are so confident of these products, let's put our money where our mouth is. So, we have moved ■rst from offering two years of comprehensive warranty on semi-automatic machines from two years to four years in January this year. So, on every semi-automatic washing machine that we make and sell in India, we basically give four years warranty on Whirlpool. And following the success of that program,

we have offered a five-year comprehensive warranty on our front load fully automatic washers. This is the new line that we set up in 2022, which is doing really well and the products are fantastic. So, we said alright, so let's offer, you know, that trust to the consumers to say this is how confident we are in our product that we are willing to give you five years of comprehensive warranty. And that is something that we did from April this year. So, those two are in the market and we look forward to significant and continued growth from these.

If I move on to the next one, which is product leadership. We have

done

some new product launches we are very, very proud of. Now both these product launches have been done in the space of the last 12 to 14 months, basically. So, that's been great work by the team to bring commercial innovation to market so quickly. The first one is the DC glass door, the direct cool refrigerators, the single door refrigerators, the glass door range, as you can see, a fantastic new designs, they look stunning in the store. And right now we are not able to produce enough to meet the demand. And so, I hope that continues and we hope to continue gaining the benefits from this, but also able to provide the products wherever it's needed by the consumers. So, this is the first one and then moving on.

This is something that we are inordinately proud of semi-automatic washing machines is one thing that everybody would think the only way to kind of grow this business is just bring in more capacity, 7 kg to 8 kg, to 9 kg, to 10 kg, to 11 kg, yes that's one way and we will follow that as well. But what we have done is, we have brought in a premium offering into semi-automatic washing machines by looking at the single biggest pain point for semi-automatic washing machine users, which is detergent patches if you see the left side of the screen, on the blue shirt, you see those patches, it says without dynamics. That's the kind of patch that you can get as a consumer when detergent and water don't mix properly in semi-automatic washing machines. But what we have been able to do is come up with a technology called the dynamics technology where hydrodynamic fins in a compartment, mix the detergent with water ensuring no detergent coagulation and offering an incredible experience, right, zero detergent patches, zero, okay. We are incredibly proud of this initiative that we brought to market and this has just hit the market a couple of months ago and we look forward to driving this really hard.

Move on please. The next slide, Slide no.20. Elica continues to dazzle with its innovative ranges. The one on the left is a particular favorite of mine. The auto sense chimneys that we have brought in with the brushless DC motors. See the insight here, again the consumer insight here inspiring trust we talked about. Consumer insight here is that, when you get a chimney, you often and I am sure you have experienced with yourself at home, you often forget to turn on the chimney when you are cooking.

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And so you end up having this, smoke in the room for about 15 minutes, and then you switch it on, but by then your eyes are watering. Look at these incredible auto sense chimneys, what they do is this, there's a thermal sensor, that as soon as the flame comes on, it detects the flame, and it comes on automatically. Now that's a great consumer benefit and on the right-hand side, you see the Hexa Ind Lotus series of hobs, there are triple burners here. And these have heat shields. So, if you see those heat shields that you can see on the screen, that avoids your knobs from heating, just imagine such thoughtfulness that's gone into the design of these products, heavy duty burners, and obviously looking incredibly good, world class design. So, that's on that.

Move on to the next Slide no. 21. We talk about excellence in execution like I said, you can do a lot of strategy but if your execution is not brilliant, then

the consumer doesn't get to see your strategy. We are focusing on it is with respect to sales and service winning every day in every store with every consumer, how do we do that? We have brought in much stronger visibility, which we track of the premium lines and our new ranges that we bring into the market, focusing more on premium. Second, we make sure that we get our pricing strategy right, especially on the premium

lines, where there is an opportunity for us to grow much, much more, we have got great products, maybe not enough market share as compared to our popular ranges, and therefore a great opportunity. We have really got much stronger sales and service execution, including like I mentioned incentive plans that drive premiumization, that drives the right mix, that drives value at the consumer level, basically at the market level. And then we also leverage our great customer relationships that we built up over three decades, round after round of management has basically engaged with our customer partners to develop great relationships and we leverage that as well. And of course, we continue to drive e-commerce marketing. If I look at the service part, it's a very good story, you can see from that graph there, the NPS or the net promoter score that we get, which is basically consumer score rating us on how they felt about the installation or the servicing. The scores continue to go up quite strongly. And we do that through a variety of things, we have got differentiated call centers, we have got dedicated desks for premium customers, for the top 20 cities, we have got escalation desks, we use technology like WhatsApp, API's, video calling, etcetera to service the consumer. And we have also got in-house service centers that we set up in 2022, that not only drive an excellent service experience, but actually are financially viable. So, all in all, from our service and a sales point of view, we are happy with the progress that we are making, we need to do much more of this. But we are happy with the progress that we are making.

Next slide, please. Slide no.22, we are coming to the end of my piece, is basically two big things to highlight on the supplier excellence program. First of all, we are very, very proud that all our three manufacturing sites Puducherry, Pune and Faridabad have achieved the bronze in world class manufacturing, which as you know is not a very easy thing to do, very, very proud of that. And the other thing is that, I mentioned probably about six or seven times in this call the P4G cost leadership program that

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we do across all lines with the P&L, productivity to grow. So, the whole idea is to save money across all lines of the P&L, put some into the bottom line, put some back into the business, to drive marketing and sales so that you can drive the volume. And there is a significant step up that we have done on that. I would say that is very, very important, especially given that going forward, there are going to be commodity headwinds that we know, there are going to be ocean freight headwinds that are already happening which the whole industry is suffering from. And these challenges are going to be ahead of us from a cost point of view. But we continue to drive our P4G program because that's in a way for us a little bit of an antidote to these kinds of issues. S

o, with that, I am

going to hand over to Aditya, the CFO for the financial performance.

Aditya Jain: Thank you, Mr. Eswar. Again, a warm welcome to everybody on the call. I am on Slide #24. And I will talk about the financial performance of Whirlpool of India. This slide talks about the standalone results for full year '23-24. We delivered a top line of 6333 crores, our full year revenue was up 2% this was despite the industry was soft, weak summers, especially on the ref side of the business. And in the second half, our revenue was up by 10%, which was driven by market share led growth, which was in turn driven by stronger execution, and effects of product upgrades and innovation. This was in contrast to our first half decline in revenue of 4%. If you just look at from two core categories for ourselves, the refrigerators grew in low single digits and the washers for a full year point of view grew in double digits.

Coming to profits, the EBITDA, we delivered an EBITDA of 312 crores at 4.9%. EBITDA grew by 4.6% on a Y-o-Y basis and on profit before tax before exceptional items we delivered a profit of 250 crores at 3.9%. Actually, we arrested the three-year decline in profits. So, over the last three years because of COVID competition and costs, we saw a decline in profit. But this was the year we saw that arrest, we arrested the decline, and the profits grew marginally by 1% year-over-year. Just to give a little bit of color on the profits, the profits in the first half were impacted by the price adjustments which were forced to take to correct our competitiveness in the marketplace. And the significant impact of the

regulatory cost changes which happened which impacted our cost. However, in the second half, because of the significant volume growth and the cost productivity actions which we took also held by the softening of the commodity prices and all the actions which is the ROI based investment which Mr. Eswar spoke about, and the focus on driving mix had led to a 58% growth in profit in the back half of the year, ultimately leading to a full year profit growth of 1.4%.

On the cash side, we generated 535 crores of cash in full year '23-24. Cash was driven by obviously EBITDA as well as the improvement in working capital. Improvement in working capital was led predominantly by the inventory management, there was an organization-wide effort to improve the quality of inventories and reduce slow moving, non-moving and obsolete stock, which was basically a paid inventory for us and as a result of which we saw an improvement in working capital and hence the cash generation.

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On Slide #25, this is the, this slide talks about the financials on a consolidated basis. The difference versus the last slide and this slide is about the Elica performance. On a full year basis, we delivered a revenue of 6830 crores, our revenue was up 2.4%. We already spoke about standalone business. On the cooking side Elica grew revenue in high single digits, so Elica revenue grew by about 8%. On profit side, on a consolidated basis the highlight is that, we grew profits in high single digits. Both EBITDA and PBT grew by about 8.8% and 9.8% and Elica continues its good strength and profitability and profit for Elica business grew 40% Y-o-Y and on a consolidated basis, we generated 610 crores of cash again driven by EBITDA and strong working capital i

mprovement
versus last year.

Moving to Slide #26. This talks about the quarter one financial performance while Mr. Eswar spoke about the standalone performance, so hence I am covering the consolidated performance which includes Elica. From a top line point of view, we delivered revenue of 2497 crores. I am happy to state that this is the highest ever revenue we have clocked in any quarter in the financial year. And this is a growth of 22.5% versus last year. This revenue growth was driven by strong market share improvement on the back of various actions. We have taken around the strategic imperatives also held by the double-digit growth in refrigerators as well as air con industry. A point worth highlighting both refrigerators and washers grew in high double digits for us. EBITDA, we delivered a consolidated EBITDA of 211 crores at 8.4%. EBITDA grew by 71% last year and there was an improvement of 230 basis points and profit came in at 196 crores that was almost double versus last year, and PBT percentage was 7.8% and an improvement of 300 basis points versus last year. A bit color on profitability. So, both EBITDA and profit improvement were driven (A) by the strong volume growth. We saw 22.5% growth in top line which automatically translates to a significant improvement in DCM, fixed cost remaining flat everything flows into the bottom line, plus a significant improvement also came from the cost productivity actions. A lot of work happened on the commercial negotiation and technical productivity, so the market forces of commodities were flatish versus last year. But all internal efforts on cost and the P4G action led to the margins improvement coupled with the entire focus on driving mix of high DCM and premium portfolio to business and this has helped us offset the pricing challenges and the regulatory cost impacts which we had.

On the cash side on a consolidated basis that remains a good story. The efforts on managing working capital inventory and the accounts receivable remains and in this quarter we generated a healthy on a consolidated basis a cash of 491 crores, which is significantly higher than last year. With this, I have covered the financial performance and I will pass it back to Ms. Roopali.

Roopali Singh: Thank you Aditya. I would take an opportunity to thank both Mr. Eswar and Mr. Jain for such a detailed presentation. I would now hand the proceedings back to the moderator to open up the Q&A session.

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Moderator: Thank you Roopali. We will now start the question-and-answer session.

Participants present on the audio bridge who wish to ask questions may press * and 1 on their touch tone telephone. If you wish to remove yourself from the question queue, you may press * and 2. For clarity of questions and better audio experience, participants are requested to ensure that while asking questions, they are using headphones to avoid the background noise. In the interest of time, we sincerely request the participants to limit their questions to two. We will now begin the question and answer session. The first question comes from the line of Aniruddha Joshi from ICICI Securities. Please go ahead.

Aniruddha Joshi: Sir, two questions from my side, in the previous conference call you had indicated the revenue guidance in high single digits. But now we have seen a very strong performance in quarter one. So, will there be any change in the

guidance and if you can indicate the revised guidance that you are looking at, that is question number one. And then question number two is, while the company has gain market share is there any strategy with which the company is working in terms of gaining market share, for example 1% market share gain each year or market share gains in premium end of the market or anything that you would like to elaborate and what will be the key triggers to drive the market share growth, is it the distribution in your regions or gaining market share in the existing regions itself or launch of new products or in a way price cuts or aggressive ad spend. So, just wanted more clarification and data on this from you. That's it from my side, thank you. And congrats for great set of numbers.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you Aniruddha, much appreciate I kind of knew this question would come. Well, I would say that we are not giving any guidance, etcetera for the full year. What I can assure you is that, investors with us, I can assure you that we are putting in every effort to make sure that we try to meet your expectations and that's about the maximum guidance I can give. As you know we are a listed company here, a listed company in the US. I don't want to talk too much about guidance that we have not given elsewhere. So, we have done, I think we have had a very good first quarter. You know, everything depends on the growth actually for the year depends on a couple of things with respect to the revenue, right. First, it depends on the market, which is very difficult to predict what happens to the market. Second is your market share, so those are the two things that basically help to go towards your inorganic business growth. While market is very difficult to predict what will happen or not happen, our focus will be to try to keep our market share strong. Because at the end of the day, profitable market share growth is actually what as I said last time, is what we want to focus on. So, growing market share but growing profits at the same time, the intent is not to grow the market share and drop the profits, because that's not a sustainable model in our view.

Now, the second part of the question I can answer in a little bit more detail, which is how do we look at gaining market share. What are the triggers driving the market share? So, firstly, the key for me would be to drive market share profitably, which basically means if I grow revenue,

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ideally, I should be growing profits ahead of revenue. That is the intent, there could be quarters in which we are not able to do that. But the intent would be to do that all the time. right. That is what I would say a good company does. There are many triggers, you know much better than me. The obviously new products and innovation is obviously one great trigger. The right pricing for the right product is another trigger. All of the sales fundamentals and execution you called about distribution being available in more stores, but you can also imagine extraction which is basically taking out more volume from the same store, from the same number of displays that you have in the store. So, your display share is also a driver. Your different categories can be drivers, some categories growing faster than the others, the lower penetrated categories which have momentum growin

g faster than the other can also be something that grows. Within this obviously we try to drive our premium market share harder than our let's say popular for lack of a better word market share the entry level products, but of course sometimes the season is great, the entry level market share will go up so that's okay. So, long as your premium market shares are going in the right direction that you want it to, there are times given the Indian market where the entry level segment really grows very well and being a leading player, your market share grows faster, you will end up with an entry market share growth faster than your premium market share. we are okay with that, so long as we are growing in premium. So, our strategy would be exactly what you called out, which is driving all these levers having a very clear idea of which lever to use when, having a very clear focus on return on investment in each of these levers, because as you can imagine, I only detail some of the sales and marketing levers, there are many of them, right. So, we are trying our level best to do this in a scientific and rational way. So, that we can always try to get to our goal of profitable market share. I hope, I answered your question.

Aniruddha Joshi: Yes, many thanks for that. Just the last question and then I will come back in the queue. We are seeing, e-commerce is becoming a way major force in the entire consumption basket, especially in white goods and durables also, now with ONDC platform also becoming a bit bigger. So, in next 10 years this will be likely to be a major driving force in the entire distribution. So, what are the strategies of Whirlpool, in this entire thing and what are the market shares in e-commerce platform, compared to let's say, GT or MT, I don't want the exact number, but are they higher or materially higher or lower or materially lower, anything directionally would be very helpful. That's it and thanks from my side.

Narasimhan Eswar: No, thanks a lot Aniruddha. So, to answer your question on e-commerce, well we obviously we are present on all the things that you mentioned, we are present on the key e-commerce platforms, we are also present on ONDC since end of last year, like you rightly say it is growing, and it will continue to grow on an ongoing basis. I think, the way we look at this is that, we don't want to favor any one segment or platform at all. These are just different ways of reaching our consumer. Right! And we also include in this our own D2C business as you recall, we have called that out also as a strategic focus going forward. And that's something that we will continue to introduce going forward as well. We already have a D2C

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website and a platform. So, to answer your question, yes, very much e-commerce is part of the plan. We have no, let's say aim to grossly drive one channel versus the other absolutely not. We plan to basically drive all the channels with respect to the financial return that we get out of the channel, and also the long term ability for that channel to kind of contribute to the industry and contribute to our growth, right. So, that is the basis on which we make our investments. And we continue to make investments in both e-commerce and in D2C, including ONDC. Now that's the first part of your question.

In the second part of the question, the mar

ket shares are kind of pretty

much, much of a much less, it's very difficult for me to give you an exact idea. The reason is because the numbers are slightly different across different, but I would say it's more or less in the same ballpark. So, it's not like we are massively below in one versus the other. It's more or less in the same ballpark between e-commerce and traditional trade, which also shows that like I told you before, this brand straddles geographic strata, it straddles premium and popular, it straddles different channels, it does pretty well across the board.

Aniruddha Joshi: Okay, Thank You, Thanks Alot.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank You.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Priyank Chheda from Vallam Capital. Please go ahead.

Priyank Chheda: Ya, Hi Team, Congratulations for great set of numbers. Sir, my question is on the gross margin, particularly for the June quarter which we saw, it is seasonally strong for refrigerator, but we are seeing seasonally slightly lower than what we see for the rest of the nine months. So, is refrigerator a lower margin business versus washer on a relative basis, if yes then

why. (B), how should we think when it comes to the full year gross margins after all the price corrections that we have taken, vendor negotiations are getting initiated. So, where should we end gross margins for the full year and on the P4G program, if you can talk, if there are additional savings left below gross margin, which is freight, employment, employee cost or advertisements, is there anything that we should think, we should approve in this year below gross margin as a savings. That's on my side ■rst question?

Aditya Jain: Thanks Priyank, this is Aditya and I will pick up this question. A, ■rst thing I just want to say that because we are a listed company and we are not giving short term guidances so I won't exactly be able to tell you like how will my full year gross margin will look like etcetera, etcetera. Having said that, to the question on whether ref versus washers, are the margins are significantly different. So, not significantly different, both of them are ballpark in the same range. So, it is not that one is significantly better than the others. In this quarter, we have seen a year-over-year improvement in gross margins predominantly coming from the benefit of the productivity actions. And hence, you see roughly one and a half to two percentage points improvement coming from the material cost line.

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So, as we have explained, we have a very structured P4G program, there are teams both on commercial negotiation sides and, and the technical side who work on driving those productivity initiatives for us to deliver those cost savings apart from whatever happens on the commodity side in the market. To your points on line items below material cost which is your employee cost and all other expenses. We also have a P4G program in which we capture the indirect cost, while the material cost is a direct cost. But we also capture indirect cost, and the teams are working on it. The idea is not here to cut the cost, but open cost optimization as a principle that how can we get more from the same level of costs or how can we do the same level of work at a lower cost principle. So, there are teams working on each of the line items, but then material cost being a significant

part of the P&L and roughly 70% of the cost is material cost is the entire P&L. Hence, that's where you will see the biggest amount of productivity, which is reflected in the P&L.

Priyank Chheda: Perfect-Perfect. Coming to the season, which is for the washers. If you can elaborate overall strategy for the season, which has already started, how do you see industry growth panning out, given the strong monsoons and we are slightly weak on the front load side as far as the old category goes. So, how are we bridging the overall portfolio, making the overall portfolio ready to gain the maximum out of the current ongoing season and if you can also elaborate on this washer as a category which has seen a solid competition coming up from the entry level peers like Voltas, Beko, how is the overall competitive intensity panning out for you, particularly for the washers. Thank you.

Narasimhan Eswar: That's a great question. I will try to answer it as best as I can without revealing too much because as you can imagine, we are a listed company and some of our competitors are not. So, I would be absolutely loath to give out any information that would prejudice us in the marketplace. How do I see the washer season coming through, very frankly like I said, right at the beginning very difficult to predict. I wish I could predict it and I would share that with you because it would be helpful for me as well. But it's very, very difficult to predict how the washer season could be. The summer season was better than what anybody expected. The best of the best did not expect that this good summer season, especially for air conditioners. And so, I am only hoping that the washer season is good, but to be honest, like I said what we focus on is trying to focus on market share, so, that we can be sure, if your market share grows, you can be sure of at least some of your growth. If you are counting on market growth, that can be in the short run a little bit of a misleading thing because if it doesn't come then you are in a soup. So, everything that we do is based on trying to drive market share, like I said probably. So, we basically got three businesses, which is front load business, our top load business and our semi-automatic washing machine business. So I think , you have talked about competition, not going to go into which brands

and so on and so forth. But yes it is quite competitive and that's great, because it's good for the consumers when it's competitive. We welcome the competition, it's very inspiring for us. So, we have special plans for the washer season, you will see it in the market. We have already taken some actions actually, to be honest, I don't want to say on the call. But if you

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actually make some inquiries in the market, you will already know the actions we have taken on semi-automatic, you will know the actions. For example, I already spoke to you about one thing on front loading that you asked about, that we have actually gone to a five year comprehensive warranty on the front load washing machines. So, fantastic new products with a five year front load washing machine. If you look at our top load business, which is basically the top load vertical axis machines, we have just got advertising on after many years with the Unilever Whirlpool ad. If you see that ad, you will s

ee that what is featured in the ad is the bloomwash series, which is our flagship product in top loaders. And in semi-automatic washing machines, which is historically been a big success for us, but of late has been something in which we have had some challenges in share, we have taken a couple of steps, we have taken some corrections in pricing that should help us through the season. And the second thing that we have done is, we have launched the dynamic detergent dispenser in the semi-automatic machines, which is a premium end of semi-automatic machine. So, all in all more to come, but I think we have a decent plan for the washer season. For us, the critical thing is, we are not so bothered about other people, we just want to do what we need to do, which is grow our market share profitably. And that's basically our focus.

Priyank Chheda: Perfect, sounds great. Just a last question on the market share gains, the three levers which you have alluded to which is additional brand promoters. Second, is new product launches. And third is mix, would it be by any chance possible to break down the contribution from the each of the three levers which are contributing to the market share gains, and a result in most likely the Koreans would have lost markets given the last share that they would have, any reason would you like to address why such that is happening in your industry. That will be my last question. Thank you.

Narasimhan Eswar: Sure. I think to be honest, we can't really give that break up because, like I said that would literally serve the answers up to everybody on a platter.

And it's taken us a lot of hard work to figure this out. Unfortunately, I can't give more color on what contributes how much. Needless to say, it's not just these three, there's a lot more actually, which I haven't detailed out, there is a huge amount of work. If you remember, I also talked about the sales incentive structure. It's not just stuff that costs money, it's also how we use the stuff like what Aditya was saying. The incentive structures is another big thing, there are several- several things that we have done, whether display shares, whether distribution, whether it's extraction. So, there's a lot of work that's gone in, it's not only these three levers, these were three of the levers, which are a little prominent, but there are many others that have led to this. So, the combination of these things done the right way with the right investment behind each is. That's what we need to get right to get profitable market share growth basically.

And as far as other players are concerned, I think, look let's be honest, it's not a one way street for anybody. I think we have seen years in which our market share has gone down, I think those numbers are shared with you in the beginning. That was the same company and does it mean, it

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can never happen again, yes it can happen again. We are paranoid about making sure that it doesn't happen again. But, this is a competitive market and people take competitive actions, all we can do is focus on what we need to do. We are not desperately focused on others, we look at competition, what they do in the market to understand what they are doing and to understand the impact of what they are doing surely, through the market shares. But we spend a lot more time making sure

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hat we are running the race we need to run, if that makes sense. That way, we can be sure of ourselves, rather than looking over a shoulder at somebody or looking ahead at somebody and saying, how do I catch up. I think we just need to pace ourselves and just do it right. That's all.

Priyank Chheda: Wonderful, Congratulations and All the Best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank You so much Priyank.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Ravi Swaminathan from Avendus. Please go ahead.

Ravi Swaminathan: Hi Sir and thanks alot for taking my question and congratulations on good set of numbers. I know this quarter had been good because of the strong summer season. But in general, the demand environment, especially post COVID had been slightly soft. If you could give some commentary on the demand scenario on a normalized basis. How it is on a pan India level. Probably you can give a commentary on how good rural is, urban is, that will be great.

Narasimhan Eswar: That's a great question. So I think this is actually the, I would say one of the trickier questions to answer. What has actually happened that we can see post COVID is that, there was a big bump post COVID basically, when people came back to the market, there was a maximum, I would say significant market growth, we are talking about 20% odd growth basically, unfortunately, we couldn't participate in that growth for various reasons at that point in time. But then what's happened post COVID is we see on an ongoing basis is, outside of these big spikes the market growth has been a little subdued okay, to be honest. And the reason that's happening is because what we can see for sure is that the premium segment of the market has certainly been growing really fast. But the belly of the market, the entry level of the market, that has not been doing massively in the last few years, right. Now, I do believe that, of course, I am not an economist at all, by any stretch of imagination. But I do believe that, kind of having the GDP growth that we have, the trickle down should happen. I do believe that post COVID consumers were spending on a lot of things that they didn't spend on during COVID. If you look at house prices, they went up so much basically, extraordinarily, rentals went up extraordinarily, travel we all know how brilliant travel was, people only get a certain amount of money every year. Say you get Rs.100 last year, next year, you get Rs.110 or Rs.109 salary increase. You choose where you put the extra Rs.9 because the Rs.100 is already accounted for. Now, I do believe that a lot of people in the last few years put their money in a lot more travel, wanting to see the world, wanting to look at different places, you know, almost catch up on all the stuff that they didn't do. So, Page 16 of 27

there was a significant increase in travel, as you know from the reported figures. Hotel costs went up because of the travel. So, all of these were inflationary in nature. And I think durables really didn't get the full benefit of this growth. Now, I am hoping being an optimist, that at some point in time, and hopefully that is from next year onwards, but we never know that this growth comes back, and we start growing at least at the rate at which normally the country would be expected to grow, a country like India with this kind of growth would be expected to

grow. So, I think that is the one thing, and the second thing is, you know, the other thing that usually drives growth is inflation. So, the inflation in this industry typically has not been very good at all, in the last few years, driven by intense competition, and I am sure by decisions that different companies are making on their own. So, there are two components to it. Therefore, one is the volume growth and the second is the value growth on top of the volume growth. The value growth has been very muted, only driven by premiumization, more or less, predominantly and the volume growth has not been that great in the entry and the mid-level basically, it's been much more on the premium segment. But I do believe that in a country like India, with the kind of population that it has, rate at which the middle class is growing, some of the lovely announcements that have been made with respect to the number of houses that will be built, going forward, etcetera when you build a house, the house will hopefully need a refrigerator, had a minimum maybe it needs a washing machine, some of the houses, maybe some of them need air conditioners surely. So, I am hoping that these things are actually going to start contributing to the

growth, not just at the top end of the market, but in the belly of the market as well.

Ravi Swaminathan: Understood sir. And my second question is with respect to pricing, we know it's a very competitive market, it had been competitive, it is competitive and likely to be competitive. But some factor like pricing probably would be at the margin. So, at the margin, has things improved over the probably past couple of years, or is it at the same level, or 100%, so the elbow room for you to increase prices in your products, has it improved?

Narasimhan Eswar: I would say, what we are very clear about is that it's a very competitive market like you said. In this category, because the cost of the product is very high, the price impact is quite significant. I think we openly discussed that basically, and talked about how that affected when we were at a price premium versus a competition, how it affected our market share and so on and so forth. So, I would say it is market determined. If there are opportunities in the market to take pricing, I think the companies will take them and everybody takes it independently. In the absence of any companies taking up pricing, obviously the value of the market would continue to be depressed. So, it's a very difficult one to predict or plan for. Obviously, the one variable in this is commodity prices, ocean freight, all these costs going up. So, just common sense, say, that at some point in time, that should be something that we look at, basically. And I am sure everybody will do their own mathematics on the topic.

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Ravi Swaminathan: Understood. And my last question is with respect to the premium products. You had mentioned that the premium products have grown faster than the entry level products. So, the percentage of share would have obviously gone up over the past few years. I mean if you can share the number of what is the premium product share say double door refrigerator, in the overall mix and automatic washing machine and the overall mix, and how it can read over a three, four years period?

Narasimhan Eswar: Ya sure, we don't give out the share data

, by segment or so on and so forth. This is something that we don't do, but I can kind of tell you that, typically our shares are higher than the entry level historically than they are in the premium level. And therefore, I would say the room for us to grow in premium is more. And so what we try to do is make sure that we get a certain amount of growth in the premium segment. Like I said before, there are sometimes when the entry level actually grows faster because the market is faster and we are quite strong in entry. So, we end up getting a higher growth there. But strategically we would like to see the premium shares growing ahead of entry on a going basis, on an absolute a percentage basis point growth year-on-year. So, for example, I am just making up numbers, if your premium share is 12% and your regular share is, entry level share is say 15%, you would like the higher percentage of growth on your premium shares or on your entry share. So, that your financials work out better, your mix is better. Obviously the more premium products that you have, the more you can drive them the better off you are as a company from many points of view. And so that's what we really try to focus on. Unfortunately, numbers, percentages, etcetera we are not able to give out.

Ravi Swaminathan: Understood Sir, Thanks A lot.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank You, Thank You Ravi.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Amit Mahavar from UBS. Please go ahead.

Amit Mahavar: Thank You, Eswar Sir, First of all congratulations on achieving a lot of operational turnaround if I can call it since you joined, very difficult time and reflecting also in the cash flows, not only in the P&L. My first question is more on, if you see what you have done in last couple of quarters, a lot of representation which was missing for Whirlpool in the trade channels, you have more people on floor, shop floor market Whirlpool products, you have actually expanded the SKUs both in ref and washing machine across four, five categories. Can you just help us understand what is the, which are the segments where you gain more market share in ref, it seems it's more in DC versus FF, can you just help us qualitatively understand the change in market share across categories in both the key

categories of ref and washing machine?

Narasimhan Eswar: Ya, Thank you Amit, looks you know more than me. So, you are right, its pretty much everything you said is right. We have done a lot to be honest Amit on a lot of areas, because execution was something that we were very keen to get right. And like I said before, strategies are great, but if

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you can't execute them in the market, then they are meaningless to the consumer. We have invested a lot in trade channels basically, as you talked about people on the shop floor explaining our products to the consumer, which we see actually as a way of marketing. So, we have done that, we have done a huge amount of training for them, we have made sure that they are kind of comfortable with not just the products, but they are proud ambassadors of the products, we have brought in new products, just to give you a couple of examples, the DC, we brought in five star after a couple of years, basically we brought in the five star industry very well, we brought in the frost free range we brought in the three star

after quite some time. So, that's been doing very well as well.

Like, we just talk to you now, we brought in the glass doors into DC that we never had before, which is quite a cool thing because a brand like Whirlpool bring in glass doors, it's wonderful. It's like, I pop across sometime the market to Bangladesh to basically see in and pretty much the whole market there is a glass door. So, glass door is a wonderful thing that we brought in here as well. So, we brought in a lot of new products but that's not all we have done a lot of executional change in a lot of areas. And therefore I think, focusing on that and driving that is what we really are clear about. And like I said, we put down so many different things, basically. And we say okay, which ones, what are the kinds of bullets that we have for each of these. So, obviously a direct, I mean I am sure you know about this, but our direct cool performance has been very good, we are very happy with that. And frankly, our interest will be to make sure we continue with that kind of growth. I don't want to say too much. But if you see the shares, you will figure out what I am talking about. The direct cool refrigerators business, we have had some very good success, we started seeing the turnaround on frost free as well. But, for us to kind of even think that whatever share increase we have got is ours to keep that would be folly. It is a very, very hard-fought battle and it's got great respective competitors, who I genuinely respect and therefore I think we have got to be on our toes all the time. And in washers, for example, we had some very, very good success in our top loading washer business. But I am pretty sure that we will try to bring that success to bear in our front loading washers business as well, where our share opportunity as you know, we have been active for the last two years, others have been active for more than a decade. So, in front loaders, we have a tremendous opportunity to grow the business. And we will absolutely focus on trying to do that. So, for me there is a lot of opportunity that we have basically, obviously the key is to invest in areas that can give you a return, so that we can focus on profitable market share growth, but I must say that you pretty much answered your question.

Amit Mahavar: Thanks. The second question is, you know, a lot of low hanging fruit is what you seem ingly have achieved or in the course of broadly achieving it. But you also have some of the tough competition now in Beko, which was non-existent when the last big management change had happened and I am not worried about competition for Whirlpool, maybe Whirlpool and Beko as a strong players will lift the category and cut down the tail. Do you think for you in the next three years, say by 26-27, the SKUs that you track and then you plan in the market for these two categories, will

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you be able to cut down the gap vis-à-vis say if you compare with LG, Samsung, particularly if I can name them, do you think that's a very strong and important target for you and in that category. When you do that, it needs a lot of innovation, which anyways you are trying to drive. So, any color about how the SKUs across the categories will move in the next two, three years. I understand the limitation with which you

can

answer this but anything incremental is helpful plus, the factory setup you have now, we have much and much less imports now. So, something around that, thanks Eswar.

Narasimhan Eswar: Sure. It's a very good question, actually. And I was expecting this question. It's a very good comment that you make and it's a very fair thing to say that there are low hanging fruits. But, to be honest with you, what we have tried to do Amit is, we have tried to figure out all the fruits, some of them are low hanging, some of them are medium hanging, and some of them are high hanging. So, the critical thing that we tried to do is figure out where are these fruits, how big are the fruits, what is the momentum of these fruits, how big is the runway for these fruits. That's what I was trying to explain at the beginning. So, what we have tried to do is, come up with a menu of things that we could potentially invest in, and what returns could that get. And so in a way, while this is a bit theoretical, but you have to invest money according to a certain theory. So, we work that piece out. Obviously, it's not an exact science, but we work that piece out to say what we should be doing at what point in time. So, I think we are not counting on any low hanging fruits, obviously if they are there we will pluck them. But we are not counting on low hanging fruits to basically drive success going forward. Now I think the question that you were asking me, basically if I can reframe it as to say, what is the ambition that we have, I will not state a specific number or something. But to be honest, you play games or you play in arenas, or battles with only one intent is to win. So, that's what we want to do, we want to win and we know that it's a long hard road to win eventually and we got to win year-after-year, quarter-after-quarter, month-after-month, week-after-week, day-after-day. That's how you will in the long run. In the battle sometimes you lose, sometimes you win. But if you win much more often than you lose, that's how you get to your goal. So, our intent is, like I said, very simply to drive profitable market growth through identified levers, which we are fairly clear on which we track and measure with discipline financially, that we try to execute as a team. And what I am happy about is that the entire team is basically thinking that way. Whether you talk to the leadership team here, or you talk to people who are executing in the field, we are all kind of trying to think in the same way. We are not perfect at all, nowhere near that. But we are trying really hard. And I think the intent will be only one which is, profitable market growth, sensible market growth, but market share growth, but continuously. And so whatever market growth comes on top of the market share growth for me is like wow, that's a bonus basically, but your salary is market share, your bonus is market growth, that's the way we like to look at it. And we like to invest it in sensible ways. If you have an open mind and if the organization is harnessed properly, there are so many opportunities that can be leveraged. In fact, just to give you a small example of how the organization is working now. The idea to do a consumer promo on the

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front load washer machine actually came from a sales team in Hyderabad, they do

not come from the central office. So, doesn't mean the central office doesn't give ideas. They give a lot of ideas which are implemented. But we are very proud of the fact that ideas are coming from the ground up basically. And we are implementing those, and we implement them fast and if we see the proof, then we go really quickly. So I think we have a lot of stuff to do, a lot of battles to overcome. But it's a very interesting fight and we are happy to be in this fight.

Amit Mahavar: Thanks Eswar and good luck to the entire team.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank You.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Umang Mehta from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Umang Mehta: Ya, Thank You for the opportunity, Sir, just wanted to understand for this low double digit growth that market did in the first quarter, what would have been the growth for economy end, so basically the direct cool range, any sense around that?

Narasimhan Eswar: Ya I think, Most of the growth and I am sure you know, most of the growth actually in the first quarter, actually came from refrigerators. So, not most of the growth, all of the growth between refrigerators and

washers came from refrigerators. So, refrigerators had a very strong growth pattern, both the direct cool range and the frost-free range actually grew quite significantly, strong double digits.

Umang Mehta: Understood. And the second question was again on gross margin. So, while I understand on Y-o-Y basis, the reasons that you explained. On a Q-o-Q basis, is there a mix element that play for the contraction? That was my last question.

Aditya Jain: Not a significant one, which will impact the Q-on-Q margin mix. So, as I explained earlier, the margin between ref and washers are not significantly different. So, that is something which has an impact on the margins, than the mix not a significant impact on margins.

Umang Mehta: Then what was the main, there's a substantial contraction on Q-o-Q basis. So, just wasn't able to understand the reason behind that?

Aditya Jain: So, what really happens in April to June quarter is, (A) your mix of the product, for example AC becomes significantly higher, which has a relatively lower margin compared to a core T2 product so that is one factor, which impacts quarter-on-quarter margin. And the second factor is about the summer, for example there are a lot of promotional schemes which are run in summer, which are not there in your Jan to March quarter. So, because of these two reasons, you will see that sequentially, you will see your gross margins could be a little lower in quarter two versus quarter one. So, those are the two big reasons which impact your sequential margins.

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Umang Mehta: Understood, That's it from my side, Thank You Sir and Good Luck.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank You.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question comes from the line of Rahul Agarwal from Ikigai Asset Managers. Please go ahead.

Rahul Agarwal: Hi, Thank You, Good Evening and compliments on not only 1Q but the achievement you achieved in the last 12 months is wonderful. It was really commendable. Sir first question essentially was on the input content, my sense is just wanted to know, how much are we importing right now from a material perspective, both for Whirlpool or Elica and where are we right now and what kind of changes, should we expect any changes over there, that's the first question.

Narasimhan Eswar: Okay.

So, you are talking about finished goods, right. So, almost all of our business is basically made locally, refrigerators, washers, air conditioners, everything is made locally. There is very small, extremely small proportion of business that's imported. I think over time, the intent will be to make everything in India, that's the intent very frankly that the country has overall as a country and that's the intent that we would have as well, touched on a lot of supply chain, and inefficiencies and complexities and so on, and so forth. But obviously, all of that localization, whether it be on finished goods, or on components is going to depend a lot on (A) readiness of the local market, which is very, very, very, depending on what the situation is, depends on the regulatory kind of rules and regulations that come in, about what should be done by when. And also depends a lot on the competitive environment with respect to cost and quality between local producers and international producers. So, there's a lot of factors that go into this, without going into the details, because I cannot share with you unfortunately again, because we are a public listed company, I cannot share that information in detail. But what I can do is tell you that, as a team we have put down all of the stuff, and then we prioritized what should be done by when, that piece of work has been done. And we are working on it, all of them as you can imagine fairly complex projects. And we are working on those projects to make those come through. I think it will take a few years, because there's a lot of, let's say, a lot of things to be done before everything can be done locally. As you can imagine, in every industry it's the same story. And certainly, we are no exception as an industry. So, we also closely work with industry bodies to make sure that the opportunity of making here versus the cost of making here, as well as the regulatory requirements, all of those are basically managed in such a way that it has become viable for the industry, and not unviable, I think that's the key.

Rahul Agarwal: Just a follow up on this, so in terms of, I was actually referring to

competence and so, like how much are we importing right now, what's our import content?

Narasimhan Eswar: Yes, so that is something that we will not be able to speak about, to be honest with you because we don't share that information publicly. We haven't shared it, and we don't plan to share publicly as well. But it's

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something that, to be honest pretty much if you know the industry number it's pretty much in the same range. More or less, there will be one or two players who are more localized, there will be one or two players who are less localized, but quite a few of the players will be right in the middle.

Rahul Agarwal: Got it. The second question was, of course we have done enough to recover, back to what positions we are right now. But in terms of your team, where will you be spending your time on over the next 12 months in terms of the top three, four challenges in your mind which are still a gap or a challenge you see and will spend time on?

Narasimhan Eswar: Ya, I think, Basically, if I look at what us, what do we as a team, basically spend time on, the first thing that we spend time on is very frankly, profitable market shares. How do we basically secure

market share and

continue to grow market share but how do we do that profitably, right. So, that's the first big one, because it's a very competitive marketplace. Very, very good competition, very tough competition, people nobody wants to take a step backward in this game. So, the first thing that we look at is profitable market share, then we basically look at working on our own cost programs, basically which is absolutely crucial. So, first, is to drive the revenue. Second is to make sure that we are working on cost, we are always conscious that there are headwinds that come, sometimes the headwinds are very, very strong. I would say right now with all of the stuff that's happening on ocean freight and commodities, etcetera, it is harder headwind than has been done in the past and it's true not only for us, it's true for entire India, it's actually true for the whole world as well. So, commodity headwinds are quite significant. Competition, I think, is the other one, but like I said, what we do is we understand what they are doing in the marketplace based on their actions in the marketplace. And we figure out if we need to adjust our strategies or not. The other thing that really is very critical for us is to make sure that we have a very clear vision, we are very clear strategic imperatives. All the people in our organization are aligned to the strategic imperatives, and we march to the same drumbeat. So, making sure that the organization is marching to the same drumbeat and everybody singing the same song is an extremely important thing for the leadership team, which is what we focus on.

Rahul Agarwal: Got it, thanks very much for answering my questions. And really appreciate to hold this call, I think as a shareholder, just request that if we have these periodical discussions, it really helps to understand the numbers better. So, hope to meet on future calls as well. Thank you so much and all the best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank You Rahul, Thank You very much.

Moderator: Thank you. The next question is from the line of Shrinidhi Karlekar from HSBC. Please go ahead.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Ya, Hi, Thank you for the opportunity and congratulations on the good set of numbers. So, just couple of clarifications. So, did you mention that both economy raise as well as premium range of product did excellent for

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the refrigerator category in Q1 and you have had a gains in both direct cool as well as frost free subcategories?

Narasimhan Eswar: Yes, please. So, when you say economy and premium you are talking about direct cool and frost free I presume, because the way we kind of look at it is within direct cool, we look at entry, middle and high, kind of thing. So, if you are asking, did the direct cool business as well as the frost-free business do well, in the first quarter, the answer is yes. Both did well, from an industry point of view.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Okay. And within the DC as well, did entry also did well?

Narasimhan Eswar: Yah-yah. Yes, because I mean It was a very hot summer as you can imagine. So, entry from a market point of view also did reasonably well. What I think is also, so all the segments actually grew and as far as

refrigerators are concerned entry, mid and premium across DC, direct cool as well as frost free. So, all of those segments grew.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: And sir share gains, you have in both DC as well as frost free?
Naras

imhan Eswar: Yes, we will not be able to share the details. But yes, we have had, obviously they are differential. Our share gains and DC have been more than frost free, but both have grown. We have had some very good success in DC.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Great. And sir second question I had is, so we are seeing is that, channel mix is shifting in India, it is moving more from general trade to e-commerce and modern format retailers. So, how do you see it as a headwind to the profitability of industry and therefore the company like Whirlpool and create lot of channel or do you think it doesn't really change much from the profitability of the industry perspective?

Narasimhan Eswar: That's a fantastic question actually, honestly. You are right, there is that kind of a shift. But, I think first based on all the experiences that we have seen across the world, not only in this industry, but also in FMCG that I worked for many years. It's not going to be a complete shift with nothing happening in traditional trade. That's never going to be the case in a country like India, you are always going to have a traditional trade business, purely because of scale and a lot of other reasons. So, you will always have the traditional trade business in India, and it will always be a reasonable chunk of the total business first. So, I think, one of the one hand margins can be affected by shifting to more organized trade for obvious reasons. The other advantage that we have is because you are displaying and you are driving the visibility, and you are providing a nicer environment to shop in, etcetera, etcetera, propensity you increase, your basket also increases. So, to be honest, the way I look at it is, India's an amazing story going forward. Because if you grow at a GDP growth of what 7% to 8% a year, hopefully even more going forward. With the real rate of growth being that nominal, you add on top of that, you are looking at a business that is going to, a country that is going to grow GDP significantly, it's hopefully going to double its per capita by 2030. And then you are talking about a lot of people coming into the purchasing
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space. So, the belly of the market, if I can call it, is going to become bigger and bigger. And when the belly becomes bigger and bigger, there is more and more opportunity. So, imagine today, so it's not a zero-sum game. That's the point I am trying to make. It is not a zero-sum game. That is the beauty of India. So, I am super happy that e-commerce grows, and modern trade grows and traditional trade grows because all of them will grow. And the reason I am saying that is because again, I want to re-emphasize India is not a zero-sum game. It is not a, I will only grow by 3% so, if you grow, I have got a de-grow not at all, there's space for everybody to grow in this amazing place. And it is not the case for the next five years. In my view, it's the next case for the next 30 years, probably. So, at least in my lifetime and I am sure you are much younger than I am. But in both of our lifetimes, we don't have to worry about lack of growth. So, I think the propensity where refrigerators are selling mid-30s, in penetration, refrigerators can go up to mid-60s, mid-70s. Washing machines are mid-teens, washing machines can comfortably go up to mid-30s without a doubt. ACs a

re less than 10%, why can't they go up to 50%. So, the point I am trying to make is, in modern trade, or e-commerce or whatever, you have a basket, a bigger basket, because you have more space, you have more people, blah, blah, blah. And so therefore whatever you lose in a percentage you might make up in an absolute. So, I think, the beauty of India is that, one doesn't have to worry so much about it, of course year-on-year you have to manage your P&L, absolutely. But in the long run, this is going to be a great story for the durables industry.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: One more if I may ask sir. So, look at your margins have improved quite sharply, but they continue to be a good 5%, 6% lower than what we used to do before COVID. So, just wondering, do you think that margins are structurally gone down? Some of the players in the air conditioning

industry do call it out that sectorial margins in India probably have gone down. So, I want to share your perspectives. Is there a possibility wherein you can go back to the margins you have had before COVID, which in first quarter was typically 14% to 18%?

Narasimhan Eswar: Ya, so, to be honest, it's very difficult to predict. But what I can tell you is that the market is much more competitive than it was pre COVID. Much more competitive, somebody on the call else has mentioned about very strong pricing action being taken by different people, et cetera. From our point of view, we are very clear that the long-term guidance that we have given is high single digit profit margins. That's what we have given, and we absolutely stick only with that and that's the long term guidance that's not tomorrow morning's guidance. It's a long term guidance and the reason we are saying that is because we recognize that the market is a lot more competitive than it was in 2018. 2018 - 2019, you had people exiting the market, today you have people entering the market, everybody wants to come into India and grow the business in India, every global CEO, has declared India as their most important growth market. So, this is just the reality; this is the fact of our great country. And so everybody will want to come in, everybody will have market share. That means there will be pressure on profits and margins and so on and so forth. And therefore, having massive margins probably is not very likely. At some point in time,

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I can tell you that when all the regulatory pressures as well have gone, because keep in mind that when you have regulatory changes every two to three years, three to four years, that also brings in a significant amount of cost into all players. Nobody is an exception to this. So, you have got competitive pressures, you have got regulatory pressures, all of these will impact people's margins. And therefore, I think steady progress year-on-year is the best thing to look forward to. We have called our high single digit in the long term and that's what I think, we can aspire to.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Thank You for answering my questions sir and all the very best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank You Very Much Shrinidhi.

Roopali Singh: Thank you. Moderator, we will take, if we are already overtime. We will take one last question before concluding the call today please.

Moderator: Certainly, ma'am. We have the last question from the line of Nirranish Jain from BNP Paribas. Please go ahead.

Nirranish Jain: Ya

. Hi Sir, Thank You for the opportunity and congratulations on good set of numbers. Sir, firstly wanted to check on the working capital. So, if I am not wrong we are a company that is already operating at close to nil working capital days, for over the years, but what we have seen in this result also like we are able to generate a very strong cash flow because of continued improvement. So, I just wanted to check, do we have scope of further improvement in the working capital and directionally is there any target for how much working capital days can go to. And secondly, I have a question on the discounting part. So, we have seen consistent, like increase in the discounting over the past few years, but now considering that we have taken a significant price correction, realigned a strategy in line with our competitors, so, can we expect some moderation in the part of the discounting. So, those were my two questions. Thank you.

Aditya Jain: I will take the question on working capital, so our improvement in the working capital right now has been driven more by inventories. What we have done as I said in my earlier part of my performance and results is that as an organization we have been working on improving the quality of the inventories, and hence a significant effort went behind liquidity slow moving non-moving inventories. Now, given the levels, we are currently at inventories, is there a further optimization possible? Yes, you can always look at opportunities but are the big opportunities available, probably no, unless you significantly improve your capacities, for example, and then you say that you have significantly increased capacity, then you can work on anything, you can lower inventory so that's one. On the receivable side, again it's a published number, the days you operate at, we operate at pretty healthy days. And the third lever on the working capital is accounts payable, so have we reached the end of it, obviously, no. We will keep looking at opportunities to improve working capital across all the three levers between APAR and inventory. What are we targeting again,

it's a matter of guidance again, and we don't disclose the exact numbers, but then opportunities will always be there in the various areas as we look at each and every nook and corner of our business. On the
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discounting side, just want to give your perspective the numbers if you look at published numbers on the balance sheet, year-over-year not seen an increase in discounting percentage. It's more or less, the ■attish. If you look at the discount for the TPI, as percentage of revenue, we have not seen any change on those numbers. Pricing is a factor of more consumer in competition led, so that we will keep calibrating between what's happening in the market and what's market can absorb. But the intent would be to hold the discounts ■at to where we are, largely.

Nirransh Jain: Sure Sir, That's Very Helpful. Thank You and all the best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank You.

Roopali Singh: Thank you. Thank you Mr. Eswar and Mr. Jain for today's session. And thank you, ladies and gentlemen, for joining us today. With that, I hand it over to the moderator to close out the session.

Moderator: Thank you. On behalf of Whirlpool of India Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you all for joining us. You may now disconnect your lines.

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Call: Feb 2025

February 10, 2025

The Manager

Listing Department

BSE Limited

Phiroze Jeejeeb hoy Towers

Dalal Street, Mumbai ,

Maharashtra - 400001

Scrip Code: 500238 The Manager

Listing Department

National Stock Exchange of India Limited

Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block G,

Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East,

Mumbai, Maharashtra – 400051

Symbol: WHIRLPOOL

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Transcript of the Earnings Conference Call

This is further to our intimation letter dated 29 th January, 2025 and 05 th February, 2025

wherein we had informed the schedule of the Earnings Conference Call, please find

enclosed herewith a copy of the transcript of the Earnings Conference Call of the Company held on 07 th February, 2025.

The same will also be uploaded on the Company's website at www.whirlpoolindia.com .

Yours faithfully,

For Whirlpool of India Limited

Roopali Singh

VP-Legal and Company Secretary

Plot No. 40, Sector 44,

Gurugram, Haryana

Encl: as above

Whirlpool India Limited

Q3 & FY25 Earnings Conference Call

February 07, 2025

Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day, and welcome to Earnings Conference Call of Whirlpool of India Limited.

We wish to inform you that all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode. And

there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation

concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal

an moderator by pressing “*”, then “0” on your touchtone phone. Please note that

this conference is being recorded.

I now hand the conference over to Ms. Roopali Singh, Company Secretary. Thank you and over to you, ma'am.

Roopali Singh: Thank you, Neerav. Good evening, ladies and gentlemen. We welcome you to Whirlpool India's quarter three earnings conference call.

I will start by introducing Whirlpool India's management team. I have with me Mr.

Narasimhan Eswar, Managing Director; and Mr. Aditya Jain, Chief Financial Officer. As

communicated earlier, we also have with us Mr. James Peters, Executive Vice

President and Chief Financial and Administrative Officer of Whirlpool Corporation.

He joins us today to respond to questions on the anticipated sell-downs.

A presentation on the business and the financial reserves of Whirlpool India is

available on the website of the company, as well as this stock exchange. Before we

move forward, I would like to remind you of the cautionary statement that forms part

of the presentation. During this call, the management will make certain

forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements are based on

certain expectations, assumptions, and other factors which may affect the business

results. Attention is also drawn to the cautionary statement made by Whirlpool

Corporation in regard to the anticipated sell-down which is captured in the

presentation. Please read the cautionary statements carefully, and the content of

this call should be interpreted accordingly.

With that, I would now like to hand it over to Mr. Eswar.

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Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you. Thank you, Roopali. Good evening, ladies and gentlemen. This is

Narasimhan Eswar, the Managing Director for Whirlpool of India Limited. And I have

with me Mr. Aditya Jain, the CFO of Whirlpool of India.

I would like to start by presenting to you the business overview and walking you

through the strategic imperatives and the progress we have made against that.

Following which, I will hand it over to Mr. Aditya Jain to talk about the financial performance of the company.

So, as I start with the business overview, what I wanted to say was that I will be talking about the period between April to December, as the quarterly results are with you for October to December. And I am sure you have had the opportunity to study it. We will also take any questions on it later. But I really want to talk about the momentum that we have created through the end of last year and into this year, and how we are sustaining this momentum through April to December.

What do I mean by momentum? The revenue growth in April to December for Whirlpool is 17% growth versus last year. We have not only grown the revenue, we have had a pretty good success in the cost take-out program, what we call the Productivity for Growth program. This has led to a gross margin improvement of 220 basis points versus last year.

We are quite proud that the PBT growth of the company is about 100% versus last year, and this

PBT improvement is about 210 basis points versus a year ago. That means the lines in between gross margin and PBT have also been managed quite strongly. We are very happy with the fact that the share gain has been very good. The market share gains that we have had on volume market share has been in triple-digit basis points over all three quarters versus last year, in both refrigerators and washers, which make up 90% of the business that we play in.

Most of these have stemmed from strong positive results that we have got from our ROI-based investments that we have done, which we have talked to you about before. I am also pleased to report that working capital, which is an important parameter of how the company is working, we have also seen some substantial progress. Versus the 5% of sales working capital in September 2023, we have published earlier minus 3% in September 2024, and the company continues to generate healthy cash as we go along. Next slide, please.

Let us start with the revenue and the profits for a second. We would like to say that there is a clear turnaround of the business in the '24-'25 fiscal year with strong profit growth accompanying it. Let me draw your attention to the left side of the chart, where we show the standalone revenue from operations growth.

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In 2021, '21-'22 and '22-'23, we were operating between minus 1.6% and plus 3.6%, so between slight decline to low-single-digits. In the first half of '23-'24, as you know, we still had a difficult time. It was minus 4.3%, but things were beginning to turn around. In the second half, which was a different story, we grew the business nearly 10% versus the previous year. And I am glad to report that in these nine months we have grown by 17.2%. That is about 15 months of continuous revenue growth, which makes us feel that we have done the job in terms of turning around the revenue situation.

But is it just revenue? If you go to the right side of the screen, you have the standalone profit before tax absolute growth percent versus last year. From between a minus 20% to a minus 30% up to the first half of '23-'24, in the second half of '23-'24, we delivered a growth of 58% on profit. And in the nine months of '24-'25, we have delivered 101% growth versus a year ago. So both revenue and profit have turned around, and that is why we said it is a turnaround.

Now, how have we done on market shares? Next slide, please. This is slide number nine I am referring to. This line at the bottom is basically the volume market share year-on-year combined for refrigerators and washers from multi-brand outlets, the offline. As you can see, the market has been growing somewhere between mid-single-digits, just once went to double-digits, low-double-digits, and then came back to about mid-single-digits or flat. That's been the kind of profile of the ref and washer market for the last, let's say, in the two calendar years.

Our Whirlpool volume market share which was down triple-digit basis points, from Jan to March '23, we were able to start moving in the right direction in April to September '23. In those six months, while the market was flatish, we had already taken in the first quarter of, when I say the first quarter, I mean Jan to March '23 of the calendar year, we had taken some price corrections and we introduced our new direct cool ranges. We then stepped up our execution, and we launch

ed our

frost-free range upgrades with great claims in April to September '23.

As you can see, the share started moving in the right direction, though it was still negative double-digit basis points. October '23 to March '24, we started turning around the share significantly. There was a lot of focus on sales execution and

capability, service execution and capability. There was a lot of focus on the frontline and driving our business, driving our consumption, as well as driving premiumness through the mix.

From April '24 to December '24, every quarter we have grown triple-digits versus the year ago in terms of market share. We have done that through a combination of many things, two or three things per quarter. We have brought in new products,

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whether it is a glass door, or whether it is a dynamix detergent dispenser in semi-automatic washing machines, we brought in much stronger executional focus, increasing that as we go along.

We took some of our great products that we have in washers and launched extended warranty on those, offering more value to the consumer. We brought in additional retail executives to drive our consumption, did several promotions that were at the right promotions at the right time, including at the festival season. And at the end of the calendar year this year, we have also launched our new air-con ranges. All of that is resulting in share growth year-on-year.

Now, what is very interesting to see on the next slide is the question that would come then, the next question is, is it just one or two categories that are driving this growth, or is it happening as broad-based growth across categories? Let's take a look at this very, very complex chart, which is Chart Number 10. And I apologize that it is so detailed, but I did want to give a lot of color to you.

The first row is basically the direct cool refrigerators. The second row is no-frost refrigerators. The third row is SA, which is semi-automatic washing machines. The fourth is vertical-axis or top-load washing machines. And the fifth row is the front-load washing machines. These are basically the market shares in bps versus a year ago, basis points versus a year ago.

Just to take direct cool for example, we were having a triple-digit market share decline in January to March 2023. With the right pricing and with the new ranges, we started to turn that around with much better increased sales execution in April to September '23. And after that, from October '23 onwards, we have been growing triple-digits versus a year ago in the direct cool refrigerator. All of you would know that direct cool is also the strongest part of our portfolio, historically. We are very happy that we were able to turn that around and start getting that into growth as a flagship business for our company.

If you look at no-frost, we had a couple of tough quarters in the beginning. It's not just Jan to March '23, but April to September as well, which is declining. We started correcting that with our new ranges and sales execution focus and several other things. In October to March, we were still declining, starting to move the right way. As you can see, in April to June we went to double-digit basis points growth versus a year ago. July to September, the same thing. I am very happy to report that in October to December we have actually moved to triple-digits basis points growth versus a year ago

, thereby showing that we are fully capable of driving the premium end of our business as well.

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Semi-automatic was quite a challenge, primarily because there were a lot of competition, which was advantaged on price, on the price that they were working on in the market. It did take us longer to turn that around. But as you can see, with the right set of actions, including warranty and right pricing actions, we have been able to start growing the business from July to September, and we had a strong double-digit growth in October to December.

On the top-loading machines, similar to the DC, the direct cool refrigerators, we started growing triple-digits. From a declining business on market share, we started growing triple-digits, and we have continued to do that from October '23 right through to December '24.

And lastly on front-loading, obviously there is growth versus a year ago, pretty good growth, but that's because the base for our front-loading washing machine is quite small. And we see significant opportunities on that going forward.

So net-net, all our categories have been in strong growth, not just for the last quarter, but for the last two, three quarters. This is the same if you look across regions as well, two different extents, but all our regions, whether it's north, south, east or west, is growing as well.

For me, what this actually tells us, and this is what makes us very happy about the results that we have is that it's not just about the numbers, but the quality of the number, that it's growing in every direction. And for me, that does not mean that it's just about one or two categories, it's about consistent growth across categories,

consistent growth across geographies, that augurs well for two things. One is the Whirlpool brand name, and I think Whirlpool is back. And the second thing is our organization, and absolutely our organization seems to be performing at the level that we'd love to see it perform in the future as well. Next slide, please.

Let's move on now to gross margin, Slide Number 11. In 2021, '21-'22 and 2022-'23, we were declining gross margin versus the previous year by a reasonably substantial amount. The correction started in '23-'24 in the first half of the year, with our cost productivity programs fully in place. And you can now see that over the last 15 months we have grown our margin versus last year by more than 220 basis points, which is leading us to the profit growth. Next slide, please.

We are also very happy with the work we have been able to do on inventory, on payables and receivables, because working capital is a very good indication of how operationally strong we are. We can see in March and September '22 we were operating at a positive net working capital as a percentage of net revenue. These are all published numbers. March '23 and September '23 as well, very similar. But in Page 5 of 30

March '24 and September '24, you can see the substantially lower net working capital that we have been able to bring in, which also helps us from a cash point of view. And also from a general operational point of view, it also kind of hints to you, and I can tell you that inventory is also an important part of this, it also hints to you at the work we have been able to do on demand forecasting, and being able to come up with much better operational efficiency. Next slide, please.

So that is one of the b

usiness that I wanted to give you a perspective. I will now move on to the strategic imperatives. Slide Number 14, please. Our strategic imperatives are; inspire generations with our brands, win with product leadership, excellence in execution, building a competitive and resilient supply chain, and growing a consumer direct business.

Let us take a look at it one by one.

Starting with inspiring with our brands, you are free to click on the link that is embedded in your presentations. This is our frost free television campaign that we have aired in select states. I would really request you to take a look at this campaign. We are very happy with it. We are very proud of the campaign. And we are also happy with the initial results that we are getting out of it. Next slide, please.

But it is not just refrigerators that we have been able to do some good stuff on the brand's work, it is also on washing machines. As you know, we work together with one of the great consumer companies of India, Unilever, to come up with a penetration driving campaign which drives penetration of washing machines and liquid detergents going forward. And there is joint marketing associated with it, which includes the TV campaign, sampling, and on-pack endorsement. And this has started as well. Again, the link is there in the presentation for you to have a look at. And this copy, this TV commercial communication has been on air since the middle of last year.

But that is not all we have done on inspiring with brands. Move to the next slide, please. On slide number 17, we are so confident of the products that we have that on semi-automatic washing machines we decided to give a four year comprehensive warranty on semi-automatic washing machines which gives us a good advantage over many brands in the market. We are able to do this because we strongly believe in the product quality that we deliver. On the success of the semi-automatic washing machine warranty, we were able to extend this to the front-load fully automatic washers, offering a five-year comprehensive warranty on these washers. All these inspire trust with our brands, and make the Whirlpool name even stronger in the market. Next slide, please.

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Moving on to product leadership, slide number 18. We have launched new direct cool glass door range. As you can see there, there is our beautiful design, they look absolutely beautiful in the market, appreciated by consumers, appreciated by the trade. We are very proud of the fact that these ranges are fully the glass door for this was happened after the new regulatory regime was introduced. And all these glass doors are completely made in India. And this is part of our contribution to the whole Atmanirbar Bharat, Make in India, develop in India and do in India. And we are very proud of the fact that these glass doors have been developed in India and brought into the market by us. And we look forward to these glass door ranges giving us a lot of good solid ground in 2025. Next slide, please.

If you look at slide number 19, the other example of something that we have brought in which is a real innovation is the introduction of the dynamix detergent

dispenser in the semi-automatic washing machines. Typically, people would look at semi-automatic washing machines and say, not much innovation can happen in this segment, it is not very high technology compared to front-load, o

r fully automatic

top-load washing machines. Well, we have brought in some good technology into this. This dynamix technology that we have brought has hydrodynamic ■ns in the washing machine that mix the powder detergent that is used with water before it goes on to the clothes so efficiently that no detergent coagulation happens. And therefore, you end up with zero detergent patches, not 0.1, but zero detergent patches. And that is something we are very, very proud of. Watch out for more on this place. Next slide, please.

We move on to the third parameter, excellence in execution and creating a consumer-centric service organization. Our aim as I said before has been always to win every day in every store with every consumer. We have invested significant amounts in the front-end capability and capacity, be it service or be it sales. We have put in a lot of work to ensure great execution, driving our premiumization goals, including ensuring much stronger visibility of our premium lines and our new ranges. We have made sure that we are dynamically always looking at the right pricing strategy, especially on our premium lines; but where necessary, even on our popular mass lines. And we continue to leverage our great customer relationships built by decades of giants over the last three to four decades.

If I take your attention to the right side of the screen, we are very happy that the Net Promoter Score on service continues to see an improvement. You can see in that graph Net Promoter Score starting from middle of 2021 to literally today, and you can see that graph is going in one direction. At some point in time, I guess, this is not going to go up anymore because this looks pretty close to 100, not too far away. But we are quite happy about that, jokes apart, with the way we have been able to

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inspire trust in our consumers, in our trade colleagues, with our service partners, and so on and so forth. Next slide, please.

And then, of course, the Productivity for Growth program that I mentioned. This has been key to driving improvement in our margins. First, the Productivity for Growth program is a huge exercise that we do. It's a regular systematic program that covers all lines of the P&L. And we have had significant step-up in the material cost productivity actions, but also in several non-material cost productivity actions, driving overall efficiency in the P&L. We are also delighted to announce that we achieved a Silver WCM, World Class Manufacturing Standards, in our factory in Pune. And our other two sites are already at Bronze for World Class Manufacturing, which are the sites in Faridabad and in Puducherry. Next slide, please.

With that, I would like to hand over to Mr. Aditya Jain for the financial performance.

Aditya Jain: Thank you, Mr. Eswar. My name is Aditya Jain, and I will talk about the financial performance of the company. I am on Slide 23. On this slide, we will talk about what are three financials on a standalone basis.

In this quarter, our revenue grew by 12%. The double-digit growth in revenue was driven by multiple factors. The first and the foremost one was the strong market share improvement which we have witnessed in ref and washers. Mr. Eswar has already explained the factor which has driven this market share improvement, so I will not delve again into it.

The second factor is the relatively better industry growth which we hav

e seen during

the festival months of October and November. And the third factor is the segment premiumization, that is a continuous focus on driving premium side of the business and ensuring that our revenue grows ahead of the volume growth.

In this quarter, we have delivered an EBITDA of Rs. 44 crores, that's a growth of 13.5% versus a year ago. In this quarter, we had taken a provision of Rs. 15 crores on account of additional e-waste expense. This is to account for the new e-waste credit rates which have been notified by the new E-Waste Regulations. And without this additional impact of Rs. 15 crores, our operational EBITDA grew by 52% versus a year ago.

On PBT, we delivered a PBT of Rs. 36.5 crores in this quarter. That represents a handsome growth of 65% versus a year ago. The PBT improvement was driven by the strong top-line growth which adds to the DCM. The cost productivity actions across technical projects as well as commercial negotiations resulting into an improved gross-margin of 200 plus basis points, better pricing, and improved mix. I spoke

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about the additional provisions on account of e-waste, and without the impact of that additional provision of Rs. 15 crores, our PBT grew by 132% versus a year ago in this quarter.

On Slide 24, this slide talks about the consolidated performance for quarter three.

On consolidated level, again, we saw a top-line growth of 11%, which was a double-digit top-line growth. Our EBITDA came in at Rs. 69 crores which was a growth of 11% versus a year ago. But without the additional impact of e-waste accruals, our EBITDA grew by 35% versus a year ago. And PBT came in at Rs. 59 crores which represents a growth of 40% versus a year ago. And without the additional impact of e-waste, our PBT grew by 77% versus a year ago. On Elica, the business continues to do well, and deliver a healthy double-digit profit margin.

The next two slides are Slide 25 and Slide 26, those two covers the nine months financial performance on standalone and consolidated basis. Mr. Eswar has already explained and spoken about the nine months results, so I will not repeat the same, but I will pause on the slides for a couple of minutes for you to have a look at the numbers.

With this, we have also received one question, and the question was about the increase in employee cost over the last two quarters. And the answer is that the increase in employee cost is on account of two factors. The first one is the investment in retail executives, that is the front-end capacity and capability build which we have done to augment our offtakes, and which has translated to a market share gain. This is a financial ROI-based decision and we track the productivity of these decisions on a monthly and quarterly basis. And the second reason for the increase in employee cost is the higher bonus accruals on account of the significantly improved financial performance versus last year.

With this, I will hand it over to Mr. Peters.

James Peters: Hello. This is Jim Peters, CFO of Whirlpool Corporation. And good evening, everyone.

And before we open the call to questions, I just wanted to share a few comments with our investors.

We view this anticipated sell-down as a win-win for Whirlpool of India and Whirlpool Corporation. It provides Whirlpool of India with increased flexibility, enabling it to focus on accelerated growth and delivering initial

tives to drive

long-term sustained growth, at the same time while Whirlpool Corporation maintains its focus on margin expansion. The proposed sell-down is not expected to have any impact on Whirlpool of India's business continuity, as we intend to

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enter into long-term brand and tech agreements with Whirlpool of India, in addition to transition commitments.

Furthermore, Whirlpool of India can more independently utilize its well-funded business to make strategic investments that fuel its long-term growth potential, in which Whirlpool Corporation has very high confidence.

With that, I am happy to answer any questions you may have.

Roopali Singh: Thank you, Mr. Eswar, Mr. Jain, and Mr. Peters. I would now request the moderator to please open up the Q&A session.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now start with the Q&A session. The first question is from Naushad Chaudhary from Aditya Birla Sun Life. Please go ahead.

Naushad Chaudhary: Yes. Hi, thank you so much for the opportunity, and I congratulate the India team for what we have achieved in the last one year. Now with all the efforts we have re-energized the business, we are growing and gaining market share in India. The productivity improvement is reflecting at the gross margin expansion level. But below that, we have a concern, by when do you think the productivity initiative which you have taken should fall below gross margin as well because there are other two line items, your stable costs and other expenses. The inefficiency, if I compare it with the India peers, are meaningfully high, especially on the stable costs. So, what do you think on this and how will you improve on these two cost lines to get the margin back at EBITDA level?

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you very much for your questions. I mean, one point I just wanted to highlight is that we have just talked about where we are investing our monies. We are investing it into things that are driving ROI within the year. So if you take a look at the financials, we have improved our gross margin by 220 basis points. At the bottom line level, the PBT has increased by 210 basis points.

While some of the costs are increased, that cost is actually reflected directly in the market share gains. The market share gains and the premiumization is being driven by those cost increases. That's what is actually leading to the market share growth. And as we get more and more scale, that should start looking better and better for

us.

Naushad Chaudhary: So, by when and at what scale do you think you would come at par of India, other peers' efficiency on our, stable cost?

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Narasimhan Eswar: That's a little difficult for me to judge and the reason is because as I look at other reported data of the past that has been reported, I do not see the same necessarily progression in all players over reported numbers. In some cases, the sales growth can be higher. The profit growth is lower. In some cases, the sales growth is not much higher but the profit growth can be a little higher. So we are following our strategy. We are following our strategy which is making sure that we are adding value to the top-line and making sure that the bottom line is also progressing at the same time.

If you take a look at the profit increase over the last year, like I said for the nine months ended December 31, 2024, we have grown PBT by 100% versus last year. So I

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ould love to get, if possible, some color on exactly what the concern would be or what the expectation would be, or what is in your mind when you say peers because I am not able to follow the detail behind the question.

Naushad Chaudhary: So, typically, for most of the durable companies, if you look at their stable cost versus revenue, it falls between 6.5% to 8%. So a lot of our EBITDA margin, I think, goes into stable cost. So there is a clear cut we have inefficiency in terms of the overall stable cost load. I think I would urge you to look at how peers are operating on this cost line item. That should, I think, help us to understand where are we lacking from an inefficiency point of view, especially on the stable cost?

Narasimhan Eswar: All right, we can certainly take a look at it. I just want to reinforce the numbers for April to December. The revenue growth is 17%, and the PBT growth is 100%, with a gross margin improvement of 220 basis points versus last year. And like I said, we are using our stable costs in such a way as to drive the top-line in the market share. Please do keep in mind that we are so far concentrated on refrigerators and washing machines. This is a market that has grown in single-digits on average in these nine months. If you take the total number, it will be in single-digits. So we have grown 17%, which means we have substantially improved our market share position. I do not want to go too much into the market share, but I am sure, sir, you have access to the market shares. You can take a look at what has happened to our positions and market shares in multiple categories, direct cool refrigerators, for example, top-load washing machines. And that has come through very, I would say, efficient deployment of resources. These resources are there for us to continue our scale. This is what, part of what has basically driven our momentum.

And just to give you the reassurance, we track this performance on a, actually on a daily basis, we get the reports of how it's doing in terms of offtake, in terms of if I put in a buck, how much I am getting out of it. We then look at it consolidated on a monthly basis, on a quarterly basis, on a yearly basis. So just to reiterate, we take a look at what you are seeing and then maybe for next time we can have a further

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detailed analysis on this. But our intent is how we are driving our business is that we have got a revenue growth of 17% with significant market share gains in triple-digits continuously over the last three quarters. All the while delivering a profit growth of 100% versus a year ago.

Naushad Chaudhary: Sure sir.

Narasimhan Eswar: However I am utilizing, how I utilize that, so long as we are delivering that profit growth is what we are really focused on. But we can, for the next time, maybe and for the next six months, take a look at even deeper dive into peer comparisons, et cetera, if there is any point to be examined there.

Naushad Chaudhary: Sure, sir.

Hi, Chanchal here, our colleague. Congratulations on a good set of numbers and congratulations on gaining market share. As the third largest shareholder of Whirlpool, the team is very impressed, and we would like to congratulate you on what performance you have delivered in the last six to 12 months.

My question is to the global CFO. Now, India being a market where we are the largest population of the world

, we are the youngest population of the world, and in

India, Whirlpool is a strong brand. You are saying by selling 30%, you retain the flexibility, and Indian team will have more flexibility to do what they want. We just want to question here, I mean, by selling 30%, how can you retain the maximum shareholding rights of our Indian entity? Because the money which you will gain

from this, you will use the money for your global needs. Your global fund may require money, but then by selling down 30%, where are your commitment to Indian market? Because if you are committed to Indian population, to Indian market, to Indian growth, why will you, for your global requirement, sell 30% more and want to retain a strategic stake?

James Peters: Yes, no, and I appreciate the question. And, first of all, we believe that Whirlpool Corporation, moving from a majority ownership to a meaningful minority best serves Whirlpool of India. As you mentioned in there, in that the proposed sell-down does increase the flexibility for Whirlpool of India to continue to adjust to the ever-evolving industry and business there. At the same time, Whirlpool of India will have a long-term brand and licensing, technology licensing agreement with Whirlpool that will benefit the business there, and we will remain committed to that.

I think the thing that's most important to understand here is that the India stock market is focused on rewarding growth, as they should be, and specifically within Page 12 of 30

consumer-focused sectors like household appliances, and given the future, as you highlighted, the future appliance penetration expectations and the potential of this business to grow and expand share. Whirlpool Corporation U.S. shareholders view the appliance business through a U.S. lens as a mature industry, and that's given the high household penetration in other parts of the world.

At this time, we really do believe the right path is for Whirlpool of India to focus on growth and Whirlpool Corporation to focus on margin expansion. Again, we believe in the long-term prospects of this business at this time, but also, as you talk about, what we would do with the proceeds in that, listen, this business, as we have talked about and you have heard in the call here, the financial health of this business is very strong, and that's the thing that also

Naushad Chaudhary: Sorry to interrupt you, if I may. What kind of flexibility will Indian team get, which they do not have when you retain the 50%? And the second thing is your long-term commitment gets diluted when you are selling 30%?

James Peters: Yes. So the flexibility that the Indian team has is the ability to make decisions on where best to invest and when to invest and what growth initiatives they want to focus on. And again, this will now put the decision-making completely in their hands without the oversight of Whirlpool that has to balance the needs of U.S. shareholders and Indian shareholders with Whirlpool Corporation being more focused on margin expansion. As I said our remaining commitment of the 20% still very meaningful. But we will remain committed longer term with brand and licensing agreements.

Naushad Chaudhary: Sorry, just to complete this. We do not think that with 20% your commitment to Indian market remains, and the flexibility we have seen with many multinationals listed in India, Indian team if they are given more flexibility th

ey can deliver, and

it's a huge market. That's what we wanted to state. You can move to the second question, thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. Next question is from line of Ankur Sharma from HDFC Life Insurance. Please go ahead.

Ankur Sharma: Yes good evening. Thanks for your time. So two questions. One to Eswar. So clearly a great job on market share gains, and that's quite evident in the way your top-line has grown and I go back to the margin question especially at the EBITDA level. The last time when we had a sell-down from the parent, we met you and you said high single-digit, maybe around that 8%, 9% margin at the EBITDA level is something that you probably will kind of be at. So how much time before we get there? Even if I Page 13 of 30

adjust for this provision, your second quarter margins are at about 3.5%. So when do you think we get back to these high single-digit EBITDA margins?

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you for your question Mr. Sharma. Yes, we had set our long term goal. This is what we had said, long term goal, and we had set it to be a multi-year goal, very clearly at that point in time as well. We said we would like to progress. Just to remind you, everyone on the call, we had set high single-digit growth in revenues. And long term margins which would be in the high single-digit. I think we could only do things one step at a time. If you can just appreciate we were in a situation where our revenues were not growing, our revenues were actually flat, our profits were declining significantly, and our market share was going down significantly, amongst other things.

As I said, it takes time to turn ship around. I think the ship has clearly turned around now. We should start seeing hopefully consistent revenue growth in line

with what we have said now. There's also a factor that is the market, obviously depends on the market, if the market starts growing fantastically then we are going to benefit from that. Our focus firstly is on driving the market share because that is something completely in our control. The market is in control to the extent of seasonality. We have a fantastic hot season, then it helps us, the refrigerator and air conditioner markets a lot. Refrigerators we play in a very significant way, air conditioners so far not so much. However, we will try to continue to drive our market shares strongly upwards. We have also demonstrated to you very clearly, I hope, that we have made improvements on every aspect of the line of the P&L.

All costs are being controlled very tightly and any costs that are being incurred, we are making sure there is a very strong ROI, which is why you are seeing the profit growth and the revenue growth happening simultaneously, not one at the expense of the other. So what we are driving for as a strategy is profitable market share growth. That is what we are driving. I do not have a time frame to give you at this point in time as to when we will get to that, but our intent is to progress steadily and strongly towards that goal. I do not have a time frame to give you that. I had said multi-year and that still continues to be the guidance.

Ankur Sharma: Okay, fair. And just a feedback/question to the parent, the CFO who is there on the call on the parent stake sell-down. Because when we sold it down last time around and we brought it down to 51%, I think the

general understanding was that the parent would probably keep it there, and not sell down further. So obviously going to 20% was a little bit of a surprise for us. But more importantly, how exactly will that be done? Is the parent also looking at a strategic sale to a financial investor, given you need to obviously sell almost \$0.5 billion of stock here, and absorbing that kind of supply is going to be very, very difficult if you sell it in the market. So are

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you also exploring a strategic sale to a financial partner? Is that also on the table? And how do we get confidence that Whirlpool does not completely sell out eventually? I think those are two questions I have.

James Peters: Yes, no, and I appreciate. And while we have not, we have not analyzed the details of this, we will continue to assess all options in the sell-down process, ensure that we proceed with what we expect to be the best value creating opportunity for Whirlpool Corporation and Whirlpool of India. In the last sell-down, we did execute it via a block trade transaction, and that approach worked well and we were pleased with the outcome. But again, we will keep all our options open in analyzing this over the coming months. And then, to your question, again, we intend, not just through our significant remaining ownership stake but also through long-term ongoing brand and technology licensing agreements as well as any transition agreements to support and continue to be invested in Whirlpool India and the growth of Whirlpool India.

Ankur Sharma: Okay, and sorry, just a follow-up there would be, we should not expect any increase in licensing/royalty arrangements, right, versus what we have as of now, given that our stake has come down below 51%. Would that be a reasonable assumption?

James Peters: Right now I cannot comment specifically on it, that would be something more with management.

Ankur Sharma: Okay. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you very much. Next question is from Bhavin Vithlani, SBI Mutual Fund. Please go ahead.

Bhavin Vithlani: Yes. So this question is to Jim. You mentioned that the sell-down will give more autonomy to the India management, and I want to understand this a bit more, because the India management decided to plow back the benefit of gross margins in terms of higher employee expenses which is in the right interest of the longer term, compromising near term for the better long term. They decided to expand the capacity when the utilization is 60%, which again I understand is in the good interest of the longer run, and a new plant of front-load washing machine. So what is the greater autonomy that the India management gets beyond this while the Whirlpool global parent reduces the stake from 51% to 20%? I fail to understand. Please help us.

James Peters: Yes. As I highlighted before, and again, I can only expand to a certain extent because this is also, things that will be executed by the Whirlpool of India Management. But as I highlighted this will allow the Whirlpool of India

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Management team and company to make strategic decisions as quickly as they possibly can, to make strategic investments in line with what they believe is in the best interest of the Whirlpool of India shareholders, and the Whirlpool of India

business. We do believe that as they do not have to be as concerned with overall Whirlpool global processes, or Whirlpool

margin requirements, this will allow

them to continue to make investments like you just highlighted, and focus on the growth longer term of this business, which we believe is the right approach, but it's different from the approach that Whirlpool Corporation shareholders expect.

Bhavin Vithlani: I am sorry, maybe, again, this same question to Eswar, if you can over the last year or so that you have been, can you give us instances where you wanted to invest, but you were not, because of the global balance sheet, or process constraints?

Narasimhan Eswar: Yes. Thank you Mr. Vithlani. To be honest I cannot get into that level of detail. What I can tell you is that there are several things which may not seem very big to many people, but there will be several small things, there is HR related things or other areas where a global corporation has certain ways of operation. And you generally, in any multinational, end up having to do some of those because it's part of a formula. And so I think what is being alluded to is potentially, and I think that is something that we have got to work out over the next few weeks and months, because we are also, as you can imagine, quite new to the information, like you. And therefore, we need to work through which are the areas in which we can actually be enabled to move much quicker.

Certainly, I think, going forward, my guess is that we will be presenting directly to the India Board and then getting the approval and carrying on, and that is absolutely what we will continue doing, as we have done so far. And I think there are probably many areas in which we can get that kind of advantage, but at this point in time, to say this is what it is or that is what is very difficult for me to kind of comment on this.

Bhavin Vithlani: Okay, the second part is when the sell-down from two, sell-down of the 24% stake was announced in February last year. And as part of the India press release, there was an 8K filing of the parent. And that was, this is Item Number 8.01, which reads that after the sell-down of the 24% outstanding of the publicly listed Whirlpool India, you will retain majority interest, majority in the India. And on a similar basis, the conference call, which was hosted, and this is, I am just reading from the transcript that one part of it is, the idea is Whirlpool Corporation will continue to hold majority interest in the company.

Now, when this assurance was given, just want to understand what is the sanctity of these assurances that being given now will also hold, because it's not even a year

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when these are part of the publicly announced, the transcripts or the 8K filings. And also, why do you want to keep, and also then why do you want to keep 20%? Why not then completely exit out to the strategic investor?

James Peters: Again, as I said before, as we looked at, right now as we look at all options, we do believe this is the best option. If you look at where we are, and again, we make continuous assessments of where we are invested, et cetera, and so I am not going to go into any of those details. What I would say is looking in terms at a strategic buyer at this time, we do believe that with the long-term technology and brand licensing agreement that we will provide, which is again back to a long-term agreement, which is probably the most important thing to support

this, that

Whirlpool Corporation can do to support this business. With that in place, we believe that a strategic transaction with another player would not make sense at this time because it would restrict the ability to use some of those things and would not be as value-creating as it is for us to provide the brand and the technology over the long-term.

Bhavin Vithlani: Okay. Thanks. These were all my questions.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Siddhant from Mirae Asset. Please go ahead.

Siddhant Chhabria: Yes, hi. So just similar questions I had, which was asked previously, and just reiterating the same thought process where we do not believe that 20% sort of shareholding would mean that there is skin in the game of the management, and ultimately, this risk execution in India business impacting employee morale, and the concern could be that given how competitive landscape it is, eventually the risk on market share. So eventually it does not give investors the comfort that a 20% shareholding and why the current parent would not eventually exit over a period of time. So just wanted to share that message again.

James Peters: Okay. I have no additional comments other than what I have said.

Siddhant Chhabria: Sure. So just secondly, I would suggest since we are now starting to host biannual

concalls, I would request, strongly suggest if we can do a quarterly concall because clearly communication has been a challenge. So that is the feedback I would like to give. Thank you.

Roopali Singh: Thank you. Your point is duly noted. I think Mr. Peter has responded to majority of the questions on the anticipated sell-down and there are several repeat questions. So with that, we would take one last question for Mr. Peter, and then request the participants to please ask questions on the business to the India management if

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you have any. Yes. Thank you. Operator, back to you to invite the next participant, please.

Moderator: Thank you very much. Next question is from Prolin Nandu from Edelweiss Public Alternatives. Please go ahead.

Prolin Nandu: Yes. Thank you for giving me this opportunity. Two questions, one is to Mr. Eswar. So again, this is on margin and while you have elaborated quite a lot on the answer to the previous question, I just wanted to understand qualitatively in terms of heavy lifting of expenses and feet on street, is it fair to say that maybe last few quarters you have done some heavy lifting in terms of cost and putting feet on street? And now every incremental Rs. 1 of revenue should ideally come at a very low or lesser incremental cost. Is that fair understanding, or do you think you still need to invest in brand at the same pace what you have done in the past few quarters to maintain the market share gain momentum that you have reported so far?

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you for that question. I just want to clarify something and maybe it is not clear, so I would like to take this opportunity to clarify. If there is an assumption that we just put people in sales on the street, and that is what is leading to the sales increase in market share, that is not true. So I just want to clarify. The signi■cant cost increase, now typically I come from the FMCG background before I joined this company. We used to invest, and that was one of the great areas of investment, in marketing. And marketing is the

art of convincing consumers to go

ahead and buy your product and be convinced in that product and become an ambassador for that product, correct?

So everybody is very excited when you look at marketing percentage of sales going up because that you know that you are investing in the brand. I want to clarify to everybody on the call and maybe I should have clarified this earlier. When I am talking about investing in retail executives, I want to help you understand what does a retail executive do? These retail executives are on the shop ■oor. They are our ambassadors for the brand. These are not people who are selling in volumes into the store. They are people who speak to customers who are coming to buy these products. Stand on the shop ■oor, convince customers to buy our products and guarantee that the sale happens from the outlet. That's where we put in quite a bit of our focus in terms of our operating costs.

So that's what I meant when I said that these costs are giving ROI within the year. It is not a guess, or a 'maybe' it is driving it. It is a 'guaranteed' it is driving it. So this is nothing for me. As a marketer, how do I create demand? There are multiple ways to create demand. One of them is to do exactly what I explained now. So we have not put in 500 people, sales people to go and sell into the stores. That's what we

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have not done. What we have done is increase the number of brand ambassadors at the shop ■oor who speak to consumers, who explain the bene■t of our products to consumers, who tell consumers why our direct cool refrigerators are a fantastic product. Why our front-load machine with ozone technology is great. Convince the consumers to buy the products with excellent rationale. There is a huge training program that we put behind it. There is a huge monitoring that we do of these people. And I dare say that we have amongst the best retail executive forces in the country.

And that is what we put our focus behind. What might help a lot is the way I look at this is anything that drives demand is marketing. So it might come into a line called sta■ cost or whatever. But what we are really doing with this is driving demand for our products. And that's why it's a direct impact. It's not the only thing. There are 25 things we have done basically. But one of the things what is driving that cost line-up is this investment on brand ambassadors in the store to drive our business. It is not on more people in the marketing department in the head o■ce or in the HR department, or in the ■nance department or any other department. The focus has been on driving consumer demand. And like I have explained before in di■erent forum, so long as I am getting a very strong ROI from that, this year and year-on-year, it behooves us to do that for our shareholders because that is sustainable and

consistent growth.

Now having answered that, as we go forward, we will continue to leverage this in other areas of demand generation because I truly believe that if you drive market shares the right way, with the right ROI investment mentality, that is the one way in which you can guarantee irrespective of what the market does, show revenue growth and show profit growth ahead of revenue growth. And if you take a look at the data that I have showed you for the last 15 months, that's what we

have been

consistently doing.

So just to kind of reassure everybody on the call because now I understand what exactly the concern is, you could look at it as the standstill cost, or you could look at it as a significant proportion being invested in driving actual demand, which means a person comes into the store, and walks out with a Whirlpool refrigerator. Now what is better marketing than that? Because the purpose of marketing is to create demand for the consumer. Long lasting demand. And because our products are good, we honestly believe that consumers go and recommend our product to other people as well.

So I hope I have given that clarity, and I think maybe I apologize because I might not have clarified that up front. Sometimes the terms that we use may not be obvious to everybody in the industry. So thank you for pointing that out. But I hope this is very

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clear that what we are doing is using many different tools and you are only seeing this tool. There are so many other different tools that we use, whether it's e-commerce ROAS, return on advertisement sales, or whether it's sales fundamental increase, or whether it's display share increase in the stores, or whether it's increasing in certain areas in promotion. So we have done all the right things that give return on investment within the year, within the quarter. And that is what is driving the business. I hope that makes sense.

Prolin Nandu: No, that makes sense, Eswar. That's it from my side. Thanks a lot, and all the very best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you so much for your question. That helped clarify, I think, from my side to everybody. And I hope even the previous questions where I was asked now, I do understand. I apologize, I do understand the intent behind the question, and I hope I have answered it very clearly. We have been investing in demand generation, full stop. That's what we have been doing.

Roopali Singh: Sure. Thank you, Mr. Eswar. Before we move to the next question, I would like to invite Mr. Peters for his closing remarks. After that, we would continue the Q&A session with the India management team.

James Peters: Thank you, Roopali. And again, thank you, everybody, for inviting me to join this evening. In closing, I just want to reinforce my confidence that now is the right time for Whirlpool of India to operate more independently. Today, we have the right leadership team in place to deliver on the continued growth plans, which I fully anticipate will create long-term value to its shareholders, including Whirlpool Corporation. We have made a lot of the right product investments in Whirlpool of India, and doing well in the marketplace.

Additionally, I just want to reinforce that Whirlpool Corporation and Whirlpool of India will continue to support each other via brand, technology, and transition agreements to ensure business continuity. And in closing, I would say I do not take this decision lightly. Having managed Whirlpool of India since 2022 on behalf of Whirlpool Corporation, I know the business potential here, and I know what this team is capable of, and I fully expect Whirlpool of India to accelerate shareholder value creation with greater independence. And again, I just want to close with saying thank you.

Roopali Singh: Thank you, Mr. Peters. With that, I would request the operator to please put the next participant for the Q&A session.

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Moderator: Thank you very much. Next question is from line of Rahul from Haitong Securities. Please go ahead.

Rahul Gajare: Yes, hi. Thanks for the opportunity. And I think on the India business, I just had one question. Whirlpool is very strong in refrigerators and washers, and in other products you have limited presence. So from here on, when we are talking about more autonomy, are there some roadmaps that you have planned in terms of more product introduction, or would you rather stick to the strongholds of refrigerators and washers, and ramp up business and market share in that category? Thank you.

Narasimhan Eswar: Fantastic question. Mr. Rahul, thank you for that question. My answer is both. So to be very honest with you, as I would also met and spoken with many people last year in the last call that we had virtually. The first job that we really had was to make sure that our business gets back on track, and gets back on momentum. I truly believe that if you do not get your base business back on momentum, to start pouring into 10 different areas confuses the organization, and makes a mess of everything.

Right now I would say not to be cocksure at all, because it's a very tough market, very tough competitive situation, a lot of challenges as always. But I think we have managed to turn the ship around. We will continue to drive this business. I think there is no doubt about what our eventual ambition is. I do not want to state it, but I think you can guess what it is. On refrigerators and washers, we would really like to do much better than we are doing even now. And I think over the next few years, we should be able to do that if we put our right thinking and strategies in place, but at least what we have now works.

Going forward, there are also opportunities in other areas like you have asked the question. And I wanted to make sure in the first 12 to 18 months that we get our base absolutely in shape. I think we are in reasonable shape now. So are there opportunities to be looking at in other areas? Definitely. Would I want to name them? Absolutely not, sir, because it's a very competitive world, and I certainly do not want to be discussing what those categories are. It is certainly of good interest to us. And I think hopefully you will start seeing some results in another six months.

Rahul Gajare: Sure. Thank you very much, and all the very best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you. Thank you, Mr. Rahul.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from Natasha Jain from PhillipCapital. Please go ahead.

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Natasha Jain: Thank you for the opportunity, and good evening, gentlemen. My question is firstly on the quarterly numbers. So your presentation and you also cited in your opening remarks that there was a very strong vested demand, which led to volume growth. That's appreciated because the market share clearly shows that. My question is, if there was such a strong growth, why is there a gross margin decline on a Q-o-Q basis?

Aditya Jain: Yes. So thanks, Ms. Jain, for your question. The gross margin decline on Q-o-Q basis is on account of seasonality, so. And October to December had the impact of the festival promotions. Diwali falls under this period and the significant relative to the prior quarter, sequentially, the promotions are higher in the festival period, and hence you see a sequential drop in gross margins. And th

e trend is similar to the

last year. If you look at the same trend in these two quarters last year, you would have seen a decline in margins. But the decline this year is lower, which indicates that year-over-year we have significantly improved our gross margins.

To summarize, like it's basically on account of higher promotions during festival seasons which happens in this quarter relative to July to September quarter, and hence you see a sequential drop of margins which is a normal trend also reflected last year as well.

Natasha Jain: Understood. So my second question is, so during Diwali season we saw one of your competitors facing a factory strike because of which products were not sold out.

Now that the player has come back in full force with a lot of aggression to get back the market share. This in conjunction with the fact that fourth quarter is not a washers quarter and washers is a high margin business. So in the near term what kind of challenges are you anticipating from this shift?

Narasimhan Eswar: I will take that question, ma'am. So thank you for the question. To be honest, there is something or the other happening with competition all the time and with us as well. Something or the other keeps happening. And I think these are all part of the game. That happens to all of us, it can happen to me this quarter, it can happen to someone else. I do not think there is any impact on what we do, or what we plan to do.

To be very honest, we have a very clear set of strategies, we have a very clear set of principles that we operate on that has led us to a decent set of results across time.

We plan to continue doing it in the same spirit. The detail of the execution might vary depending on what we need to do going forward but the strategies that we talked about, the imperatives, whether it is focusing on the consumer, it inspiring consumers with our products, inspiring consumers with our marketing, inspiring consumer with our stories at the point at which the consumer is buying the product

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through our retail executives that I mentioned where we have increased the stock price, that will continue.

Similarly, our focus on gross margins, and I think Aditya explained it very well in the last question, but I was a newcomer just two years ago to this industry. So I just want to highlight, the simple way that I would look at this industry is, always look at this industry year-on-year. Quarter-on-quarter it varies a lot, and I am not talking about us, I am talking about every company, right? It is a very seasonal business. Refrigerators sell more in the summer, air conditioners sell more in the summer, washing machines sell more after the monsoons basically. So it's very tricky to compare quarter-on-quarter and what you should always do with refrigerator business is track with the, sorry, with the durables business is look year-on-year because it is a seasonal business.

So we will continue to drive the things that we know will give us greater market share, but profitable market share, and that is our sole focus. All our effort is focused on that. To be honest, we do not get distracted by competition. We take note of what the competition does. We respect competition very much, which is very healthy, but at the same time, we really are mostly focused on what we need to do, and our whole organization focus has been

whatever we say we will do, are we

doing that to the best of our ability? If we are doing that to the best of our ability, that's the best that we can do. So long as our strategies are right, but more importantly, our execution is bang on. And that is what Whirlpool of India is focused on for the last couple of years.

Natasha Jain: Understood, sir. Sir if I may just drop one feedback. So on my channel check rounds, what I found was while the product quality has definitely improved in the last one year's time frame, we did hear a lot of complaints in terms of the packaging. So apparently the packaging quality has reduced, as a reason of which the products get damaged in transit. So have you received this feedback from channel? And if so, where are we in terms of addressing that? Thank you, and all the very best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, ma'am. It's actually a very good insight that you picked up. Yes, when I was in the market with customers a year ago, some people talked about that. We always benchmark our quality percent basically using standard techniques. We have invested significantly on the packaging quality already. And it was not that it was bad before, it was pretty good before, but now it's going to be much better. And when I say now, I mean literally now as we speak. So those changes have happened between February of 2024 to December of 2024. Quite a few of them are engineering changes which takes a lot of investment, time and effort, but we are absolutely wanting to be in our minds at least the best on quality in the marketplace. Second best does not work for us. So we are okay. We were okay being

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at the kind of top parity, but we want to move to be the best. And that's a very astute observation.

Yes, I did pick it up from customer visits. And yes, we have acted on it. And yes, the new products are in the store. And I can tell you that our numbers are, which we track extremely closely, are going absolutely in the right direction, month-after-month for the last few months. Thank you.

Natasha Jain: Great to hear that, sir. Thank you so much.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from Nirranish Jain from BNP Paribas. Please go ahead.

Nirranish Jain: Yes, hi. Thank you for the opportunity. So firstly, congratulations to the India team on the business turnaround. Sir firstly, I want to check that with the increase in the autonomy for Whirlpool India and the decision-making flexibility that we are talking about after the proposed stake sale, how are we planning to utilize the surplus cash that we have on the balance sheet? I mean, which is currently at around 15% to 16% of the market cap. So do we have any plans to increase the dividends or do buybacks in order to enhance the shareholders' value?

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you very much for that question, sir. Yes, we are rather proud of our cash-generating ability. And I think hopefully sometime in the near future, we'd also be proud of our full cash deployment ability as well. So what we have been able to do, for example, and I will just give you a small example, is we have, and this has been something that we have shared with SEBI as well, so it's public knowledge.

We are now augmenting significantly certain refrigeration capacities and products. And we are investing a very handsome amount of money for that. And that is something that will enable us to compete even

stronger in the marketplace in the coming months and quarters. That's just one example. So we had, in fact, a few years ago, part acquired the Elica brand. We continue to increase our stake in that brand as it continues to perform really well, adding beautifully to our profit margins. In a nice burgeoning industry, as we look into the next say, 10 to 20 years, we see that particular market segment growing, despite kind of current market challenges in terms of growth. But we see that segment growing because the penetration of the segment is very low. So we do see quite a few opportunities. We will not be able to utilize all of it at one time, but we have very, very clear plans, basically, which are standardized plans.

We look at whether its capacity augmentation is required of certain lines, whether it is adding new lines which are producing completely new products, brilliant new
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products that will serve the Indian consumer even better, or whether We are looking at further investments in different areas of businesses. Or, for example, we could even look at options of inorganic growth, which in the last two years, to be honest, we did not do because I told you we had a ship to turn around, and that's what our focus was on.

But going forward, can we look at other ships? It's always a lovely thought, a tempting thought. Maybe not in the immediate future because, as you can imagine, we have a lot on our plate. We need to keep our business growing with strong momentum as we have now. We need to make sure that we are also navigating the change that we have across the next months, and keep everything going on that keel. But then going forward, there will be further opportunities for us to look at cash and see how best it can serve Whirlpool of India and its shareholders.

Nirransh Jain: Sure, sir. Sir, secondly, like as Mr. James also mentioned that Whirlpool Corporation is looking to get into a long-term licensing and tech agreement as part of this transition. So just wanted to check what is the probability that the royalty fees can be revised further, as in, like, increased further from these levels? So, and in case, like, it gets increased, so shouldn't this actually get lowered considering that the stake has come down from 75% to 20% now? So just wanted to get your thoughts whether we should look at it as a further risk in terms of royalty getting increased from here on?

Narasimhan Eswar: Sir, I would not at all be able to comment on this because that is not for me to say. I am, as you know very well, a Whirlpool of India Limited Managing Director. I cannot speak for the Whirlpool Corporation. And I am so sorry, but I will not be able to really give you any sensible answer to this question.

I think the answer was provided by Mr. Peters, and what he said is what stands. Because that's more a Whirlpool of Corporation thought process. And if there is any thought process that then comes, then we will go through the normal, usual, proper process, as far as the Whirlpool of India Limited Company is concerned, which is, there is a very good, strong Board that we have, which helps us take the right decisions. And of course, if there is any further consultation to be done, the Whirlpool of India Board will advise us to do that, and we will do the right process. So I am so sorry, but I am not able to answer

the question because I do not genuinely know how to answer this.

Nirransh Jain: Sure, sir, understood. Lastly, on my part, so I wanted to check on the trade discounting. So generally in FY '24, I think trade discounting had remained similar versus last year. So I wanted to check how has the trend been so far in the nine months, in terms of trade discounting as percentage of sales?

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Aditya Jain: We have kept our trade discounting percentage roughly at the same levels. That number has not significantly changed. The endeavor is to keep the trade spends more or less flat. We have been investing a lot of money, as Mr. Eswar has explained, in terms of demand generation. That is where most of the investments have gone, but trade spends have largely remained the same.

Nirransh Jain: Sure, sir. That is it from my side and all the best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, Mr. Nirransh.

Moderator: Thank you. Next question is from the line of Umang Mehta from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Umang Mehta: Yes. Hi. Thanks for the opportunity. I just needed some, if you can share something factual, as in your terms, current terms or agreement on royalty and technical know-how, are they revised annually or when are the next renewal dates? If you can share, this is a factual question.

Narasimhan Eswar: Sir, I think, I just need to check, but I think whatever it is, the royalty and technical fees et cetera is published in the last annual report, if I am correct?

Roopali Singh: Yes. So the current agreements are obviously in place and the amounts that we are paying out are duly recorded in the financial statements. Modifications, if any, that would come in, if they come in, would obviously, like Mr. Eswar just pointed out, go through the governance framework and the mechanism that is there, that Audit Committee kind of reviews it, and goes to the Board of Directors. And if whatever necessary approvals are required to be obtained, would be obtained, and the details that are required to be shared out would be shared out.

Umang Mehta: Okay. Got it. And the second question was on margins. So as we stand today, spot prices were to remain where they are, and the thrust you are seeing at the premium and continue. Would you be confident that gross margins will continue to expand like they have this year? So when we think about next year, would you say that's a fair statement?

Narasimhan Eswar: Sir, I think it's a very good question. However, I would love to know the answer to this question myself. And what I mean by that is, as you know very well, it's not just about premiumization. There's a lot of other things that are happening. There is commodity price increases that could happen or decreases that could happen. Oil prices could go up or it could go down. The dollar movement is also another thing. What happens with other currencies with respect to the Indian rupee, with respect to component costs and detailed stuff that we buy. So there is a ton of things.

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What I can assure you is that this organization is spending all its time figuring out how to optimize every cost to our productivity for growth program. And obviously, I will tell you the golden rule that I would like to follow is revenue growth, which is good. Profit growth, which is ahead of revenue growth. And the profit growth is driven by market share growth. And that is done profitably. This is the kind of formula

that

we like to do.

And I truly believe that gross margin improvement is something that's at the corner of this strategy. That's how, frankly, I grew up running business. Grow your revenues. Grow your gross margins. Take some of your gross margins, put it into what we call marketing, what here we call state cost, but it's actually marketing. Put it into stuff that drives your demand, and put some of it back into profit. And that is simply the formula that we are following. So will I be focused on gross margin? Absolutely, like a hawk. Can I guarantee the gross margin will be this or that? Absolutely not, because it's so difficult to figure out what's happening next month, let alone next quarter, next year.

So I can assure you, our investors and our shareholders and our future investors, that we are on it. You've seen the data. The only thing I can let is let the data do the talking. 15 months, we have grown the gross margin by 220 basis points versus a year ago. That's the data in front of you. Anything else I say is irrelevant because you can look at that and say, answer yourself, maybe do these people have the capability to drive the margin? I hope I answered your question.

Moderator: Thank you. So the line for the participant dropped. We move on to the next participant. Next question is from line of Shrinidhi from HSBC. Please go ahead.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Hi. Thank you for the opportunity. And apologies for yet another question related to sell-down. Sir, may I ask, was this decision taken in consultation with India management team, or it was a largely parent's decision?

Narasimhan Eswar: No, sir. It absolutely was not taken in line with India. It is not possible, actually, if you can imagine.

Roopali Singh: Sorry. Maybe I will come in. You will appreciate that the holding company is ultimately a shareholder, and the holding company takes its decision, such decisions on its own without any consultation, obviously, with the India management.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Understood. Thank you for clarification. Sir, second question is related to how are employees at the leadership level, at your level and level below you, are taking

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these decisions, and are you seeing incremental attrition at the company at the senior levels?

Narasimhan Eswar: So, see it is a significant change that we are going through, that's a fact. It's a significant change, it's not a minor thing that you can say, oh yes, whatever, let's carry on. So, we will carry on. But having said that, any change goes through a process of change management. And we are right now not even five or six days from the announcement, five working days from the announcement. Our primary focus right now is speaking with our employees first, making sure our employees understand to whatever extent we have the information, understand why the decision is being taken, and what does it mean for us, how we can benefit, and so

on and so forth.

We are speaking to our employees at every level, at many levels I would say personally to people, and making sure that our employees are, to the extent that they can, feeling clear about what the future could be, and what the future might hold, with the limited at this point in time amount of information we have regarding the change. Because as you just heard from Mr. Peters, many things need to be sorted out, the long-term license agreement, the long-term

tech agreement,

the transition support, all of that stuff.

So, firstly, that's what we have done with our employees. We have done the same with trade colleagues that we work with, the big customers, trade people that we work with, done the same with our service partners, we have done the same with pretty much everybody, including with you now. So, this is the process that we are going through, but with the employees you can imagine it's a much more involved process, firstly.

And secondly, I think what is important is, I would like, and this is what the leadership team and I actually discussed is, we went through this last year, okay? Not this, but we went through a sale last year as an organization, and I would only ask the investor community and the shareholder community and all our well-wishers to only think of one thing. 25%, 24% stake sale happened last year. Now, that was not a walk in the park either, it was a pretty impressive stake sale. But look at what we were able to do as an organization, and that is the importance of not getting distracted. We were able to gather together, work on the goals that we said we need to work on, keep our eyes focused on what we need to do. And we were able to deliver in that same period when that stake sale happened, I think it happened in February if I am not wrong, February or March.

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And basically, if you see from April to December, where we should have been theoretically most distracted and messed up, we ended up delivering a growth like I told you of 17% versus the previous year, and 100% in profit versus the previous year. So, I think it's very simple, we have got to stay focused on what we need to do, and that's what I think the leadership team is wanting to do. And like I said, we are in touch with our employees and talking to them, but we can only use the past to hopefully be the predictor of the future.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Great. And sir, the last one, if I may. In terms of medium-term targets, when you say high single-digit growth EBIT and high single-digit EBITDA margin, I was just wondering at the management level, do you see this whole washer, this refrigerator category, including the premiumization tailwind and the penetration tailwind, do you see this industry as a, at the best high single-digit growth industry at India?

Narasimhan Eswar: No, sir, that's not the intent. Like I clarified before, high single-digit revenue growth is what we said we'd do. And the reason we say that is because market goes through ups and downs. So if you see the market growth this year, as I showed you in one of the charts, though I did not share the numbers for obvious reasons, but did share the kind of trend. Sometimes it's flatish, sometimes the market grows by double-digits, and sometimes it grows by single-digits. So on average, if you see the market growth itself, that's not running in the double-digit kind of growth from a volume perspective, right?

Then on top of that, what we then add on is the market share growth. So at this point in time, this guidance we had given last year, we may take a look going forward as to whether we want to look at that, keep that, change that. That is something that we will consider as we go forward. At this point in time, I would not be giving any guidance different to the above.

Having said that, I want to clarify again, EBIT being high single-digit consistently

we

have said is a long-term goal, and I think it's not possible for anybody to just jump from one EBIT number to another. You can do that if you do not care about revenue and you just want to cut costs, but I do not believe that a market like India is best served by operating like that. There's a right combination of revenue growth driven by market share growth and some amount of market growth, hopefully. At the same time, margin growth, which results in profit growth. And if the profit growth is ahead of the margin growth, then the business is marching in the right direction for us.

That is what we will be focusing on.

Shrinidhi Karlekar: Thank you for answering my questions. All the very best.

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Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you very much. Ladies and gentlemen, we have come to the end of the allotted time. With this, I now hand the conference over to Ms. Roopali Singh for closing comments.

Roopali Singh: Thank you, everyone, for joining in. A big thank you to Mr. Eswar and Mr. Jain as well for providing all the business context. With that, we would close out the meeting.

Thank you once again for joining in today.

Moderator: Thank you very much. On behalf of Whirlpool of India Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you for joining us, and you may now disconnect your lines. Thank you.

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Call: Feb 2026

February 16, 2025
The Manager
Listing Department
BSE Limited
Phiroze Jeejeebhoy Towers
Dalal Street, Mumbai,
Maharashtra - 400001

Scrip Code: 500238 The Manager
Listing Department
National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block G,
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East,
Mumbai, Maharashtra – 400051

Symbol: WHIRLPOOL

Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Transcript of the Conference Call for Investors/ Analyst for Q3 FY 2025-26

This is further to our intimation letter dated February 3, 2026 and February 10, 2026 wherein we had informed the schedule of the Conference Call, please find enclosed herewith a copy of the transcript of the Conference Call of the Company held on February 12, 2026. The same will also be uploaded on the Company's website at <https://india.whirlpool.in/?sc=1>.
Yours faithfully,
For Whirlpool of India Limited

Sweta Srivastava
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Plot No. 40, Sector 44,
Gurugram, Haryana

Encl: as above

1
Whirlpool India Limited
Q3 Financial Year 2026 Analyst Call
February 12, 2026

Moderator: Ladies and Gentlemen, Good Day and Welcome to the Analyst Call of Whirlpool of India Limited.

We wish to inform you that all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during the conference call, please signal the moderator by pressing “*” and then “0” on your touchtone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded.
I now hand the conference over to Ms. Sweta Srivastava, Company Secretary. Thank you and over to you ma'am.

Sweta Srivastava: Good Evening, Ladies and Gentlemen. We Welcome You to Whirlpool India's Analyst Call for the 3rd Quarter for the Financial Year-ended 2025-26.

Along with me, we have the Chairman of the Board – Mr. Arvind Uppal, Mr. Narasimhan Eswar – Managing Director and Mr. Aditya Jain – Chief Financial Officer of the Company, also joining the call.

A Presentation on the Business and Financial Results of the Company is available on the website of the Company as well as the stock exchange.

Before we move forward, I would like you to remind of the cautionary statement that forms part of the presentation. During this call, certain forward-looking statements may be made. These forward-looking statements are based on certain expectations, assumptions and other factors which may affect the business results. Please read the cautionary statement carefully and the contents of this call should be interpreted accordingly.

With that, I would now like to hand it over to Mr. Eswar.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you very much, Sweta. First, I would just like to introduce myself. I am Narasimhan Eswar – Managing Director of the Company. I would like to welcome you to this Analyst Call. Thank you for taking out your time and joining us.

Let me get on with the "Presentation." If I could ask you to please go to the section that basically has the agenda. There are three agenda items.

2 The slide that says agenda is Business Overview, Strategic Imperatives and Financial Performance."

I will be "Covering the Business Overview of the Strategic Imperatives," and my colleague, "Mr. Aditya Jain will Cover the Financials."

If you can just go to the slide that says "Signed Long-Term Contracts." So, Slide Number 6. The first thing that we would like to highlight is that we call it "Secure the Future of Whirlpool of India Limited." And we have been able to do that because we have signed transaction agreements with Whirlpool Corporation for the long term. Now this was already placed into the market on the 16th of October 2025, but I am just highlighting this. This is the first time that I am speaking to a large group of analysts post that transaction.

Now, what does it actually consist of? It comprises the following: Firstly, the Brand License Agreement or the BLA. We have e

xclusive rights to use the Whirlpool brand in our territory for 30-years and the royalty rates are extremely competitive. These have already been shared with you.

What is important is that we have got this for a slightly expanded set of markets. So, that is also helpful for us as we look towards the next 30 years. And the good news is that at the end of 30 years, we can have an option between us and Whirlpool Corporation to renew for another 10-years at a time into eternity.

The second part that we have been able to secure, which we are very happy about, is we have got the brand, but what about the technology? So, we have worked out a technological license agreement with the Whirlpool Corporation of the US to make sure we have access to current and future technology for major domestic appliances.

So, these are in categories that we are currently covering and they are also in a couple of categories that we are not currently covering. But the intent in refrigeration and washers basically, and the intent will be to make sure that we have all the very best technology available to us going forward. On this one, we basically have it 10-years. For the next 10-years, it is up and then after that, it is up to us category-by-category to renew it five years at a time. So, this is even more good because we have the option to ask for the technology to be renewed five years at a time after 10-years if we need it. But if we feel we do not need it, then we do not need to take the technology. We can use our own technology. So, it is a very flexible technology access agreement that guarantees us access to world-class technology.

The third part of this agreement is basically the "Transitional Service Agreement." Now, as you all know, typically, companies have a TSA that could be somewhere between six months to 18-months long. Given the unique nature of this transaction, we have worked out with Whirlpool Corporation written agreement that this will continue for us till March 2029. That is three years 3 and four months from the date of signing of this agreement, which we feel is an advantage, because if the timing had been very short, then we would have had to kind of scramble to figure out how to get to our own systems of working going forward. But now we have plenty of time to sit back, think through really well, what do we need to keep in the current systems, what do we need to delete, what do we need to modify, what do we need to add on? So, we have enough opportunity for us to work out something really strong for us in the next three and a half years.

Lastly, on the "Service Agreements":

There has been a comprehensive service agreement also detailed now. We were taking some services from Corporation. Corporation was taking some services from us. All of those have been clearly called out in the service agreements.

One of the most critical things is that we were servicing the Global Technology Center, which we call G-Tech. And that service agreement will continue until March 2029 to enable us to get to continuity and then adjust it as we go forward.

Next slide, please. So, now moving on to the "Business Results," which was the other part that we will discuss of Q3 '25-26:

I am now talking only Whirlpool of India Limited standalone results. At a very top-line level, I think we have been able to sustain market shares in what was quite a competitive market. A weak industry, but a competitive industry nevertheless, while growing profitability. We have grown our revenue by 4% versus last year in a relatively weak industry environment driven by weakness in refrigerators and air conditioners.

We are very, very proud of our productivity for growth through the P4G cost takeout program that led to delivery of 30%-plus gross margin. With the result that our EBITDA growth is 47% versus last year and our profit before tax, before exceptional items, which is basically the new wage code that has been introduced,

the profit before tax is 32% growth versus last year for Whirlpool of India standalone without Elica.

We are happy to see all the positive results come through from our ROI-based investments, which we use as our mantra.

And lastly, operationally also, we seem to be doing the right thing so far. Working capital is quite healthy. We are again at a negative net working capital this quarter. And so that makes it four out of the last six quarters that we have had negative net working capital.

Next slide, please. Moving on to Slide Number 8, it just shows you the numbers stacked up. The left part of the slide is basically standalone revenue growth versus last year, and the right part 4 is standalone PBT before exceptional items versus last year. So, you can see in AMJ, what actually happened was, we were minus-3 on revenue, minus-2.8 on revenue, and our profits were flat in AMJ. In July-August-September, we were minus-5 in revenue and profits were down significantly, minus-50 versus last year. In October-November-December, we were at 3.8 on revenue and we were up 32% on profit.

So, again, we keep focusing on trying to do what we can with a couple of critical things that happened between the April-September period I would say. One is quite significant market decline on refrigerators, especially direct-cool refrigerators. And the second one is, of course, extremely heavy competition, unseen kind of levels of price reductions that were happening in the market, which we did not necessarily follow all the time.

Next slide, please. So, this is the chart that I keep presenting in every session. But the way we have kind of worked it right now is to show a long-term picture. As you can see, the last row of this chart is our volume share. This is basically volume share, multi-brand outlets, just including all refrigerators and washers.

So, Q4 '22-23, we were losing triple-digit basis points. So, three red dashes means triple-digit decline in basis points. Two red dashes means double-digit decline in basis points. Two positive pluses means double-digit increase minimum, like somewhere between 11 and 99 basis points increase and so on. So, as you can see, '22-23, last quarter, Jan-March '23, we were losing triple-digit basis points. April-September, we started course correcting it to get to double-digit basis points decline. Then October-March, we had a clear strong double-digit basis points increase. From April '24 to December '24, and even in Jan-Feb, we had basically triple-digit basis points increase versus last year. And that continued.

And in the last 12 months, Jan-December, the market has been flattish, and our volume share has been just growing in single-digit basis points. As you will see later, this is driven a little bit more by direct cool, where we have quite high shares, and the competition has been extremely intensive.

Now, in spite of I would say a very weak market this year for refrigerators and washing machines, driven by poor market in refrigerator, and in spite of extremely heavy competition, especially on pricing, we were still able to keep our overall volume share keep our head above water in the overall volume shares, because we were able to introduce a lot of new products in the market this year.

There was a glass-door products we introduced in both DC and in frost-free, including the Pride of India series, which I will show you later, and there was also frost-free we had in the L60 range, we were able to bring glass-door refrigerators. We drove the auto-defrost in single-door refrigerators, as well as the detergent dispenser in semi-automatic. Expanded those really hard, and we also brought in premium ranges in the air conditioners.

5 We added additional retail executives.

And finally, as a matter of last resort, we ended up trying to take the right decision sometimes, when we need to, for maintaining pricing indices. Net-net, these are the things that led to us holding o

ur share in a very, very tough level.

Next slide, please. So, this is again the breakup that I will show you. These are the volume shares across categories. So, just to show you, let us look across categories. So, as you can see, the last column is the 12-months 2025, Jan-to-December 2025. So, if you see the 12-months, Jan-to-December 2025, we have grown triple-digit basis points on the front-load washer business, which is fine, because it is not a very high share business for us right now, so there is opportunity to grow. We have grown strong double-digit basis points on both low-frost and semi-automatic washers. That, I think, we are quite happy with, but we would like to move it even further. So, both in low-frost refrigerators and semi-automatic washers, we have grown upwards of 40-50 basis points.

The two categories where the maximum challenge happened on shares was basically on direct cool and on top-load, both of which where we have very high shares. In direct cool, our shares are well upwards of 20%. And that is the area in which we have not been able to grow share in the calendar year 2025. And that is something that we will be looking forward to course-correct as we go along with great new initiatives.

On the top-load washers as well, it has been extremely competitive. As you can see, both on (DC), Direct Cool, and on top-load, literally for the last two years, we have had triple-digit basis points share growth. So, from, let us say, almost like September-October 2023 till Jan '25, we had significant share growth. And now, we are starting to see that share kind of stop or slightly

decline or slightly increase in the case of top-load washers. And that is something that we are extremely conscious of, and we will continue to plan to grow those shares going forward. Next slide, please. This would then consolidate our top-three position. In direct cool refrigerator, we are typically either Number 1 or Number 2, even in the last 12-months. Similarly, in semi-automatic, we have been Number 2 in seven of the last 12-months. Top-load, we are within touching distance of getting to a Number 2 position, not more than 100 basis points away.

And, of course, in no-frost and in front-load, we have a lot of work to do, especially in front-load. No-frost, we are in mid-double-digit kind of market shares already. But, again, plenty of opportunity for us to grow in those two. Thank you.

6 Now, if I look at the cost productivity programs, moving on to our financials, we continue to drive strong P4G cost productivity programs that drive gross margin improvement. Here is a chart that just shows you what has been happening from H1 '22-23. As you can see, H1 to H2-22-23 moved up by 30 basis points, again, from H2 to H1 '23-24 by another 30 basis points, H1 '23-24 to H2 '23-24, we moved up 190 basis points. And then from there, we have again moved up 30 basis points in H1 '24-25, another 60 basis points in H2 '24-25.

Now, if you then switch it and look at the nine months-ended December for the Fiscal Year '25-26, again, you will see that in the nine months, we have moved from a 30.3% gross margin to a 30.8% gross margin. Obviously, so we are quite happy with that. There will obviously be some challenges, I am sure, at some point in time. But the intent really is that more often than not to keep growing the gross margin, as that will help fuel any plans that we have to reinvest on higher ROI ideas. That would be our strategy always going forward.

Next slide, please. The other thing that we are quite happy about is our networking capital. Like I said earlier, starting from April 2024, we were able to start working. Obviously, all of the '23-24, we did the work. And then started paying off around September 24, which is the networking capital percentage net revenue. As I said, in the last four out of the last six months, we have had negative networking capital in the percentage of net revenue. That is

the perspective I

wanted to provide from the business point of view.

Now, I will move on to the "Strategic Imperatives." So, we have got our strategic imperatives here, inspire generations with our brand, win with product leadership, build a competitive and resilient supply chain, and excellence in execution.

Next slide, please. Slide Number 15. This is just our history of inspire with our brands. Our chairman is right here. And the chairman has been the managing director of Whirlpool in the past. And some of this is what he has done, whether it was pedestals, whether it was auto defrost, the three-door refrigerator, which we call, Proton, the dark interiors, which we call Platina, the first VA heater. So, Whirlpool has been a pioneer in the India durables industry. And we continue that trend as we go along.

Next slide, please. So, our ADF, which is the auto defrost proposition in direct cool refrigerators, it continues to grow well. We have refreshed our on-pack stickers to basically call it, "No Tension Refrigerator," because that is what it does. DC consumers' biggest pain point is ice walls that build up. And it causes them a lot of trouble to get that sorted out. And auto defrost automatically takes care of no icing on your walls. And that proposition is something that we are driving and that is doing very well.

Next slide, please. These are some of the photographs of the glass-doors that we introduced on our direct cool refrigerators. This is called the "Pride of India Design." You will see that there is a very, very Indian touch to these. These are not the usual flowers and so on and so forth 7 that you see in the market. These are absolutely customized to what you see in India in terms of design elements. You can see the stuff on the right. It looks like something the sari from a very famous movie, which I am sure some of you will recognize. And you see some of the stuff on the left. This is to do with what you can see in architecture in India as you go through.

Next slide, please. We also did the same thing with glass-doors in the frost free collection. We introduced the Lapis Grande, which is a premium glass-door collection, which is also doing really well in the market.

Next slide, please. In frost-free, again, we have the best-in-class performance on convertibility. As you know, convertibility is something Indian consumers are really fond of. But what you really want when you have a convertible is you want to be able to switch it to a convertible, move it from a freezer to a fridge in the fastest possible time. So, we have the performance and the claim to basically be able to say we will convert from a freezer to a fridge in just over 10-minutes, which is an incredibly fast time. But that is what the Indian consumer wants, and that is why we designed it.

Next slide, please. Another thing on frost free, to show you the kind of focus we have on, this is the new three-door Proton range that we have brought in. This had not been updated for about five or six years. So, we brought this in, and to the blessings of our chairman, who gave his green light to it after having seen the design, and we were able to put this into the market. Seems like quite an exciting start. This brings the magic of three doors, and the big claims here

are 43% lesser cold air loss versus a top mount, 360 deg. enhanced cooling with fresh flow, and no odor mixing. And we have done all this with a capacity upgrade, which means the consumer gets more space basically than what they had before.

Next slide, please. And there is something that we are very proud of, this reconception. But moving on to the "Dynamics Technology," I think this one that we did in semi-automatic is something we are very proud of, like I was saying before I got cut off. Semi-automatic washing machine users, the biggest problem that they face is detergent patches staying on their clothes. This is the technology that we came up with,

worked it out in 2023 towards mid-and-end of

2023 and launched in 2024. And it has been a very, very strong win for us, driving our market shares. And today, this Dynamics technology, which ensures zero detergent patches with semi-automatic washing machine users who use powder mostly. This covers 45% of the entire category. So, this is something that we are very proud of, having done this in the last couple of years only.

Next slide, please. And the front-load washers business for us continues to accelerate. It is not shocking because it is on a smaller base, but we have grown the business about 50%, greater than last year. And the market shares have been growing on triple-digit basis points versus last year.

8 Next slide, please. And so is the case with our AC business. Both of these, we have no shares. And AC business, therefore, is also scaling up. We have got greater than 50% growth in calendar year 2025, with our new ranges of air conditioners that we have launched in the market, which we are reasonably happy about.

Next slide, please. And of course, with Elica, a fantastic brand, we continue to drive premiumization to premium product ranges, whether it is filterless and auto-clean kitchen hood, or whether it is a built-in oven with air fryer function, or whether we do it with the direct flame flexi-opt-off, quite happy with the kind of initiatives that are coming through in Elica as well.

Next slide, please. If I move now to execution, we continue to work on excellence in execution. Our aim is to win every day in every store with every consumer, knowing that they will not come back to the market, at least for that category, for another seven to eight years, if not 10-years. Getting the pricing right, making sure that we have strong visibility and making sure we track that on a daily basis, making sure that our incentivization has happened on sales and service to drive premiumization and value, which we started from Jan 2024. And making sure we leverage our great customer relationships for a win-win situation for both us and our customer partners.

We have also continued to see good improvement in our net promoter score, which is the measure for service. We continue to see that improving strongly, both through our service provider network that we have across the country, as well as our in-house service centers that we have set up in 2022.

And one other thing that we are quite happy about is that we were able to transition to a new number, which is not that easy. And this was for two reasons -- one is for simplicity, and the other is for significant cost savings. So, very happy about that as well.

Next slide, please. And like I said, P4G is at the core of our business. We, from fiscal year 2023 to the nine months in fiscal year 2026, we had a standalone gross margin improvement of 320 basis points. And this is all the result of the P4G program that we do.

Next slide, please. I will now hand over to my colleague, "Aditya, CFO, to take you through the Financials".

Aditya Jain: Thank you, Mr. Eswar. I will now take you through the "Financial Performance of Whirlpool of India Limited."

I am on Slide Number 28. This slide talks about the Q3 Financials for Whirlpool of India on a Standalone Basis. In Q3, we delivered a top line of Rs.1,624 crores at a growth of 3.2%.

9 The revenue growth was driven by a couple of factors -- the first one was all the actions we took on the product and the execution side, helped us grow market share in washers. And we also saw a growth in our air con business, which was relatively higher than the rest of the business. So, given that the value of the air con is much higher, that helps us on the revenue growth side.

Second factor was the industry growth. In this quarter, we saw a low-single-digit industry growth, basically driven by the festival demand, we had Diwali falling within this quarter and that is where we saw a little bit of pickup of demand

and that also helped the revenue. And

see, our focused ROI-based initiatives of driving segment and category premiumization which also helps drive our revenue.

On the profitability side, we delivered EBITDA of Rs.65 crores. That is a very healthy growth of 47% versus last year.

And EBITDA margin was at 4%, an expansion of 120 basis points versus last year. The

improvement in EBITDA was predominantly on account of the higher volume in revenue, which translates into a higher absolute DCM, and hence drives an EBITDA improvement.

On the cost productivity side, we have a robust P4G program and we look at all lines of P&L from a cost productivity point of view. And the team did a great job in managing the cost productivity, and as a result of which, we were able to offset a lot of price indices maintenance actions, which we needed to do during the quarter.

And see, the expansion of our premium and high margin portfolio also helped in driving our EBITDA improvement.

Our PBT before exceptional items was at Rs.48 crores, which is again a healthy growth of 32% versus last year. Reported PBT, however, declined by 60% in this quarter, and this was due to the fact that we had to account for a one-time wage code provision of Rs.33.4 crores on a standalone basis.

I am on Slide Number29. Slide Number29 talks about the Consolidated Performance for Whirlpool of India. Consolidated here means it includes the performance of our Elica business as well.

On a consolidated basis, we delivered a revenue of Rs.1,774 crores at a growth of 4% versus last year. Our Elica business grew in high-single-digit during this quarter.

Our EBITDA came in at roughly Rs.91 crores at 5% at a growth of 31%.

And PBT before exceptional items, came in at Rs.71.7 crores at 4%. PBT grew by 21% versus last year.

10 Our Elica business, apart from growing in healthy single digit, also continues to deliver a very healthy double-digit margins.

On a reported basis, again, the PBT declined by 45% on account of one-time wage code provisions and that number was Rs.38.8 crores on a consolidated basis.

I am on Slide Number30. This slide will Summarize the Nine Months for the Period-ended December 2025 Performance for Whirlpool of India on a Consolidated Basis. On a nine-months basis, we delivered a top line of Rs.5,853 crores. That was a marginal decline of 1% versus last year. The decline in revenue was mainly on account of weak industry. As we all know that April-May- June quarter, which from a seasonality point of view is the biggest quarter for the business, had a weak industry on account of delayed and weak summers. Though we saw some recovery in the latter half of the year, but then the impact on a nine-month basis is still negative.

This impact was offset by a market share improvement in washers for us and the growth in air conditioners and Elica business. The market shares on refrigerators was more flattish for us, and our focused effort to drive premiumization, which helps again on the revenue growth, helped us offset the impact of the industry decline which we saw in this quarter.

Mr. Eswar also spoke about the trend of the gross margin and the journey of the gross margin improvement even on a nine-month basis. Given the headwinds on RMI, given the headwinds on FOREX, etc., as a result of all the P4G and the cost reduction programs, we have seen an offset impact of all the RMI and FX and delivered a gross margin improvement of 62 basis points versus last year.

Our PBT before exceptional items was at Rs.316 crores at 5.4%, a decline of 4% versus last year, and reported PBT declined by 13% mainly on account of one-time wage code provisions.

I think that is from the financial side. With this, I will pass it back to Sweta for the Q&A session.

Sweta Srivastava: Thank you, Mr. Eswar and Mr. Jain. I would now request the moderator to open the Q&A session.

Moderator: Thank you. We will now begin the question-and-answer

session. We have the first question

from the line of Ankit Merchant from Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Ankit Merchant: Hello! My first question was sir, that the corporation earlier had given an intention that they want to reduce the stake to 20% by December, right? Now they have sold a bit of it and it still stands at 40%. My question is that, is there any change to the timeline where they want to divest and whether they have said anything about divesting 20% or has that changed as well?

11 And what are the constraints that you guys are seeing in terms of regulatory constraints, the valuation constraints that are delaying the execution?

Narasimhan Eswar: So, I will be very honest with you. What the corporation will do or will not do is something that I cannot speak on at all, as you know very well. Because just like any shareholder, like you yourselves are esteemed shareholders of ours, nobody tells us whether they want to sell or buy or do whatever they want. The shares are theirs and they are free to do what they want to do with those shares. So, we are not privy to any information more than what you are privy to. Since October '16, especially so, where there is very limited kind of communication and definitely none on this topic. So, I am not able to provide you any color at all. The best way to do that would probably be to just read the transcript of the latest shareholders meeting that they had in the US or maybe approach the corporation, but then that would be a bit unusual. The point I am trying to make is they are shareholders and they are wanting to sell and it is not something which we are discussing and doing, just to be clear. I hope I answered your question

honestly.

Ankit Merchant: Yes. So, on the other side, the main intention of the stake sale was that, we will get more operational flexibility, we will be able to focus more on the India business while without much interest. Given that they sold some kind of a stake in the open market, have we seen any autonomy or freedom post that in how we make decisions, in how the board works or has there been any reconstitution in the board?

Narasimhan Eswar: So, the board stays exactly the same as before. The chairman of the board is here with me and I am sure when I finish speaking, he would like to add on. Our board has guided us always through this business, even through 2025, when all of these four big agreements had to be signed, that I spoke of right at the beginning. We had right at the beginning, in February itself, instituted what was a transition committee, which comprise two independent directors, a non-executive director, plus myself and the CFO and they basically sat with us. And they kind of advised us through that whole transition process, all of the negotiations that we had with the corporation. They blessed all the documents as they went through and have been with them and the board have been a huge help to us in working this through. So, the board, just to be clear, is fully and deeply involved in the business from an advisory point of view as they should be. The second thing is that, as far as we are concerned, we are frankly very excited we have been ever since we signed those four documents. Because that gives us a lot of energy that our future is secure, that our shareholders' future is secure, and we have been working ever since trying to figure out what else to do. I think it is early days, but hopefully in the next two to three years, we will be able to show you some of what that new flexibility is. So, I am just going to turn it over now to the Chairman of the Board, Mr. Arvind Uppal for his perspective.

Arvind Uppal: Hi Ankit, good afternoon. So, it is a very fair question. There is no doubt the corporation used to support the management team in India. Now, given that they will not be closely in touch with the management team anymore, the board is stepping up to provide support largely to

12 Mr. Eswar in whatever respects. If you look at the latest board meeting that we just had, we did two things; one, we just created a committee. It is called the Strategic Oversight Committee which will be there to support the managing director and the management team. This will comprise of me and we are bringing Mr. Anil Berera on board. If you may recall, he was the CFO for the longest time. So, two very experienced ex-Whirlpool people, and they will be backing up the managing director in whatever respect you want. So, at this point in time the board is very confident. He has delivered fantastic results so far, and despite all the chaos and noise that has been happening around us, I think we have done a great job. So, now as this settles down, I think we should see far better output. I have no doubt about that. Thank you. I hope that answers your question.

Ankit Merchant: Yes, sir. My next question is to Mr. Eswar, sir. Given that we have seen good trajectory going forward, over the next three to five years, what kind of growth are we seeing compared to the industry -- do we outperform the market, are we in line with the market, do we underperform, and what gives you the confidence that you will probably be in line with the market or probably above that?

Narasimhan Eswar: Okay, it is a great question. Probably a question on a lot of people's minds. So, I will take some time to answer this question. So, the core categories that we play in. So, firstly, we are a refrigerators and washing machine-focused player. We have said that. In the long run, we want to be at the top of the leader board. That is why we come to office every day. We do not come to office to be Number 3 or Number 2, frankly. And I am not saying long run means three years or five years. It might be eight years or nine years. That is fine. But that is the eventual path. Now, within refrigerators and washing machines, we have certain categories like DC. Now, we are already doing pretty well in direct-cool refrigerators in terms of market position. The intent would be to grow the DC business going forward. By decommunitizing it, I am not going to get into detail of how, but to do that, to give offerings that are unique, differentiated and decommunitized so that we can actually grow and become the leader in the DC category. And that basically means that given our very high shares in DC, I do not think it is very easy to get 100 basis points or something like that in DC year-on-year, it is very difficult when you are at our share. But growing the DC category every year would be, for me, the right target to go. Modest increases, maybe 20 bps, maybe 30 bps a year, we will see. Second, if I look at semi-automatic, in semi-automatic, we are sometimes Number 3, sometimes Number 2. That is one in which we want to again grow our market shares, but grow it in not only the entry, but also in the premium segments, which is what we have been doing over the last two years. We have been slowly moving our business up towards the premium segments. And I hope to continue to see that happen again through decommunitizing the category by offering products that have a point of difference, that are not the usual run-of-the-mill stuff, and make that the base on which we grow. So, in semi-automatic as well, like DC, competition is incredibly tough. Not that it is easy in the others, but especially on pricing, very tough. And therefore, I would expect to see only a modest growth in share growth going forward for the next five years... I am talking 13 again everything over five years. Now, comes top load. Now, top load is something in which I

think, again, similar to the first two categories, we have a very high share already. But, we do have a fantastic product portfolio that we can fully leverage. Right now, it is not at all fully leveraged in many ways. And so, I expect to see us use this top-end to mid-end of the product portfolio to grow o

ur shares. Again, modest basis points over the next five years. Then come the two other interesting categories where our shares have a bit of an opportunity. One is Frost-free. Frost-free, we are in the mid-double digits. And I think there is opportunity to take that up further, more in line with our DC or our top load kind of washing machine shares. And so, I see that as a very interesting opportunity. In this particular segment, unlike the first three that I mentioned, there are sizes in which we do not play today. And those are very interesting spaces for us. And those are very attractive spaces for us. So, that is obviously of tremendous interest to us. And we will be looking to max out in those spaces as well. So, I see a lot of potential in Frost-free for us compared to some other firms. And lastly, we come to front load washing machines. In front load washing machines, we have tremendous opportunity. We have got great products with our Ozone technology, which are unique. We have very low market shares; still less than 5% volume market share for us. And if you see the rest of our washing machines, they are somewhere between 15% and 19%. So, huge opportunity. Brand name very well known in washing machines. It is just a matter of putting it all together and making it happen in a very, very tough and competitive market. So, as I look to see across these five categories, you can see how we can grow our market share, relatively smaller in some categories and much higher in other categories, through the right innovation, the right go-to-market, the right execution, and always fueled by a P4G program, which gives us the gross margin improvements that we can funnel back into the business. Of course, I have not mentioned other interesting category for us, air conditioners. We are a smaller player in this category, but coming along well. This is a very fast-growing category. We will be very sensible about how we grow in this category. It can be a category in which if the season does not come through well, you could be sitting on tons and tons of inventory. So, we will always manage this kind of dichotomy, which is high growth, but you got to manage the inventory. So, this is something that we will also be focusing on, and air conditioners will be the other revenue driver. So, the portfolio position for it will be revenue driver, not so much a profit driver, because the margins in an air conditioner typically for the industry are lower than the margins for refrigerators and washers. But, it is a revenue driver which helps. In addition to these, this is the freedom and flexibility that we spoke of. We also have opportunities to open up other-related categories within the cooling space. We also have the opportunity to look at other categories outside of these. And then on top, the cherry on the cake is, of course, Elica, which is a highly underpenetrated category, less than 5% penetration for these categories in India. Fantastic products, amazing design, great traction. So, this is something that we will be looking to build. So, we have clear core categories that we know what to do, what sort of products we need to launch. We have some categories in which we are not yet at optimal share at all, and we have huge plans to grow those categories. And then, of course, we have gems like the kitchen space with Elica, and Whirlpool, by the way. We have got two brands in the kitchen 14 space that we can actually grow. So, I would say from a revenue point of view, we have a lot of opportunities in the next five years. I would really look forward to strong growth in the next five years. Previously, I had talked about high single-digit CAGR. Assuming that the market is also working, because that is, I think, the most critical thing in the Indian market, the market also needs to grow. If the market were to grow slightly ahead of GDP, then I do not see why the high single-digit cannot become an early doubl

e-digit kind of growth number over a five-year period. The profit part of it, I would say, this is going to be a little up and down across the next year or so, because there are two or three things which are important for us to kind of understand. In this durables industry, regulations are very critical. Regulatory costs are very high because it is an engineering industry. It is not just make one product. There is like hundreds and hundreds of components in every refrigerator or a washing machine. And many of them have regulatory impacts on them. So, regulatory cost is one thing that will impact the entire industry. And of course, as we go forward, we need to make sure that we can manage costs through our P4G program as well. So, with the heavy, heavy competition that we have in this industry, I do feel that profitability will also grow, but it will grow modestly. I do not think you will have breakthrough growths in profitability. The only thing that can change that is either if market price is up to take care of the regulatory costs completely, or indeed you have some kind of help with respect to commodities or things like that, that can come your way. So, a bit tricky to predict. We will focus on driving the top line and keeping to our discipline, operational rigor on managing all the costs, and that is our way forward. Did I answer your question?

Ankit Merchant: Yes, sir. Thank you for the detailed explanation, sir. This one last question I have. I just want to understand with the new energy ratings that have come in, in January, what is the impact on our Company and what kind of price hikes have we taken across the board?

Narasimhan Eswar: Okay. So, the energy ratings have come in January in air conditioners and in refrigerators. And we have started putting our new products out there already. New manufacturing of new products has already started exactly as per schedule. There is no issue on any, not even a single SKU that we have. So, all the manufacturing has gone exactly as per plan. So, you will be happy to know that we are well prepared for it. We are not right now talking about any price increase, etc., or communicating what we have done in the market because we are waiting and watching to see what happens in the market. And depending that, we will take dynamic decisions. We look at pricing literally on a monthly basis. So, we will take those dynamic decisions as we go forward.

Ankit Merchant: Thank you, sir, for your time and for the detailed answers.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Vinay Agarwal from Invisage Capital. Please go ahead.

Vinay Agarwal: Hi! Thanks, Mr. Eswar for doing this and for taking my question. I just had a couple of questions with Whirlpool, the corporation stake going down to 40% and when I look at the incentivization 15 for top management, a large part of it is still based on sort of the shares of the parent. Will that change going forward? And then one more question which I had was, when I look at the board, a couple of board members are also advisors or partners in some private equity firms who were also sort of want to be potential buyers. How does the board manage that conflict? And you say that corporation what they do, we do not have a say in that. But I am just wondering with the board and CEO, how does this thing work? Just one thing that if you can throw some light on that?

Narasimhan Eswar: Sure, sure. Thank you, Mr. Agarwal. On the incentivization, just like to clarify that as of 28th November, when the corporation sold its last stake and therefore was not a majority shareholder anymore. I can assure you that all future ESOP plans that are given to the top leadership of the Company, which are performance-based, will not be anything to do with corporation. That has been already decided well in advance by mutual consent. Any ESOP plans that we give to our people going forward, will be based on India performance and

India

performance alone. So, I just wanted to make that very clear. We are in the process of working through these details with the board and we hope to have something in front of shareholders. So, as you can imagine, it is a complex process. We now have to do this on top of our day-to-day running of the business. So, we are working through with the board's help, who have a lot of experience in this area as well. But we are working through those things with some external people helping us, and we should be able to place something in front of you pretty soon. Hopefully, for your approval, and then once it is approved, it will be rolled out into the plans for the leadership team. So, that is the answer to the first question. The answer to the second question is, you had asked specifically about something to do with the details of the transaction. Mr. Agarwal, I can say only the following things to you. First is, it is not correct of me to talk about any confidential transactions that were happening or did happen or did not happen. That would not be right because it would be something that has not been released by the corporation or my Company. What I can tell you is, if at all such a thing had happened, Number 1, we would have as a matter of process, taken a clear declaration from the people involved about the fact that they have no knowledge of what was happening there. Number 2, we would have taken such a declaration from parties that were talking to us. And Number 3, you would have made sure that these people were all involved. So, you have to please trust us on this, and it is very difficult for me to make comments about speculative statements. It would not be correct legally for me to answer this question in any way other than what I am answering right now and I would genuinely appreciate if we please keep it to stuff that I am able to answer if that is okay.

Vinay Agarwal: Yes. Thank you, Mr. Eswar. And the point on your stuff is much appreciated. That would be great. We attended the parents' call also and they spoke about a number of new products that they are launching. Will some of those new products come to India as well or will it be a part of if not now but later we will have access to those new products?

16 Narasimhan Eswar: Oh, yes, it is quite possible that when the Indian market is ready for such products we can bring them in. Like I said, so long as they are referring to refrigerators and washing machines and related categories, there are other areas like KitchenAid which we do not have access to. So, just to be clear, KitchenAid was not part of this discussion for us just because KitchenAid is run independently as a business by Whirlpool globally for strategic reasons. Even if KitchenAid makes a washing machine or KitchenAid makes a refrigerator, not that it is making it, but if it did, that would be KitchenAid technology. But all of Whirlpool Corporation's stuff we absolutely have access to, yes, sir. And as and when we need stuff, we will be able to access it with Whirlpool Corporation's blessing, yes.

Vinay Agarwal: And just the last question, the cash and the balance sheet in terms of sort of a higher dividend payout or does the board even consider a buyback or maybe it is difficult given the situation the Company is in right now?

Narasimhan Eswar: It is a good point. At this point in time, we are not really working on that area yet. We will start

to work on that area. But, I see there is plenty of useful cash that we can do. We also have a lot of cash, it is true. Firstly, there is ongoing operations. Secondly, there is CAPEX for new projects that we can do. Thirdly, we could be looking at what is interesting in the market. Decisions, for example, a three-year payback or a two-year payback or a four-year payback on something that can reduce the cost of P&L on a going basis is much lower. These are all kinds of things that we are looking at. I think our e

xecution will only be limited by our ability to work through the six years. I think there are plenty of areas we can look at and of course the areas that you mentioned we can look at. We will look at all those things and take the board's advice across the next few months. It will take some time. But we will be working on it very actively now. Thank you.

Vinay Agarwal: Thank you, Mr. Eswar.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Priyank from Vallum Capital. Please go ahead.

Priyank: Yes, hi, sir, Wonderful and great to see the kind of operational performance that we are witnessing despite all the ownership changes to the Company. My first question is, in the interim quarters, you did mention that there has been extraordinary competitive pricing and promotions in the industry. That was visible given that some large players prioritize pushing versus filling. Do you see this competitive intensity normalizing now and your organic actions resulting into market share gains plus margins improvement? That is my first question.

Narasimhan Eswar: Okay, let me answer this question. Your observations are very interesting indeed. Sir, I wish I could give you an answer to this, but the honest answer is I do not know. So, that is why I said, I will have to dynamically keep looking at what is happening in the market. This is a very, very competitive market. If you see the number of brands that were introduced in the refrigerators and washing machines in the last six years, it is unbelievable. And with every new brand comes 17 a theoretical loss of fair market share that you need to fight against. New players try to use pricing or discounting as a way of getting market share. Thank you. That is what it makes very competitive, right? So, in this context, we will keep watching what is happening in the market and take our actions according to that. To always make sure we have our competitive pricing indices in the market. And that is the best I can say. As far as the second point that you mentioned, which is margins are concerned, margins are going to be impacted by pricing, but they are also going to be impacted by a lot of things. There is a significant regulatory impact that will happen in calendar year 2026 because of the refrigerators and air conditioners. For many companies, it is 50%, 60%, 70% of their portfolio. These are the two biggest categories. Entire refrigerators and air conditioners are going through BEE rating or energy change. And therefore if you cannot take the full pricing out from the market, then it will impact different companies maybe in different ways, but more or less it will impact everybody. We need to look at that. And the second thing for us, particularly, is that 2026-2027 will be the year of our transition. Basically, there are some impacts that we have already declared in our October 16th statement that we put out in the public domain. That will happen as a result of our becoming not a majority-owned Whirlpool Company. So, based on that also, there will be some transition impacts financially. I would just say that for '26-27, my intent would be to try and drive my revenue, intent would be to try my market share in a financially sensible way. I think of all the years I have been in, this would be probably from a profit point of view, structurally the most challenging year, because you have entire refrigerators and air conditioners all going up in regulation in the same year, plus the year in this full financial year which we are moving to a completely independent entity with the attendant let us say transition costs that basically impact our P&L. So, that I think is what I would say. And after the year of transition, I think you will end up for me in a situation where we should be able to continue a strong progress basically in terms of margin improvement.

Priyank: Sorry, sir. Just a follow-on and a clarification. On the BEE energy ratings change, what would

be the pricing impact or the correction that the investments we would need to take in case we need to keep the margins intact. And I am not sure what would be the transitional impact on the P&L, which is supposed to happen this year. If you can quantify these two things? And lastly, on the capital allocation part, in case, if there are no clear priorities lined up in terms of large CAPEX or Elica investments or new categories to be implemented immediately, maybe we can prioritize returning back some of the capital back to the rightful owners of the Company. That is my suggestion and a clarification question. Thank you.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, sir. On the BEE pricing, I am afraid we are not declaring that at all. We are not sharing that because that is different for different companies depending on where they are and that is highly confidential information, which would actually be inimical to our interests to share in the public domain. As far as the transition is concerned, all of the information is fully available in the documents we released on October 17th, October 16th was the signing. Kindly take a look at that. All of the information is there. Lastly, on the capital back, sir, we hear you. 18 I think like I said I already answered that question. Please take a look at all the options that we

have for cash utilization, work through with the board, take the board's advice, and then come to you when we need to if that is okay. Thank you so much.

Moderator: We have the next question from the line of Dhruv Jain from Ambit Capital. Please go ahead.

Dhruv Jain: Thank you for the opportunity, sir. My first question is on Elica. You have had Elica in your portfolio for a couple of years now. Now, with this transaction coming through, what kind of aggression that will you be able to carry out in this part of the business? And how should we think about the scalability of this vertical over the next say three to four years?

Narasimhan Eswar: Wonderful question, sir. As I mentioned, Elica is something that we feel is a tremendous brand, built really, really well by the people who built this brand from the beginning. The time is quite good for us, basically, as we look to the new financial year, to start looking at how should we be dealing with Elica. And in my view, as we discussed with the board as well, Elica is operating at very strong PBT margins. The really interesting question for us would be what is the trade-off between that PBT margin or maybe a couple of hundred basis points lower and the revenue. So, that is something that we are actively looking into, we are actively discussing. There has to be some investment to happen to get it going from a 5%, 6%, 7%, 8% revenue growth to a very strong double-digit revenue growth. So, we prefer for ourselves that Elica is growing strongly, and even if it were to grow at a lesser margin, we are growing strongly. That is the kind of model that would probably make most sense for Whirlpool India going forward, which is a very direct answer to your question.

Dhruv Jain: My second question is on the DC refrigerator and the semi-automatic washing machines. Over the last four or five years, we have rarely seen pricing go up in the category and you yourself mentioned that the number of layers are entering the space. So, is the core category sort of getting commoditized? How should we think about Whirlpool sort of getting... you mentioned some of the new categories that you are thinking about, but a little more color in the sense that if you could just spell out what should be the contribution of some of these emerging categories say three years out, or what is the share that you like, because these two categories are getting increasingly commoditized?

Narasimhan Eswar: That is a very good observation. So, what has happened I would say more in SA than in DC, is that there are two things that have basically become the key drive

rs of a semi-automatic

business in the last, say, three, four years, I would say. One is because the number of entrants coming in, pricing has become a very important thing. The lower you sell, the more market share you get kind of thing. The second thing that has happened is capacity, which is the size of the machine. So, let us sell 9 Kg for the price of 8 Kg. Let us sell 10 Kg for the price of 9 Kg. Again, it is a pricing game, but it comes in a different avatar, which is capacity. What we are trying to do is for both categories, DC and SA, decommoitize it. And I think that is where the differential can come. See, in every category, in my view, you need to have a point of difference. Why should a person prefer to buy your product than somebody else's product, right? And that cannot happen if you commoditize the category. If you just bring it down to price and the color of the box and the number of kilograms that it can take, then you commoditize the category. So, all our efforts, without going too much into detail, will be into decommoitizing the category. For example, you would drive the aesthetic design of DC fantastically through glass-doors, right? If you go to DC homes, you will actually find in many homes, the DC refrigerator is actually in the living room. Okay? It is not in the bathroom, it is not in the kitchen, it is in the living room. It is like a showpiece. So, if that is the case, then one of the insights is, why do we not make it extremely attractive to people to look at, to display? So, that is where glass-doors have a major role to play. So, that is one example of decommoitization. But there is others. You take a technology like auto defrost, that is something that we have that is unique in the market amongst the large players. And it solves the number one pain point of DC consumers. Now, today it might be at a certain percentage of the market. Why cannot it be 75% of the market? Then you decommoitize the category. And you have solved the consumer's number one pain point. So, it is through a combination of that kind of approach that we believe that we can continue to hold a strong market share in DC and in semiautomatic. I think if you try to play the game that everybody is playing, then whoever has got the most, deepest pocket is going to win. But as you know very well, that is not the only way to win. So, our focus is on creating those points of difference, decommoitizing these categories. That does not mean that we are going to just let go of low-priced categories. We have never done that. We need to fight where we need to fight tactically. But the strategic fight will always be on decommoitizing these categories and getting value for these categories for the industry, for our shareholders and for the consumers as well, whether it is DC or whether it is SA. I think DC and SA, one thing we must remember, penetration growth has been very low for these two categories in the last five years. Once penetration growth comes back to DC and SA, which is your guess or mine as to how far away it is, the absolute volumes here are quite mind-boggling. So, I do not think DC is going to go away anytime soon, or SA. So, we continue to stand by these categories, but we will look to decommoitize these categories as I mentioned.

Dhruv Jain: Sure. And sir, my third question, in some of the cost items that we compare Whirlpool to say, some of the other larger peers, for example, freight costs, we see that there is significant room for improvement. So, just your take in terms of maybe adding another plant in south or in some other part of the country to optimize some of these freight costs or some of these other cost items? And, I mean, sorry for hopping on it again, but just the kind of cash flows that you generate, I am sure it will be easy for you to take those calls to improve the P&L significantly.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you. Freight costs. So, I am just going to

give a bit of color and then Aditya is going to

jump in. So, when we compare freight costs, it is very interesting because one analyst, I think about one year ago, had told us this point, that your freight costs are higher. So, we obviously went into a deep dive on it because anywhere where there is money, we want to be there.

20 Here are the facts. The freight cost of anybody who sells a lot of refrigerators will always be much higher than anybody who sells a lot of air conditioners. And the freight costs of anybody who sells a lot of air conditioners will be higher than anybody who sells a lot of smartphones. So, when you look at the freight costs, it is quite important to look at the product mix of the Company as well. What I mean by that is, if I am selling 50%, 55% refrigerators, 25% washing machines and 15% ACs, my freight cost will be X, Y and Z for each of those categories weighted. Somebody else who has a completely different freight mix, for example, they are selling 80% washing machines and 20% air conditioners, their freight costs will be much lower than mine per unit. Right? And if somebody is selling 100% refrigerators, his freight costs will be way more than mine. So, we have benchmarked our freight costs versus the entire industry. We do not believe that we are sitting on any comparative disadvantage. Whether we are at an advantage or not, I will not say. But it is our mix compared to some of these other brands that you are referring to, that is causing the market to change. Aditya, any points on this?

Aditya Jain: You have said it all. The only additional perspective I would add is, when you are looking at freight costs, you are looking at the percentage of revenue. So, while the incurrence of the freight is more volumetric in terms of how many number of units you can carry into a truck, while the truck freight remains same, but higher the number of units you carry and hence the freight. And hence when you compare refrigerators versus washers to air conditioners, in air conditioners you can carry more number of units for the same freight, but the per unit value of AC is significantly higher. So, that causes freight as a percentage of revenue to be significantly lower for air conditioners compared to refrigerators and washers. Now, when you extend the same logic to televisions, for example, again, the number of units which goes in the same truck will be even higher and hence the per unit freight will be lower and the value per unit of a television will be even higher than the value per unit of a refrigerator or even an air conditioner. And hence, on a percentage basis that will be even significantly lower and the same thing is then applicable for mobiles as well. So, when you look at from a percentage revenue point of view on that logic and adjust for the product mix of different companies, you can start looking at that freight as a percentage of revenues is much more comparable than what is reflected in the reported results because of these differences.

Narasimhan Eswar: So, I hope I have answered your question. It is basically the mix. If I started selling twice the number of air conditioners tomorrow, keeping everything as the same, my freight cost as a percentage of an hour will come down and you will start seeing if I sell the same mix as Company X or Company Y, you will see that my costs are at least as good if not better than theirs.

Dhruv Jain: Fair enough. And sir, you mentioned about this year it being challenging in terms of profitability. So, is it fair to say that we are going to see no margin expansion or very limited margin expansion in the coming financial year?

21 Narasimhan Eswar: No, I do not know that. The reason I do not know that, sir, is because I do not know what will happen to pricing in the market, firstly, right? If the pricing goes up by 1%, 2%, 3%, 4%, the numbers are completely different as you can imagine, right? 4%, of course, let's

not dream, but

I am just saying that it is one big thing. The second is, while the costs are in, the regulatory costs are in for everybody, everybody is also working on how to reduce the regulatory costs going forward, right, by reengineering, etc., You need time to do that. You can only do that after you have finished the regulatory work, you keep on reengineering as you go forward basically. All companies do that. And of course, the third thing, like I said, is we do not know what mix is selling. If the premium mix starts selling much better in '26-27, if the premium starts selling much better, then you have a mix help that comes through, which helps you in your gross margin, right? We do not know, we cannot predict these things sitting here at this point in time. We can have assumptions, but every time we have made assumptions, not only us, everybody in the industry, a lot depends on the monsoon, a lot depends on how much the sun shines in summer, believe it or not, and a lot depends on the other parts of the economy as well, right? So, we are very hopeful, very positive, given that we had a very tough, let us say, summer, and a very early monsoon in '25-26, just hoping a little bit for the reverse, if the summer lasted a

bit longer, and if the monsoons were very strong, but a little less, let us say, erratic compared to last year, that would be really good. And then lastly, of course, you have the fourth variable, which is your cost program, right? So, our cost program, people also have targets, they have stretch targets that are very difficult to get, but our people have surprised us in the last three years by getting to places we thought they could not get to, because they are so good at what they do. And so, therefore, given so many variables -- pricing, regulatory, market, P4G cost programs -- it is difficult for me to say this will be the profit or that will be the profit.

Directionally, it is an unusual year, that is all. I hope I answered your question.

Dhruv Jain: Yes, sir, and so, just one feedback, now that Whirlpool Corporation is not a majority shareholder, it would be great if we can have these calls every quarter?

Narasimhan Eswar: Yes, I do commit on this call that we will have the calls every quarter. Yes, so that is a commitment.

Dhruv Jain: Thank you so much and all the best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: We have the next question from Natasha Jain from PhillipCapital. Please go ahead.

Natasha Jain: Thank you for the opportunity. So, my question is on competitive dynamics. Two points here.

First, we have seen that Voltas Beko, Godrej, Haier, and now even LG Essential, coming in very aggressively in all categories that Whirlpool is present. Additionally, your largest revenue salience which is refrigerator, first off, it is a high penetrated product compared to other appliances, and secondly, for some reason, replacement cycle is just getting longer without any 22 trigger for a customer to change as in, there is no frequent e-rating like what comes in probably in AC. So, again, if not a very quick demand generator category anymore, given these two points, how do you read the competitive dynamics for industry and Whirlpool in particular?

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, ma'am, for that question. I think the competition that is there for us is exactly the same for everybody else. So, just to be clear, there are, say, 10, 12 big name players competing in the market today and then there is probably another 15, 20 players. My competitors, except for me, they will be the same for others also, if you know what I mean. So, we are all in a very competitive area. And I think the answer that I am giving is probably true for everybody rather than just for us. It is very, very competitive, but that is where I think there are only two things that a Company needs to do. One is be clear on why your strategies will allow you to win in the marketplace. If your st

ategies are the same as everybody else's with no differentiation and

you are not clear on that, then, sure, you have a risk of not winning in the marketplace. The second is, how good are you at executing your strategy? So, everybody can have a strategy. It looks wonderful in PowerPoint. Everybody stands around and cheers the strategy. But can you execute? How detailed are you at running into the market and making things happen? That is where I think, I would say that strategy, you could argue that we have a good strategy, I could tell you that I have a better strategy than my competition, competition will tell you that I have a better strategy. You cannot decide on this. We are very proud of our execution capability. We are very proud of how we work as one team. And I think that probably is what we really hold to. Because at the end, we only have two things with us --one is the brand name and the second is our people. Other than this, we do not have anything else. Yes, we have money, everybody else has money. So, it is only the brand name and our people that make the difference in business for us. As far as refrigerators, which is a very technical point that you mentioned, two things -- firstly, I would say refrigerators is a big enough category. But like I told you before, if I talk of Whirlpool, I have significant opportunities to grow in washing machines, in the front-load business, for example. My shares are very low and what somebody else says to me in Direct Cool, I am to them in front-load washing machines. Similarly, in air conditioners, same story, my share is very low. So, I have plenty of opportunities to grow in those categories. On top, refrigerators is not a category that is super-high penetrated. So, just for your perspective, we are less than 36-37% penetration in this country on refrigerators still. Very frankly, we should be at least heading towards the next 20-years towards 65-70% penetration. So, for a variety of reasons which we do not have the time to go into right now, probably at some other forum I will share this. There are a lot of reasons why the refrigerator replacement cycle has not happened as per plan. And for the same reasons, they will start happening in my view between the next one to five years in a significant way. DC will pick up and so will semi-automatic. The bottom half of India in terms of income is going to come back in a strong way. And when that happens, these will grow. And when these grow, your replacements will also start growing for other reasons. So, I would say that in my view, I cannot get into the detail, now, it will probably take 15-minutes for me to explain why, but I do see in the next one-to-five years a pickup in durables happening, especially in refrigerators and 23 washing machines. Air conditioners anyway goes up or down depending on the summer. And in typical, air conditioners have grown well in the last five years. But refrigerators and washing machines, I think, there is a significant pickup coming in the next one-to-five years is in my view. But that is just my view. It is not the view of the Whirlpool of India Limited. It is just based on my assessment of what is happening. I do not have much to worry about. All we can do is

have a clear strategy, understand what our points of differences are, outline them, make sure the entire organization is clear on that, and then go out and execute all the plans that we have agreed as close to perfection as possible. I believe that any Company that can do that consistently over a five-year period will be still standing at the end of five years in a strong position. And companies that cannot will have a difficult time.

Natasha Jain: This is much helpful. The second question is on AC. I understand it is a very small category for you at this point. But if I observe the market share data, you have grown versus probably the incumbents who have lost market share. Now, given that there is

so much of cost hikes coming

in and GST benefits almost gone, in such a scenario, if I were to just pick up brands in the middle segment of the pyramid, so do you think that Whirlpool as a brand could be a bigger beneficiary given you would be more favorably placed in terms of pricing versus the rest of the brands in that category? And in terms of outliers, would AC become an outlier for you in the near-term given that now that will be a seasonal quarter for AC?

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you for the question, ma'am. Very astute observations. On AC, I would say, we are quite interested in this category. As I said very clearly right at the beginning, we wanted to make sure we get our refrigerators and washing machine ducks in a row first before we start worrying about AC. We got our refrigerators and washing machine ducks relatively speaking in a row, and then we started focusing on AC. It is working for us, and we will continue to drive that business. You are right that we will have some advantages as we go into the market, and we intend to fully leverage those advantages. Having a better mix across categories also derisks you from a long-term point of view. So, are we interested in AC? Of course, we are interested in AC. Are we going to do crazy stuff? No, we are not going to. We will always keep to the path of financial sensibility while doing things. And so, that will be our mantra. But, you can be naughty once in a while. That is allowed, I think.

Natasha Jain: Fair enough, sir. Thank you so much and all the best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, ma'am.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, in the interest of time, that was the last question. I would now like to hand the conference over to Ms. Sweta Srivastava for closing comments.

Sweta Srivastava: Thank you, everyone, for joining the call. With that, I would like to draw this call to close.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you.

24 Moderator: On behalf of Whirlpool of India Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you all for joining us. You may now disconnect your lines.

Call: May 2026

May 29, 2026
The Manager
Listing Department
BSE Limited
Phiroze Jeejeeb hoy Towers
Dalal Street, Mumbai ,
Maharashtra - 400001
Scrip Code: 500238 The Manager
Listing Department
National Stock Exchange of India Limited
Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block G,
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East,
Mumbai, Maharashtra – 400051
Symbol: WHIRLPOOL
Dear Sir/Madam,

Subject: Transcript of the Conference Call for Investors/ Analyst for Q4 FY 2025-26
This is further to our intimation letter dated May 18, 2026 wherein we had informed the schedule of the Conference Call, please find enclosed herewith a copy of the transcript of the Conference Call of the Company held on May 22, 2026.
The same will also be uploaded on the Company's website at <https://corporate.whirlpool.in/financial-information/> .

Yours faithfully,
For Whirlpool of India Limited
Sweta Srivastava
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Plot No. 40, Sector 44,
Gurugram, Haryana
Encl: as above

"Whirlpool of India Limited
Q4 Financial Year FY26 Analyst Conference Call"
May 22, 2026
MANAGEMENT : MR. ARVIND UPPAL – CHAIRMAN –
WHIRLPOOL OF INDIA LIMITED
MR. NARASIMHAN ESWAR – MANAGING DIRECTOR –
WHIRLPOOL OF INDIA LIMITED
MR. ADITYA JAIN – CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER –
WHIRLPOOL OF INDIA LIMITED
MS. SWETA SRIVASTAVA – COMPANY SECRETARY –
WHIRLPOOL OF INDIA LIMITED
MODERATOR : MR. DEEPAK AGARWAL – AXIS CAPITAL LIMITED
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Moderator: Ladies and gentlemen, good day and welcome to the Analyst Call of Whirlpool of India Limited. We wish to inform you that all participant lines will be in the listen-only mode and there will be an opportunity for you to ask questions after the presentation concludes. Should you need assistance during this conference call, please signal the moderator by pressing star then zero on your touch-tone phone. Please note that this conference is being recorded. I now hand the conference over to Mr. Deepak Agarwal from Axis Capital Limited. Thank you and over to you, sir .

Deepak Agarwal: Thanks. Good evening, ladies and gentlemen. On behalf of Axis Capital Limited, we welcome you all to Whirlpool of India analyst call for the fourth quarter financial year FY26. From the management side, we have the Chairman of the Board, Mr. Arvind Uppal; Mr. Narasimhan Eswar , Managing Director; Mr. Aditya Jain, Chief Financial Officer of the company; and Ms. Sweta Srivastava, Company Secretary joining the call.

We thank Whirlpool of India to give us the opportunity to host this call. Now , I hand over the floor to Sweta ma'am. Thanks, and over to you, ma'am.

Sweta Srivastava: Thank you, Deepak. Good evening, everyone. I would like to welcome you to the Q4 financial year 2025-2026 analyst call of Whirlpool of India Limited. Please note that the call is being recorded and the audio call and transcripts will be available on the website of the company .

Also, the presentation to be made by the Managing Director and Chief Financial Officer is available on the website of the company as well as the stock exchanges.

Before we move forward, I would like to remind you of the cautionary statement that forms part of the presentation. During this call, certain forward-looking statements may be made. These forward-looking statements are based on certain expectations, assumptions, and other factors which may affect the business results. Please read the cautionary statements carefully

and the contents of this call should be interpreted accordingly .

With that, I would now like to hand it over to Mr . Eswar .

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, Sweta. Good afternoon, everyone. I'm Narasimhan Eswar , Managing Director of the company . I'd like to welcome you to this analyst call. Thank you very much to Axis Capital for making this happen. Thank you to everyone for taking out your time to join us.

Without any further delay , I'll start with the update. So the update as usual, we split it up into three areas; the business overview , the strategic imperatives and how we're doing against them, and lastly , the financial performance. I shall cover the first two and Mr. Aditya Jain, the CFO, will cover the last one.

If you move to Slide 6 of the presentation, please, and you can see the slide numbers at the bottom right-hand side of the page. We'd just like to start off with some key highlights of 2025-2026 Q4. This is for the India standalone results. We're happy to see that we delivered a revenue growth of about 7.4% versus last year. Happy because the first two quarters of this
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year, because of a lot of competitive pressure that happened in the market, which was extraordinary , we had a revenue drop versus a year ago in Q1 and Q2 of this fiscal. Q3 we made our way back and Q4 we've grown by 7.4% versus last year .

We're also quite happy that even if temporarily , only for a month, but in March 2026, in refrigerators and washing

machines combined, in the multi-brand outlets volume market share, we secured the number two position. The reason why we're happy about this is not just because of the number two position, but because it shows us in our organization and people who believe in us that it's possible to get here and also gives you the confidence that once you get here, you can aspire for even more.

Now , how we got to that position was basically because we had some share leadership in a couple of different areas where we made some progress. In direct cool refrigerators, in multi-brand outlets volume market share, we got market leadership straight for three months in a row, in fact, four months from December 2025, number one position there. We secured after a very long time the number two position in top load in quarter four market share for multi-brand outlets volume market share. And we also secured for the quarter the second position in semi-automatic washers.

Now , these were the three top categories in which we secured good market share positions. In front load washers, where our market shares are much lower as we launched only in 2022, coming in late into this category , we're happy to note that our volumes have actually doubled in this quarter and we showed a triple-digit increase in market share consistent with the past several quarters, again on multi-brand outlets volume market share.

In our relatively smaller business of aircon, and I know that many companies have declared very strong results of million units and so on and so forth, but for us, we exceeded 100,000 units in the March month, which considering where we were three years ago, is a fairly good achievement. And it also shows the power of what we can go on and achieve in the coming months and years because our quarter volume growth was more than 50%.

Elica had a wonderful quarter . Revenue was up 30% and profit for Elica was up 48% -- PBT. Also, what was very nice to cap it all off was March 2026 marked the highest-ever shipment month in the history of Whirlpool of India Limited, handsomely beating the last great record which was in April 2019. All-in-all, from a revenue and a volume growth point of view , a much better picture than the previous months.

Margins were impacted in this quarter as you would have seen already from the reports due to energy change regulations in refrigerator and aircon, which we moved into quicker than most others because of our lower inventory , and also the incremental e-waste impact that we continue to accrue for in line with government mandates.

We continue to closely monitor the supply situation. As everybody knows, the supply situation arising from the Middle East war is of concern to not only us but all industries across the country . Both with respect to cost and supply of components, products, etcetera, it is quite challenging and we continue to work on that very , very seriously and diligently .

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Coming to the last part before we move into the detail, we're happy to report that even in this quarter , we got a negative networking capital in our ref and washer business. Any increase in our networking capital was only because of planned investments in air conditioners, which was obviously on the positive side because aircon works on different number of days of receivables compared to -- and inventory compared to our ref and washer business.

Could we go to Slide number 7, please

se? So, this is the chart that I always share. I'm not going to walk you through the entire chart because there's a lot of detail in there. But the industry continued to basically grow with very low single-digits in Jan 2026 to March 2026, so subdued industry growth. Decline in refrigerators so far for the whole year, driven by decline in direct

cool refrigerators. I'm now talking about the industry .

In terms of big highlights for us in this quarter , which is the extreme right column, Q4 2025-2026, Jan 2026 to March 2026, I think the biggest highlight was our bringing in the new ranges of refrigerators both in direct cool and frost free into the market.

So, for those who are unaware, there's a big energy change that happened in January on both refrigerators and air conditioners. What that really means is every refrigerator and every air conditioner had to be replaced with new technical models, every single SKU that we have.

And this is what we call as a phase-in phase-out.

And when you do this phase-in phase-out, those who enter it at a slightly earlier stage end up having to lose some amount of display share and stock share in the market as they transition their products to the new products. And this is quite a monumental thing for the entire industry . We were into it a little bit earlier than the others because we had lesser inventory on refrigerators as we closed out the year and air conditioners.

We also introduced some very exciting new products that I'll talk to you about later. We introduced the new three-door Protton, which is doing very well in the market. We introduced a new 9 kilogram with steam option in the front load washing machines, and we introduced new models in the direct cool auto-defrost premium refrigerators. We also added some amount of retail executives to further drive our business and our ROI, and we had a very good quarter in terms of air conditioner and front load washer scale-up.

Our volume market shares for this quarter declined by double-digit basis points versus last year, predominantly driven by refrigerators where we had this phase-in and phase-out, as well as significant competitive pricing activity still happening, which we have chosen not to follow completely , which is a deliberate strategy .

But as we recover our phase-in phase-out, as we move faster than others on the phase-in phase-out in the month of April, May, June, I hope to be able to recover that market share back again as we ramp up our display shares and our stock.

Next slide, please. So, this is the breakup that I always share of the shares -- market share by segment. As you can see there, three reds mean -- three dashes basically means triple-digit basis points, two dashes means double-digit basis points.

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Overall, if you take a look, in front load washers, we continued to grow triple-digit basis points for the seventh -- sixth or seventh quarter in a row, and we continue to do very well there. In top load washers, we were able to grow strong double-digit basis points in quarter four 2025-2026 behind some incremental initiatives that we've put in with respect to new products. In semi-automatic, we were able to report triple-digit basis points growth. So, overall in washers, we had strong growth and in air conditioners as well in terms of shares. We declined triple-digit basis points in direct cool refrigerator and frost free refrigerator in volume market share in Jan 20

26 to March 2026.

Like I said, the primary driver was a regulatory changeover that we moved faster than others, which we will make up for pretty soon. And the secondary driver was competitive pricing, which continued to be very aggressive and we didn't follow to the same extent to balance between market share and profitability .

Next slide, please. Slide number 9. Let's now talk about the top line. In terms of sales growth in the first half of the year, we had a minus 4% as you can see on the left side of the chart. We started off with minus 3% and minus 5%, so it was pretty much tough between April and October -- April and September because of very heavy competitive pricing on the one hand. And on the second hand, the industry was -- impact was quite significant because of a delayed onset of summer and early monsoons last year. So, it was a very tough year for -- a very tough first six months of the year for the entire industry , which any part of the industry which relies on cooling products like refrigerators or air conditioners.

We started making a recovery in Q3 as you know with a 4% growth in revenue and in Q4 we've now made a 7% growth. And our second half momentum is actually driven by three things. One is a significant scale-up in our air conditioner business, which is fledgling compared to some of the big players.

Significant scale-up in our front load, we call it HA, Horizontal Axis, but it's the front load washing machine business, and overall share gain in washers. We've also had significant accelerated growth in premium products across refrigerators and washers. So, this is what drove our top line.

In H2 2025-2026, refrigerators remain challenging like I said because of the regulatory product changeover in Q4 that we're right now going through, which should end very soon for us, and the competitive pricing impact.

Next slide, please. We move to Slide 10. We look at margins versus last year. These are the gross margins. So, just to remind you, 2022-2023, we had 27.6% margin, 2023-2024, we went to 29%, 2024-2025, we improved to 30.6%. This year, we've arrived at a 29.9% margin, driven by basically the air conditioner mix in our margin.

So, just to explain, if air conditioners for us grows disproportionately, then our overall gross margin goes down because the gross margin percentage of air conditioners is lesser than that of refrigerators and washers, which we are fully aware of.

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However, air conditioner is able to provide scale to us, which helps alleviate fixed costs, and air conditioner is able to provide significant revenue to us, both of which matter a lot. So, it's a very conscious choice that we took to drive the air conditioner business at the right time. And so you can see that without the air conditioner mix impact, our gross margin would have continued to grow. And the reason that is the case on refrigerators and washers is because of our P4G, the Productivity for Growth cost saving program that we do and continue to do and believe in extremely fiercely.

Next slide, please. Slide number 11 now talks about the profit before tax margin. If you look at Q4, last year Q4, we had a 7.6% PBT margin in 2024-2025. This year, we would have been slightly higher than that except for two significant costs that I had already highlighted at the beginning of the year -- in January -- beginning of the calendar year.

One is the energy cost upchar g

es because of the refrigerator and air conditioning, which has not yet been compensated by pricing as of March 31. And the second is a very significant incremental e-waste provision that we do to make sure that we are conservatively accruing for potential e-waste cost. If e-waste costs are sorted out going forward between the recyclers, the producers, and the government, obviously, then that would be a help in the future for us. If I go to the right on the full year PBT margin, last year PBT margin was 5.6%. If you just take out the incremental e-waste provision we have made versus last year, we would have held our margin. So, this is purely the incremental e-waste provision that we've made, not the base e-waste, the incremental e-waste provision that we've made this year that is basically reducing the margin on a full year basis.

Next slide, please. We continue to remain efficient in working capital. This is a slightly complex slide, so kindly stay with me. As you can see on the first three columns, the blue columns, in March 2022, March 2023, March 2024, as a company we were operating on a positive networking capital, which obviously is not the ideal way to operate. A negative networking capital is a wonderful way to operate.

By September 2024, with a concerted effort across the company, we had brought it down to a negative networking capital, kept it there in December 2024. In March 2025, it was slightly positive, but much lower than the previous years. June again it was negative. And then if you see today, if you look at March 2026, the first column is our actual networking capital, which has gone up versus the previous year. But if you just take a look at the little piece next to that in green on the right that is our refrigerator and washer and our regular T2 business. That is now operating on a negative networking capital.

So, if you compare March 2026 excluding AC with March 2025, we are actually better off on networking capital on refrigerators and washing machines. The planned investment of air conditioners networking capital is what took our networking capital up in this quarter and obviously, it would be recovered in the coming quarter.

Next slide, please. I now move on to our strategic imperatives. We are now on Slide number 14. Our strategic imperatives continue to be the same; one, inspire generations with our

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brands; second, win with product leadership; third, build a competitive and resilient supply chain; and lastly, excellence in execution.

Moving to Slide number 15. This is just a bit of our history. We introduced pedestals to the country. We introduced auto-defrost in direct cool refrigerators. We were one of the early pioneers in providing colors and finishes in refrigerators from the drab and dreary kind of only steel, only gray or white refrigerators in the past.

We were the first to introduce three-door refrigerators in the country. We were the first to introduce dark interiors with the Platina range, which are extremely premium, and we were the first to introduce heaters in top load washing machines.

Net, a pioneer in the Indian durables industry, we've continuously done innovations that are made for India by Indian engineers, by our Indian workforce, inspired by Indian consumers with Indian consumer knowledge. And I hope to show some of that again as we go through the next few slides. Our focus has been to premiumize our business.

Going on to the next slide, please. Let's start with direct cool refrigerators. In direct cool refrigerators, the premium end of direct cool refrigerators, we have the auto-defrost range. Auto-defrost range we've rebranded to call it "No Tension" refrigerators because the single biggest pain point for direct cool consumers is the ice that forms in the freezer section for any direct cool refrigerator. And it causes a lot of trouble. So, you can see some of the creatives that we put out there, but in essence, we introduced a new launch, a black steel that's been

doing really well for us in Vitamagic Pro, which is the brand name for the auto-defrost range. And that's doing really well for us.

Next slide, please. Moving on to the top load washing machine business. In the top load washing machine business, you will recall that in previous meetings, I have basically said that within refrigerators and washing machines, we'll make sure that within some amount of time, we will cover all the gap areas that we have in our portfolio where we can add value to consumers, grow our market share, and grow it profitably.

In the top end, the BloomWash series, we had up to 10 kilograms. We've now introduced a high capacity top load washing machine in line with consumer demand. This is an 11 kg BloomWash and there are some amazing new features in this. The first one is that this new 11 kg BloomWash has got a Quick Sense technology. Now, there are many top end top load washing machines that have quick wash cycles, but usually they are one wash cycle whatever be the load. This one has got 30 minute cycle for a small load, 35 minutes for a medium load, and 40 minutes for a large load. And the machine automatically senses what type of load it is and takes care of it. So, this is the Quick Sense feature.

We also have in the same machine Soft Sense, which automatically releases the right amount of softener at just the right time. Lastly, we've brought this into a brand new and beautiful Juniper Green CFM, which actually brings out the premium look in an even better way and offers an amazing new color to the premium top load washing machine consumer.

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Next slide, please. Moving to Slide 18, we now talk about premiumization in two categories, this is the third one; semi-automatic. Our Dynamix technology in our mid and premium range is doing really, really well and driving the semi-automatic category. This is the technology that promises and delivers on zero detergent patches for those who are using powder in semi-automatic washing machines, which is the number one pain point of Indian consumers; the patches that stay on in the clothes after you use the detergent in the wash.

This business is doing really, really well for us. It was just introduced two years ago, in 2024 in June, if I recall right, and it is now a significant proportion of our business. Nearly half of our business is in this technology and it's driving triple-digit basis points share gain in its segments.

Next slide, please. Continuing with the premiumization story. Triple doors are the premium end of frost free refrigerators in the middle to premium area. And here we've launched -- relaunched our Protton three-door model with the Protton NXT series. We've not only done a technological and design upgrade, but we've also done a capacity upgrade, providing even more value to the consumers. T

his is doing really well for us and the magic of the three doors is that with this technology, we now have 43% lesser cold air loss versus the top loads that you normally get because of the three doors and the need to open each door much lesser.

Second, your fruits and your vegetables stay as they are supposed to because the fruits and vegetables have a separate drawer as you could see, and there is no odor mixing with other things that might be there in the refrigerator compartment. And of course, there's 360 degree enhanced cooling with Fresh Flow.

Next slide, please. We go to Slide 20, our front load washer. Now, this is premium by itself, whether it's 7 kg, 8 kg, or 9 kg, or 10 kg. The front load washers accelerated for us in 2025-2026. Our total business has grown about 60% more than last year. We've had triple-digit basis points market share growth pretty much through the year. This uses 6th Sense technology like all of our premium products do, and this business is doing quite well for us and we hope to grow it more and more in the coming months, quarters, and years.

Next slide, please. And of course, our AC business. Like I said, maybe a small number for others, but a giant number for us from where we're starting out. We've been able to bring in some really good technology and drive some really good go-to-market. And for the first time, we've been able to cross 100,000 units in monthly sales in March 2026. Our air conditioner business, even in a relatively tough year, has gone up by more than 40% versus last year, following quite a strong 80%-odd growth in the previous year.

Next slide, please. And of course, our fantastic Elica products. The new product ranges continue to drive premiumization, whether we're talking about the filter-less kitchen hood or we're talking about the ductless kitchen hood that has been launched recently, or indeed this beautiful product, the built-in hob with four burners, which has got heavy duty full brass burners, multi-flame direct, with cast iron pan support.

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And this cast iron pan support is also backed with a heat guard to make sure that you don't feel any heat while operating the knobs. So, all of these wonderful products continue to drive our premiumization strategy very strongly.

This is probably the most exciting news of the lot. This might look like the cloak of Darth Vader, but what it is actually is a black cloak that we've deliberately used to cover our new products that we're launching. Many of you have asked us when are we launching into the frost

free large capacity space? Well, the answer is in Q2 of 2026-2027, thereby filling a significant gap in our frost free portfolio.

Please stay tuned for this. In the next quarter, I hope to show you all of the different models that we're bringing in and the features of this. But this is something that we're extremely proud of. We've waited for more than two years to deliver this and we are very happy to announce that we are going to be in play in the large capacity frost free, which was one of the big chunks missing from our portfolio.

Next Slide, please. We continue to focus very strongly on driving excellence in execution with visibility of our premium lines, with a very strong sales and service incentivization program that focuses on driving premiumization and value, focusing on very strong customer relationships that we've built over

the last 40 years, and a very, very good management of our supply chain in a very complex environment.

On the service front, we're continuously improving in our service KPIs. The chart that you see there is the Net Promoter Score. As you know, the Net Promoter Score is the score difference between when consumers after installation or after service give you a score on a scale of 10. 9 plus 10, whoever gives you -- what percentage of people give you 9 and 10 scores out of 10, minus the people who give you ratings between 1 and 7.

So, this is continuing to grow for us very strongly. And this is despite the fact that we're starting to sell a lot more air conditioners where the requirement for service and getting Net Promoter Scores is even tougher because people want instantaneous installation, instantaneous service, very difficult, especially in this Delhi heat that we are facing right now to live without an air conditioner for most people. Despite that, our service organization is doing a tremendous job in keeping the scores up.

Now, we move on to our supply, two big things in this; quality and cost. And quality, as you know, we follow the world-class manufacturing practices. We continue to follow that. We've achieved a Silver in Pune and Bronze in the other two manufacturing sites with our Puducherry and Faridabad, and we hope to take them to a Silver across the course of the coming quarters and years.

On cost leadership, basically we have, if you see from 2022-2023 to today over three years, we've done a standalone gross margin improvement of 220 basis points across these three years. And that's all because of the P4G program that we do, Productivity for Growth, which is a very systematic program that covers all lines of the P&L, involves almost everybody in all of procurement, engineering, innovation, and manufacturing, as well as supply chain. And this

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program continues to do strongly for us, covering off many of the other cost impacts that we get in other areas.

Next Slide, please. And with that, I'd like to hand over to Mr. Aditya Jain. Aditya?

Aditya Jain: Thank you, Mr. Eswar. Good afternoon, everyone. My name is Aditya Jain and I am the CFO of the company and I'll take you through the financial performance of Whirlpool of India Limited.

I'm on Slide 27. This slide covers the financial performance on consolidated basis for Q4, i.e., Jan to March 2026. In this quarter, we delivered a revenue of INR 2,181 crores, which is a high single-digit growth versus last year. As we heard from Mr. Eswar, industry was not a big help in this quarter. Industry grew in low single-digits. And on top of that, the entire refrigerators portfolio was impacted by the new energy regulations which came into force from 1st January 2026. As a result of which, a massive amount of phase-in phase-out was supposed to be done. Despite those headwinds, we were able to grow revenue in high single-digits and the factors which drove our revenue growth are as follows; A, our washer business did pretty well and we grew share in the washer business. We attained a number two position in semi-automatic as well as top load washers.

And on HA, which is a small business for us right now, we grew market share, which is the MBO volume market share in triple-digits in this quarter. This was driven by the commercial and the consumer-focused product innovations and our mantra

of executional excellence.

Our AC business did pretty well. In AC, we grew by 50% in this quarter. And AC being a high ASV product, which is the average selling price of AC is roughly 2x of other core business that also helps in driving your top line.

Third big element was the segment premiumization. What it means is our focused interventions and our ROI-based ideas are focused on driving incremental growth in mid and premium segments of each of our categories, which again helps us driving premiumization within the category and hence driving the revenue growth.

Last but not the least, it was a fabulous quarter for our Elica cooking business, which grew revenue by 30% in this quarter.

On the profitability side, we delivered an EBITDA of INR121 crores at 5.6%. The EBITDA

was lower by 33.7% versus last year. And our profit before exceptional items was at INR1 10 crores at 5% and our profit declined by 29% versus last year. The big reason for decline in our profits versus last year was on account of regulatory cost upcharges. There were two big items which impacted our profitability in this quarter. One was the incremental e-waste expense, which we accrue as per the e-waste notification which came in September last year. And B, the aircon and the refrigeration upgrade cost.

Let me give you a little bit more color why we were a little bit more impacted by this energy change cost impact. As you would have noticed on the working capital slide, in December we

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had a negative working capital, which meant that we were managing our inventories very efficiently and there was very limited quantity of inventories which we carried forward from 2025 into 2026.

And as a result of which, most of our Q1 business came in from the production of the current quarter, which was BEE upgraded refrigerators production on which we had to account for the new energy cost. And this was not supported by commensurate pricing in the market till March because of multiplicity of factors and the varying level of inventories which everyone would be carrying.

And just for perspective, outside of these two items, which is the energy cost upcharge and incremental e-waste provisions, our profit would have been higher than last year. Our Elica, as I said, had a fabulous quarter and they delivered a revenue growth of 32% and a profit growth of 48% in this quarter.

Next Slide. I'm on Slide 28. In this slide, I'll cover the financial performance on a full year basis. We crossed the INR 8,000 crores numbers from a top line perspective and delivered a top line of INR 8,034 crores, which is a growth of 1.4% versus last year.

Just to give you a little bit of color, this came on a backdrop of a flattish or a muted industry because the industry for the whole year was roughly flattish. And in fact, the refrigerator industry declined largely due to the direct cool as there was delayed onset of summer and the monsoons got advanced. So we had -- the industry had a pretty bad season. And on top of that, there was a big energy change in the back half of the year, which again impacted the refrigerator business.

So, despite those headwinds, we were able to offset those headwinds and still grow our revenue by 1.4%. The various factors which led to this growth was A, our washers portfolio which we spoke about did well even on an annual basis. Aircon continued to be a good story on an annual

basis. We grew aircon business by 40% despite that the summer was pretty soft and not conducive to the aircon growth, but then we managed our business very well.

And Elica again did well on an annual basis with the double-digit revenue growth of 12%.

Other factors were segment premiumization, which is a high focus area for us and our ROI based investments continued to deliver good returns.

Coming onto margins, we spoke about our P4G program that's running through the length and breadth of the organization that is lifeline of the organization in which we look at cost takeouts across all lines of the P&L. That continued to generate cost efficiencies and as a result of which, we were able to offset the commodity cost headwinds as well as the impact of the currency depreciation, which we have seen during the year. And because of this P4G program, our core T2 business margins, which is refrigerator and washers business, improved versus last year. Our overall reported gross margins stroke material margins were lower versus last year by 50 basis points, largely on account of aircon mix because at a material margins level, the profile of aircon -- the margins of aircon are relatively lower than the T2 business, but then you get a lot of leverage both on revenue growth as well as fixed cost leverage.

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On profit side, we delivered an EBITDA of INR481 crores at 6%. It was lower by 12.6% versus last year, roughly 100 basis points. And our profit before exceptional items came in at INR426 crores at 5.3%, lower by about 12% versus last year and 80 basis points versus -- lower by 80 basis points versus last year.

The single biggest factor which led to the decline in profits versus last year was the incremental e-waste provisions. And let me just remind you that the new notification for e-waste came in middle of September last year -- middle of September 2024, correct.

Last year had pre-September rates which were based on market-driven rates and the post-September 2024 e-waste provisions based on the new circular which came into effect.

And in the current year, we are accounting for the e-waste as per new circular and hence we have an incremental material year-over-year impact. And outside of that e-waste impact, our profit margins were flat to last year.

Our reported PBT declined by 19% as we accounted for the one-time impact of wage Code provisions of INR38.8 crores on a consolidated basis. Elica continues to do well, grew revenue in double-digits at 12% and its profit on an annual basis grew ahead of revenue at 15%. That's it on the results.

With this, I will pass it back to Sweta for the next session -- for the Q&A session.

Sweta Srivastava: Thank you, Mr. Eswar and Mr. Jain. I would now request the moderator to open the Q&A session.

Moderator: Thank you very much. We will now begin the question-and-answer session. The first question comes from the line of Priyank Chheda with V allum Capital. Please go ahead.

Priyank Chheda: Yes, hi. Thank you, Eswar and team. Firstly, keeping your promise to do the call and handholding the minorities along with you and what a wonderful performance. First, clarifying for the incremental regulatory e-waste provisioning and whatever the electric energy upcharge.

So, what was this, if you can quantify for the cost for Q4 and FY 2026? And also the rationale behind doing it, would it be an incremental means that would it be for the whole of the following year based

ed on the volume assumptions we have accounted for the following year or would it be repeated also, the cost would get further repeated for FY 2027?

And have you seen this channel inventory now matching up with the norms and the regulatory on the ground so that you can recover that cost because everyone would also have a like-to-like impact on the cost?

Narasimhan Eswar: Sure, thank you. I'll take that one. So, we're not giving any further breakups within the regulatory piece on what is the incremental e-waste and what's the energy upcharge because that would be a very, very high level of getting into the detail which we're not keen on doing. But to answer your question, sir, Mr. Priyank, on the e-waste, let me take each of those separately. On e-waste, we are providing at the highest possible rate that we can provide for.
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And the way I would look at this is at this point in time, there's a lot of discussion between the Ministry, producers like ourselves, and the recyclers in terms of what would probably make the most sense. And there's quite a bit of discussion on this topic.

If there was any rationalization of these costs, then obviously we would stand to benefit. If there was no rationalization of these costs going forward, then we wouldn't lose anything. So, that's the best way that I can put it and the magnitude obviously depends on what the rationalization is. And those kind of requests and discussions are ongoing as we speak because the industry -- the entire industry, not only this industry but all industries, but specifically this industry is feeling the heat a lot from this incremental e-waste provision. So, that's on the first part.

On the second part, if you look at the energy upcharge, the energy upcharge is a permanent upcharge to the BOM, right? And this is because the bill of materials cost goes up when you go -- basically what happens is last year's three-star becomes this year's two-star. So, in essence, what you have to do is if you want to have a one to five-star range in your portfolio, you have to basically upgrade each of the levels one star. And when you do that, you have to use more expensive compressors, more expensive insulation, more expensive vacuum panels, and etcetera. And therefore, basically with regulatory changes like this energy upgrades, cost goes up unit-by-unit.

The logical thing would be that when the cost is actually gone up, that logically if it was one company that was just doing this and there was only one company in India, then that company would take up the price because it is a cost incremental to your business, right? And you would recover the price. It's a very competitive market.

And while I'm saying that, let me also add on that I had kind of said that the cost situation would be challenging this year for the entire industry and also for us because of the regulatory upcharges because the energy changes even in the last quarter. But of course, on top of this, we now have the impact of the war effect basically on costs as well as supply.

So, yes, I believe the industry has taken whatever actions it has to take. Each individual company obviously does what they deem best. We have done what we deemed best and you can figure it out from the market. I don't want to talk about what we've done in April and May because that would not be appropriate, but it's out there in the market.

And we will ha

ve to see what happens with the market and what the market does. We always have to keep in mind that we have to cover our costs and keep ourselves profitable, at least to a reasonable extent.

At the same time, we're in a very competitive market and we need to make sure that we're not outpriced. So, if it comes to a place where we're outpriced and we start having an impact on volumes in a material way, then we will have to do what we need to do to protect our business. So, it's always that delicate balance that we need to do between managing our volume and our market shares and our value and managing our profits.

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So, I hope I answered your question. The energy upcharge is here to stay. I think the next energy upcharge is supposed to be three years from now. So, every time there is an energy upcharge, there will be a cost upcharge.

And theoretically, the best way to do that is to recover it by pricing. Practically, that is decided by what individual players do in the market and what other individual players do in response to what, you know, their competition does.

Priyank Chheda: Perfectly. So, hence my follow-up question and I thought so, I will take your perspective what can be the scenario that can play out with the Middle East raw material and freight charges going up as well as regulatory cost further loading up.

So, the two scenarios which we can think of it can happen is maybe a competition rationalizes and the pressure eases and then this is followed with the pricing growth and then this scenario would lead to maybe a market share consolidation within -- gains to the incumbents.

Or do you think that there can be a downtrading itself by consumer where the cost loading happens so high and it would overtake all the efforts that we would be doing? I mean, just your thoughts on what can be the possible scenario that you think can be playing out in our industry?

Narasimhan Eswar: Yes, it's a great question. I wish I knew the answer to this question. Anything could happen. It's very difficult to predict the macroeconomic environment. What we are focused on is not so much on what's happening at a too macro level because obviously we have zero influence on anything.

We as a company, I'll tell you what we are focused on. We are focused on figuring out what's happening on the supply situation from two points of view. One is what's happening with respect to availability of products, right? Quite a few of the products are dependent on coming through the Straits of Hormuz. Oil is dependent on that, which is required for a lot of things that we do in our industry. Many of the materials, plastics are built on based of oil. EPS that we use for packing is based on oil. Methyl isocyanate that we may use is based on oil. So, there's a lot of things that's based on that.

And the second thing that obviously is a very big impact other than the price of oil is obviously the forex rate. And that is also important because typically in this industry, we make almost all of our products in India, which is incredible, but obviously there is some amount of imported components for all industry players because all the components are not made in India, right?

So, typically between, depending on the company, between 20% and 35% of products components may be imported, right, depending on the company. And so that part of it is subj

ect to forex.

So, both of these is what we are monitoring on a daily basis, making our plans against that, making sure that we're talking and working very, very closely with our suppliers on an hourly basis because what you actually have to do is make sure first of all that you have supply of components to be able to make your products. If you don't make your products, then there's nothing to sell. So, this is the first point.

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And the second point is how do you manage your costs? Both are significant challenges for all players in not only in our industry but pretty much in every industry and pretty much around the world because this is something that affects everyone. And it's up to individual people how individual companies how this is being managed. We're working a huge amount on this to make sure that we can keep our factories going, produce great quality products at the best possible cost that we can make it.

Then the second part is obviously there is a certain amount of pricing that maybe the market will bear. It's a very competitive market. And beyond that, also the question is what the consumer will do. So, there are so many variables on this that to actually guess what is going to happen, I think it's like a roll of the dice.

So, what we are doing is focusing on what we can control and what we should be delivering, which is our everyday work and staying close to the ground in terms of managing our supply, looking and taking the right decisions that we feel on costs and on pricing, and then monitoring the market very closely and we will keep on modifying dynamically our actions as we go through because it's an incredibly dynamic time.

Priyank Chheda: No, wonderful. One--

Moderator: Just a moment Priyank. We request you to please rejoin the queue if you have any further questions. Thank you. Our next question is from the line of Naushad Chaudhary with Aditya Birla Mutual Fund. Please go ahead.

Naushad Chaudhary: Yes, hi. Thank you for the opportunity and congrats for a decent set of number in a very challenging time. First, wanted to understand on the AC piece of business, what would have been the full year revenue contribution from AC? What is our aspiration for next two, three years in this category? And how much capital it would require to reach to our aspirational number?

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you very much, Mr. Chaudhary. I would not be able to share the exact AC contribution because we don't lay out that number, but AC is still a small proportion of our total business.

As you know, refrigerators still covers more than 50% of our total business, washing machines covers about 25%, 30% of our total business. AC would be the next big play basically along

with Elica. That would be the kind of thing.

Our aspiration on AC I can certainly answer that. I think we would like to grow in AC across the years strongly, but responsibly. And what I mean by that is that we would obviously like to increase our market share in this very dynamic and fast-growing -- and I'm talking about the last five years, fast-growing industry of air conditioners. It's something in which we have low shares and therefore for us the sky's the limit.

But having said that, we are very, very conscious that this is also a category in which working capital is very heavily utilized, at least in certain quarters. And it's also not at the margin prof

ile -- even for the most established players, it's not at the margin profile of our refrigerators or washing machine business.

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And therefore, I would say that we would like to grow this business very responsibly. We would like to grow this business very strongly, but focused on offtake, focused on making sure our products are selling out and we are putting in as much products as are selling out. So, the focus is not so much on loading huge amounts of inventory into the market and hoping for it to sell. We are trying to sell much more to offtake, a closer relationship to offtake.

And that way we can make sure that we will grow, we will grow responsibly, and we will make sure that we are not stuck in a situation where we're sitting on a lot of inventory which we then have to liquidate with, you know, taking whatever actions which may not be helpful for the P&L, if that makes sense. That's what I would say would be our strategy; responsibly, strongly growing the AC business.

Naushad Chaudhary: Any specific market where you will be more aggressive on the AC business?

Narasimhan Eswar: Oh no, we love all of India. So, we are actually just to be very straightforward on that, Whirlpool is a completely pan-India brand. So, we don't have any particular places. There are some places where of course we are stronger than in other places, but the split of the AC business is also slightly different. And therefore, we are focusing where we need to focus. Obviously, we focus where the markets are strong.

And the second type of area that we focus, for example, are the markets where our market shares are very strong in other categories. So, A, where the category itself is strong, and B, those markets where our market share is very strong in refrigerators and washers, which means we have very strong brand profile. Those are the two kind of areas that we focus on, but that is a significant proportion of the country, it is not three or four states.

Naushad Chaudhary: The second question on the cash balance which we have on the balance sheet, any thought on that in terms of utilizing that cash either for, you know, building or acquiring some additional category or if at all any buyback plans to use that?

Narasimhan Eswar: Yes, I'll pass this on to Mr. Aditya Jain. Aditya?

Aditya Jain: Yes, thanks for your question. From a cash perspective, the first thing I'll say, it's a good problem to have, you know. So, it's good to have good cash on the balance sheet. And the second piece is like our approach to investments is a little different since the time we've become an Indian origin company wherein now we don't have any budgetary constraints, etcetera, and our decisions are purely guided by the right projects, the right ROIs, and the right paybacks. So, there's no constraint given that we don't have a constraint on cash and no budgetary constraints, so that's the only factor which drives the decision making.

And couple of areas wherein we're looking forward to investing a little bit more aggressively than we've done in the past. A, it is on the ongoing business, especially driving the product innovation. We invested a lot of money in setting up a front load factory a few years back. Mr. Eswar spoke about the premium frost free refrigeration, so a large capex has been spent in setting up that facility as well. And as you get into the future, having the cash on bala

nce sheet

gives us that flexibility to bridge all the portfolio gaps which exist today and accelerate our innovation pipeline.

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The second area which we're looking at right now is the entire automation in our factories. It not only helps the process and the quality, but would help us give us a lot of cost savings as well. And hence, that is the other area is what we're evaluating to see that how can we utilize our cash.

Third important area is the entire cost management and the projects wherein we can trade off a little bit of capex with the cost with the right level of paybacks. As we've seen that the cost environment is going to get more and more challenging, while we have P4G programs, but then this regulatory cost and other pieces headwinds keeps coming in. And hence, finding out lot more projects wherein we can invest in capex and get our cost down, be it factories, be it product, be it network optimization, etcetera, etcetera.

Fourth area for us which we're evaluating is all about, you know, as you said about getting into adjacent categories, looking at backward integration. And why are we looking at those kind of

options is given I think the geopolitical situation and supply chain uncertainty is going to stay in some or the other manner . And then doing that piece A not only helps us get us a little bit more certain from a supply chain stability point of view but again can get us a lot of cost efficiencies as well.

Now , outside of this, there are always options to go into the market and look at inorganic opportunities like we did Elica about six, seven years back. And probably just from a sheer cash point of view , it is just sufficient enough to look at a company of a similar size. So, these are some of the options.

Now , do we have an exact timeline in terms of what we're doing? Ongoing business, we do it in day-in and day-out and we're looking at all those opportunities on an ongoing basis. But when it comes to a little bit more inorganic, we're looking into all those options, we've started work, and along with guidance from our board members, we're taking appropriate steps in that direction. We assure you as a management and with the inputs from the board, we're looking at investing cash in a manner which generates the long-term value for the shareholders.

Naushad Chaudhary: But one thing on the cash is very clear to our head that we are going to use this in the business in either of these forms, either organically or inorganically , but this is not going to the shareholders in either form of dividend or buyback.

Narasimhan Eswar: So, buyback is something that we've not looked at, at this point in time because we think there is lot of opportunity that we can actually take. Like I was saying, especially on innovation, there is so much more that we plan to do across the next 12 to 18 months in terms of bringing innovative products to the market -- and I would say 12 to 24 months actually as we invest. Plus, like Aditya was saying, we are very interested in looking at other opportunity areas in the market which can add overall value to the company . And obviously , if those opportunity areas come through, then it would be a really good use of cash. If those opportunity areas are not to be found across the next year or so, then obviously then that is not, you know , incrementally available.

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Bu

t we do believe that we are at that type of -- at that time of our existence where aggressive investment across the next 12 to 24 months can really take us into a different level of growth on both revenue and profitability .

Naushad Chaudhary: Sure, sure. W ish you all the best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you. Thank you, sir .

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question comes from the line of Atul Mehra with Motilal Oswal Asset Management. Please go ahead.

Atul Mehra: Yes, hi sir. Good evening and thanks for the opportunity . Sir, firstly wanted to get a sense of now that we are an independent company away from the parent, what is the vision that we have aligned out for the next three years, five years? Because like I think Aditya was mentioning, we are not constrained now like how we were in the past, right? So I'm sure when you are looking at the drawing board, you guys would have had a three-year , five-year strategy roadmap. So, if you can outline that, that is my first question, sir .

Narasimhan Eswar: Absolutely . So, I have not outlined that except to the board. I'll try to give you a very top order thing without going into the numbers and stuff like that because I think that's less critical. As you might have seen at the beginning of the presentation, sir, we are quite excited about the fact that even if it's for a month, we are number two in the refrigerator and washing machine space.

If you were to ask me what is my dream, which I think is a better way of putting it, I would say that obviously holding that position for a long span of time, and it may not be the next month, it may not be the next three months or four months because this is a hard fought battle with very tough, very well-established competitors.

But for me, it's wonderful to be number three, it's even more wonderful to be number two, whether it's for a month or for a quarter or for more, let us see. But we will continue to keep fighting to be in that position and hopefully improve on it. But all of this is only a stop towards the eventual position.

So, we would like to be the best in refrigerators and washing machines. And we know that it's going to take us years to do that. We are humble enough to recognize that, but we are very clear in our vision to be the best in refrigerators and washing machines, which is something that we've done globally for many years across the world in many markets. So, it's not like it's the first time, but we need to do that in India. And that is why all the men and women of Whirlpool get up every day in the morning and come to office. It's not for this quarter's results, it's not for today's results or tomorrow's results, it's for what we eventually want to become. And would it take five years, would it take eight years, would it take 10 years? That's a good question. I would hope to say definitely less than 10 years, but that's why we come to office, to be honest with you. We've never publicly said that before, but I say today , that's our dream: to basically become the number one player in refrigerators and washing machines, which is why we need to be there across all the segments.

While doing that, we will hope to have a healthy business in other aspects as well. For example, in the air conditioner space, and I'm now not getting into the detail, but I don't think right now we have an aspiration to be number

one in air conditioners because it's too much to chew on.

But for me, refrigerators and washing machines, which we've played for 40 years, know this space very well, have the ability, have the knowledge, have the experience, now have the resources, the energy for sure, and have the organization. We need to march steadily towards that goal across the next few years.

Having said that, we also need to do that in a profitable manner. It's not about just getting to market share, spending money left, right, and center, and we don't have anybody to support us, you know, on the financials or anything of that sort. So, it's all got to be self-generated. We will do that in a responsible way.

So, it may take us a little bit longer to get there. It will not be five years, it will probably be more than five years to get to the leadership position in refrigerators and washers, we know that, but one day we hope to get there. And we hope to get there while improving our profitability across time.

I've already mentioned that this is not the short-term, this is more the long term thing I'm talking about. I have already said to you that 2026-2027 will be difficult financially for the entire industry and also for Whirlpool because of all the energy changes, because of all the war impacts that are happening, which are very, very significant and kind of continuing to be not so clear as we go along. But all these things will end one day. What will not end is our passion to be the best at what we do.

We would therefore like to grow our business, grow our air conditioner business, maybe have some associated other business which are synergistic in a go-to-market perspective but add value to us from both a revenue growth and a profitability standpoint, which is I think what Mr. Chaudhary's question was, which we answered.

We would absolutely love to have businesses like we acquired Elica. There could be other businesses that could be very interesting, but it's got to be also similar on go-to-market ideally, though we're not closed to other options. And we want to do that profitably over time.

Atul Mehra: Got it. Sir, secondly my question is, you know, in this thought process of utilizing cash towards potential synergistic acquisitions, etcetera, etcetera, my only apprehension on this is, you know, you have a stock which is according to you trading at attractive valuations because you have bought stock in the open market, right? So, as a CEO, you believe the stock is undervalued and you have bought it in the open market, but for some reason it appears that you don't want to deploy that cash for a buyback.

So it is very strange from the perspective that you have a stock which is trading at, you know, one-third its valuation it was trading at in the past. The management believes it's undervalued, you guys have bought the stock in your own personal portfolios, right? But despite that, you are not considering a buyback. So, it is very strange and bizarre why despite having no use of
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cash and despite a very attractive in terms of valuation on the stock, the Board and the management is not considering a buyback. It's really not understandable if you can elaborate a little bit on that.

Narasimhan Eswar: No, thank you sir for that and I'll just give my little perspective and then, you know, I will ask Aditya who understands this topic a lot more than I

do, I can assure you. I think I certainly

believe that Whirlpool India has a bright future, there's absolutely no doubt, which is why as you might have noticed -- and thank you for noticing, some of us did pick up with our own money basically the stocks, Whirlpool of India stocks basically.

Having said that, I think there are quite a few opportunities in front of us that we're considering. And these opportunities can add a lot of value. It's early days, I'm not saying we are anywhere close to anything significant, but it's early days and there are opportunities that we think, and I think as a businessman, that could add significant value to Whirlpool of India without going into the detail of what those opportunities are. And we continue to evaluate those opportunities.

It would be remiss of me not to really play that out. And please keep in mind that it's November when the transaction happened where Whirlpool Corporation went below 50%. Following which, we've had one energy change which has probably taken a lot of energy out of all of us, and we've also had impact of war.

And in the middle of all of this, you can imagine the amount of work required to keep things going, we need to do our day jobs and then look at other things as well. It's going to take us a little bit of time to consider that.

I -- obviously, we want to do what's best for our shareholders, but we really do think what's

best for our shareholders in the long run, and we're not looking at today's share price and feeling depressed or demoralized at all. We are looking at what we're doing and saying if everything was to come back to status quo in other aspects, we should be, when times get right with the kind of momentum that we are trying to build, with the kind of discipline that we're trying to work with, we should be able to achieve quite a few of our goals. And there could be significant opportunities that we want to pursue. We will not be able to pursue that if we do some things in a rush or in a hurry under pressure.

So, I'm going to ask you to trust us a little bit more on this. We have a very well-informed Board that is also looking at these things. And we've not had a huge amount of time post this acquisition -- post this transaction, as you can imagine. But I think Whirlpool India can do a lot more in the coming 12 to 24 months in terms of utilizing quite a few of the assets that we have that you mentioned. And I would like to help grow this business as my primary kind of source of excitement and happiness. That's what we would like to do. Happy to listen to Aditya's point of view on this if you have anything more to add.

Aditya Jain: No, I think Mr. Eswar you said it all. I think the limited point here is that we have a vision, we have a vision to grow and we have the vision to be the number one. And in that vision, there

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are opportunities on the way to deploy this cash in a manner which can take our company to the next level.

So, it is a question of a little bit of short-term versus long-term. And we believe that with our vision to grow, we would need that on the way to make our company successful and which would ultimately lead to a long-term value creation for the shareholders. And that's where our thought process is as of now. And we will evaluate that in a little bit more detail in the next 12 to 24 months

and take the right decisions.

Atul Mehra: Right. Thank you very much. My only feedback is the focus should be on shareholder growth and not just business growth, right? At the end of the day, shareholders want return on the company's investment, right? So, do consider a buyback in terms of as part of the many avenues that you are considering, while you are considering many other potential M&A, etcetera. Do also keep in mind that a potential acquisition is just acquiring your own shares which could be undervalued. So, just keep that in mind as a suggestion and thank you very much.

Narasimhan Eswar: Sure, sir. Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question is from the line of Umang Mehta with Kotak Securities. Please go ahead.

Umang Mehta: Hi, thanks for the opportunity. My first question was on your capital work in progress. We heard that premium refrigerator is something which is on cards, but anything else which is ongoing in terms of capacity expansion? And any plans of any capex for room ACs because what we understand is globally because Whirlpool didn't have any manufacturing, we always were kind of on the back foot. Is it possible to commit any capex and start production in India in the near future? That's the first question.

Narasimhan Eswar: Sorry, Mr. Mehta, your voice broke a little bit. Could you just repeat in brief, the question, I'm so sorry. Your voice broke.

Umang Mehta: No worries. Sorry. I hope I'm audible now. Just whatever capacity expansion plans are currently [inaudible 1:06:56] CWIP of INR200 crores. Can you share some thoughts or insights? And any plans to expand AC capacity or put up AC manufacturing in India in the near future?

Aditya Jain: I'll take the first question which your question was on basically the CWIP. The CWIP right now pertains to the premium refrigerators we spoke about. Since we've not started -- since it's going to come in the next quarter, so the capex is still lying in CWIP and has not got capitalized. Just want to clarify that piece.

Narasimhan Eswar: Yes. Sorry. So, basically, Mr. Mehta, we hope to bring in a few things across the next 12 to 24 months. And I say 12 to 24 months because some buttons have been pushed, but as you know, this is a high engineering business and it's not very easy to bring everything into market in 12 months.

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There's quite a few buttons that have been pushed by the Board with the Board's advice by us in terms of what we will do. And like I said, our accent will be firstly to make sure that we cover all portfolio gaps that we have in refrigerators, washing machines.

We are also open to looking at other areas of investment where there are significant opportunities in the near future in terms of expansion into those categories, right, associated categories.

In terms of the air conditioning investment into capex, this will be a commercial and strategic decision. The reason I'm saying that is because there is quite a bit of capacity in the country available with 3PL players who can supply air conditioners to you with your design, to your specification, to your technical requirement. And you've got to balance that off with

investment into capex of your own plant.

Now, that does make sense at a certain volume possibly and we are continuously evaluating that decision. And when we need to make the decision, we absolutely will do that. But f

or me,

I just need to make sure that if I get into a new plant, then I should make sure that the depreciation does not hurt my P&L any more than it needs to. So, the short answer to the AC question is it totally depends on how we go across the next few years and it depends on what happens with the 3PL manufacturers that we have, what kind of partnerships we can strike, what kind of deals we can strike, and what economics would make sense for us.

So, long as economics is making a lot of sense for us, we are fine. If at some point in time the economics of setting up your own plant is better than the economics of sourcing it from a 3PL, then we certainly would not hesitate to take the decision at that point in time.

Umang Mehta: Got it. And the second question was on your margins. So, two points to it. One was what is the e-waste expense absolute number in 2026 and where is it likely to land in 2027? And any crystal ball gazing you can do in terms of what margins can we look at either in terms of gross or EBITDA in FY 2027? I know there are many moving pieces, but as of now, what would be your best assessment?

Narasimhan Eswar: Yes, sir, as far as e-waste is concerned, we're not giving out -- you will see the e-waste data, you know, I can't remember it off the top of my head, but you will actually see it, you know, when we're publishing our annual report. It'll all be there because it's statutory to declare that.

Margins, to be honest, we can't give any guidance right now. Like I said before, this is an incredibly unusual time. If it had been a normal year, even then I probably would be loath to give any guidance on margins because it's so -- it's such a competitive market, right?

It's not like, you know, I don't want to say which category, but there are some industries where you take a price increase for one year and then, you know, everybody is clear. This is the kind of business where the price list changes on a monthly basis. So, this is not the kind of place where we can just give out any margin guidance, honestly. I wouldn't do that.

Also in this current context, I would say it's almost impossible to predict. Like I said, we are focused on making sure that we're doing the right things for the short and the long-term, taking Page 22 of 27

all of cost and all of revenue into account. But any guidance I would absolutely not be able to give on margins.

I will say that as I said before, before the war impact started, I said 2026-2027 would be a challenging year because of energy regulations coming in, because of these incremental e-waste provisions that all people have to make. It would be a challenging year because of the competitive thing. The war is there on top. So, we're just praying for good outcomes and we're working incredibly hard to make sure that we make as best an outcome as possible out of what we have in front of us.

Umang Mehta: Sure, sir. Thank you and all the best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. Our next question is from the line of Nattasha Jain with PhillipCapital. Please go ahead.

Nattasha Jain: Thank you for the opportunity. Sir, first question is on refrigerator. So, the past couple of years we've seen that the industry growth here has been pretty much flat despite it being a cooling product and summers being good. So could you throw some light as to what's happening in this category

? I understand even penetration is not that great here. So, why is this category being a laggard in terms of appliances?

Narasimhan Eswar: Yes, ma'am, it's a great question. I'd say I can't give you a definitive answer to this question, but what you've observed is true. At the entry level, the direct cool refrigerator business, the industry has not done well in the last five years. I'm not talking about market shares and movement between players, I'm talking about the entire industry.

I think post-COVID, in terms of the recovery that's happened from the economy, I think that's one of the factors that you had a situation where it's a little bit like a K-curve. It's not been one-sided kind of growth for everybody. It's been a bit of a K-curve. The downward part of the K-curve is basically impacted DC, the direct cool business, and the semi-automatic business as you know, because these are entry-level products at the entry of DC and then of course there's a middle and a premium as well.

Now, you also have a situation where if the bottom part of the K-curve is not moving as fast, and I'm really, really hoping and looking forward to that moving up fast because that trickle down has to happen. Plus, you know, with all of the recent activities that have been opened up, you know, with income tax slabs opening up, GST being brought down on products, not so much for refrigerator and washing machines, but certainly for air conditioners and panels and cars and so on and so forth. There's a lot of housing programs being done by the government. I think it's around the corner. Now, it's three months, six months, 12 months, 18 months from

now, I do not know , but it's certainly not three years away where penetration should start growing again.

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As the trickle down happens, the penetration starts growing again also because of all these other events that I mentioned. And when that happens, I think DC will start picking up, SA will start picking up. These are not sunset categories, absolutely not in this country . What actually I think, ma'am, practically speaking in my view is happening is a lot of the people who have refrigerators that are eight years old or 10 years old or 11 years old and you would expect them to upgrade to a new model are potentially saying, hang on, let me just maybe carry on for another two years by doing some amount of repairing and some amount of managing somehow because we do a lot of jugaad innovation in our country .

And I think that's probably happening here as well, where decision making on buying the next refrigerator is getting postponed. It cannot be postponed forever because at some point in time, you know , machines that you bought 15 years ago, 14 years ago, 20 years ago, you know , for sure, you know , you can't repair it beyond a point in time, all machines have a life.

So, I think it's a matter of time before it comes in. So, there are two big things that I think are going to happen. I think the bottom half of the K-curve is going to start lifting because of all the impact that the government is putting in, but also because of the fact that, you know , the trickle-down effect has to happen.

And the second part of it is that as people have postponed their purchases, but now there is a point beyond which you cannot postpone. So, when it comes back, you should hit -- I think mathematically you should get a

double whammy help, which would be very nice to see, especially for somebody like us who's very strong in DC and in semi-automatic. We would love to see that take up.

Nattasha Jain: Got it. So do you think a BEE rating kind of a thing in refrigerator could pump up the demand?

Narasimhan Eswar: Ma'am, it's a very nice question, it's a very probably a tricky one to answer . I think what is really important in DC and semi-automatic is making sure that the price point makes a lot of sense for the consumer for the value that they're getting, right?

On the one hand, you know , having more energy efficient products is very good because it helps save, you know , energy, it helps conserve energy for the country . It's a wonderful thing.

On the other hand, if you increase -- keep on increasing star ratings, then the cost also goes up, right? The refrigerator will not be the same cost for a two-star and a three-star and a four-star.

Basically , it's impossible to be at the same cost.

So, energy rating cannot increase without a commensurate increase in cost. And if there is a commensurate increase in cost, then over time there has to be a commensurate increase in pricing. It may not be immediate, but over time it has to happen.

And therefore, as we know , when price goes up, demand could potentially go down. So this is a very complex relationship. We are doing the right thing as a country , as an industry by upgrading our energy-efficient machines and so on and so forth.

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It might have beyond a point in time, if overused, then it could potentially have an impact of pulling down demand instead of pushing it up. And that's where I think that tight balance is, which is what industry is always speaking with to the ministries about.

Nattasha Jain: Understood. Sir, one last question and one feedback. So, in terms of washers, the question is, you know , fourth quarter and the first quarter continues to be a good quarter . Could you throw some light in terms of how Whirlpool's performing there and especially your front load fully automatic front load category? And a feedback, sir, saw very strong traction for your RAC on the ground and good feedback in terms of both product quality and cooling. So, just wanted to leave you with that. Thank you so much.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you very much, ma'am. On washers, like I said, our front load washers, washers overall we've had some pretty solid results. We've had share increases in the last quarter as I said in the presentation. There's been volume market share increases and obviously value market share increases in all three categories in the last quarter: in fully automatic, in semi-automatic, and in front load.

Specifically on our front load washers, as you might have seen, we have strong double-digit shares in top load, nearly close to our DC shares actually . We've got pretty strong double-digit growth in semi-automatic, but our front load washing machine share is still only single-digit. So, we have tremendous opportunity in that because we are known as a washing machine company , we invented the washing machine globally .

So, I would say it would almost be an unfulfilled potential if we don't take our front load washing machine to where it needs to be, which is the top echelon of front load washing machines. But it's an incredibly competitive market. A lot of existing -- very strong players have big stakes there. So, it's not going to be easy

, but we are moving ahead one step at a time.

And like I said, in the last six or seven, probably eight quarters, which is over the last two years, we've had either high double-digit or triple-digit basis point share growth in every quarter versus the previous year. And thank you for your comment on the room air conditioner .

Much appreciated.

Nattasha Jain: Thank you, sir . All the best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you.

Moderator: Thank you. Since we're nearing the closing time for the meeting today , we'll take one last question from Mr . Achal Lohade with Nuvama Institutional Equities. Please go ahead.

Achal Lohade: Yes, thank you for taking my question, sir. Just two questions. First, I know the industry and the company has gone through lots of ups and downs, but if you were to look at from a steady state perspective, what is the margin range one should look at for Elica and for rest of the business? That's my number one question.

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And secondly , you know , in terms of the adjacency , is it fair to say that it will be in the kitchen appliances or you could also evaluate something in the small appliances? Those are my two questions. Thank you so much.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you very much, sir. Like I said, you know , we're not really giving out any margin guidances now for the future, but just to be very, very top line, I had said even two years ago, our intent over the long run would be to grow the business high single-digit, you know , year-on-year compound growth rate. I think maybe we can up that a little bit and go into early double-digits as we think about the future. At least that's our ambition and let's see where life leads us on the base business.

Now , margins, I think to be honest in the long run in this category because of the modeling that -- you know , if you do your modeling on the regulatory impacts and if you do the modeling on the competitiveness of this industry , you can see today that there's hardly anybody who's in double-digit margins, right? It was not the case six, seven years ago in what we call 'the good old days', right? Those were the days where you would be sitting on 11%, 12%, 13% margin. Honestly , I think that's going to be very, very difficult for any player to do. Whether or not you are sitting on double-digit margin today , I think is not that relevant. What is relevant is it's an incredibly competitive market in which there is a significant regulatory cost component, energy changes that are kind of slated to come, you know , across the years.

And therefore, over a long span of time, I think to get to a high single-digit margin is probably what is likely in the refrigerator washing machine air conditioner space, right? And I think that kind of is probably the best that I can tell you.

Now , what Whirlpool will do or will not do, we will see as we go along, but that's kind of in line with what I said and that would be long-term, it's not definitely not -- I'm not saying medium term at all.

As far as Elica's concerned, as you know , it's already in a strong double-digit kind of range. I think with Elica, the key for us is Elica is such an incredible brand. And I would say compared to Whirlpool, it's not, you know , nowhere near that level of distribution because it's a more niche category . And I think there's plenty of potential for Elica across the next decade to be in many , many , many more homes as India prem

iumizes, as India aspires more.

Elica is this incredibly , incredibly designed product, made in India, conceptualized in India, delivered in India, inspired by Italian design. And that is something that I think, you know , as we look to that business, I would always hope to keep it in the double-digit margin range, but over the next maybe five to seven years, I would love to take a little bit of that margin and put it into driving revenue growth because I think there is a significant opportunity to drive that category whose penetration is probably less than 5% today , much less than 5%.

And I think, you know , to get to a washing machine level of close to 20% or to a refrigerator which is in the mid-30s to sub-40 level, Elica's got tremendous potential for growth as well, like ACs have in this country , like washing machines have in this country , and like refrigerators have in this country . So, I hope I answered that question.

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On the adjacency , I think like I said, we started looking at it early days. We have to look at a lot of factors. I think the overall obviously any business that we get into, whether it's an adjacency or an acquisition or whatever it is, a merger, we have to become better owners of the business than the current, you know , business. And that I think is what is going to be the key . So the obvious things to look at is where are the synergies with respect to go-to-market, where are the synergies, you know , with respect to what kind of business you want to get. For example, we've not been really interested in very low margin businesses. That's not of any interest to us because Elica is a classic example of the kind of business that we would definitely like to have, which is really good margin business, capable of growing very strongly . We have, you know , a lot of potential to grow that business. We have the margins with which we can invest into that business. That's a classic example of the type of business and by the way, similar go-to-market, similar go-to-market, not the same, but a similar go-to-market. And

therefore, that's the kind of profile of adjacency or acquisition or whatever you want to call it that we would like to look at, not something which is completely off the wall. So, is it large? Is it small? I think that's less important than is it beautiful? Is it profitable? Is it synergistic? I hope I answered your question.

Achal Lohade: Very well, sir. Thank you so much. Wish you all the best.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you, sir.

Moderator: Thank you. Ladies and gentlemen, that was the last question. I now hand the conference over to Ms. Sweta Srivastava for closing comments.

Sweta Srivastava: Thank you, everyone, for joining the call. With that, we would like to draw this call to a close. Thank you.

Narasimhan Eswar: Thank you.

Aditya Jain: Thank you.

Moderator: On behalf of Whirlpool of India Limited, that concludes this conference. Thank you all for joining us. You may now disconnect your lines.

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